

CRITICAL READINGS

IN GLOBAL DYSTOPIAN POLITICAL NOVELS

Dr. Salim Kadhim Abbas

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CRITICAL READINGS

IN GLOBAL DYSTOPIAN POLITICAL NOVELS

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"Every now and then, the same thought leaps into my mind, and the same vision unfolds before me. I see the values of virtue, truth, goodness, and beauty ascend like dawn, scattering the darkness—toppling the thrones of vice, evil, injustice, and ugliness.... I see paradise itself descend upon this weary planet, opening its gates and calling us to live within its embrace..... It is a dream— perhaps so extravagant that others deem it folly— no more rational than a child asking his father to lift him high enough to touch the moon....

..... And yet, this dream is inseparable from the ancient longing for the day of deliverance... the day of Saviour's coming.... It is bound to the timeless notions of waiting..... It is what, unknowingly, plants in us the seed of hope; what urges us, every day, to find a reason to keep living until tomorrow..... It is what makes us endure, without fully knowing why, the pains and wounds of the present— sustained by a quiet, stubborn faith that someday the future will come, bearing joy and happiness in its hands."

DR. SALIM KADHIM ABBAS
IRAQ – 2025

DEDICATION

To all lovers of literature who dedicate their time and effort to its study —

To the scholars, academics, educators, and students who tirelessly continue their pursuit in the fields of research and study — with unflagging passion — on their ongoing journey to uncover the deep meanings hidden between the lines of literary texts, to analyze literary discourse and interpret its ambiguities and complexities, in a quest to enrich thought, broaden the horizons of awareness, and aspire to a deeper understanding of the world around them—

To the researchers who diligently trace the fine threads intertwining literature with politics, history, and culture — weaving from them profound insights that illuminate and shape the course of reformative human thought—

To the intellectuals and critics who dare to question the entrenched, to unmask the unexamined, and to carve new passages into the labyrinth of interpretation —

And to the devoted readers — especially those who wander the mysterious corridors of political and dystopian narrative, and those who drift through the boundless horizons of the novel—

This work is humbly and wholeheartedly dedicated.

I hope these articles serve as lanterns in your hands, illuminating forgotten corners, awakening reflection, and, in whatever measure they can, enriching your journey across the boundless realm of English Literature.

DR. SALIM KADHIM ABBAS
IRAQ – 2025

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INTRODUCTION

In order to analyze literary texts—particularly narrative texts, which are often products of their historical and cultural environments—it is crucial to understand the external context surrounding the text during the period in which it was produced. This includes the social, political, and cultural conditions of the time. Modernism emerged as a diverse movement in the arts, encompassing literature, visual art, and music. Between 1890 and 1930, Modernism evolved significantly, giving rise to new schools of thought, innovative narrative techniques, and groundbreaking theories of art and literature. Influential movements such as Symbolism, Feminism, Nihilism, Objectivism, and Naturalism emerged, impacting various literary genres including the novel, drama, poetry, and the short story. The period from 1910 to 1930 was marked by significant economic turmoil, including a global depression. High Modernism began to flourish shortly after the First World War, a time when politics, society, art, and literature were undergoing rapid transformation and expressing new emotional and intellectual concerns. In the West, the years following 1930 witnessed constant change, with economic collapse and widespread unemployment reshaping public life. Meanwhile, political ideologies and regimes were taking hold across the globe: the Bolsheviks in the Soviet Union, Fascism in Italy, Communism under Mao in China, and Nazism in Germany. These developments led to violent conflicts such as the invasion of Abyssinia, the Spanish Civil War, and eventually the outbreak of the Second World War. Dictators such as Stalin, Hitler, and Mao remained in power long enough to inflict profound suffering and devastation upon civilian populations.

The first half of the twentieth century was a period of unprecedented global upheaval, marked by events that significantly altered the course of modern history. These events had far-reaching and deeply negative impacts on the lives of people across much of the world. Among the most prominent were:

1. The World Wars (I and II) – which caused the deaths of millions and reshaped global politics.
2. The use of atomic weapons – most notably when the U.S. dropped atomic bombs on the Japanese cities of Hiroshima and Nagasaki in 1945, killing approximately 120,000 civilians.
3. The rise of totalitarian regimes – which suppressed populations, eliminated political freedoms, and exerted total control over societies.
4. The manipulation of technology by authoritarian governments – using propaganda, surveillance, and mass media to entrench their power, suppress dissent, and restrict freedom of thought, while also exacerbating poverty, unemployment, and lack of education.

In this turbulent political and social climate, many novelists emerged, using literature as a means to engage with the issues of their time. As a result, the novel during the Modernist and Postmodernist periods became more realistic and gained popularity for its ability to reflect the suffering, struggles, and hopes of society. George Orwell, in particular, believed that the purpose of literature should be to raise awareness and enlighten ordinary people about the hidden realities behind social and political problems. He viewed literature as a tool for social responsibility rather than mere aesthetic enjoyment. For Orwell, meaningful political reform and structural change were essential to creating a better world—a view shared by many of his contemporaries.

In this context, the book presents a curated collection of research articles and studies that offer critical analyses of several significant and influential modernist novels. The author of the book (the writer of these articles) carefully selected works that reflect the social and cultural diversity of the environments in which they were written. The selection includes three British novels by two British authors—"Animal Farm" and "Nineteen Eighty-Four" by George Orwell, and "Lord of the Flies" by William Golding—two American novels by two American authors—"Fahrenheit 451" by Ray Bradbury and "All the King's Men" by Robert Penn Warren—and one Canadian novel, "The Handmaid's Tale" by Margaret Atwood.

These acclaimed works, many of which are award-winning, engage deeply with the socio-political issues of their respective societies. They encode within their narratives the conflicts, crises, and systemic injustices endured by individuals and communities. The novels explore a wide range of powerful and enduring themes, such as the absence of justice in dystopian societies, dehumanization, oppression, totalitarianism, the corrupting influence of absolute power, ideology, culture, identity, class struggle, the impact of politics and power on individual and society, racial and gender discrimination, theocracy, and patriarchy. Through vivid storytelling and symbolic representation, these novels portray the suffering and tragedies that arise in the absence of justice and freedom. As such, they exemplify a form of committed literature—literature that serves a social, moral, and ideological purpose. These works not only issue warnings about the dangers facing society but also seek to uncover the root causes of political and social unrest. Furthermore, they aim to raise awareness and enlighten the public about the realities shaping their world. Given their profound role in educating readers and fostering critical and mature thinking, these narratives and their authors merit close attention and rigorous critical examination. Their contributions to literature and social

consciousness underscore the importance of placing them under the lens of scholarly analysis.

The Corrupt Absolute Power of Big Brother: A Critical Reading of Orwell's Nineteen-Eighty Four

Abstract

This study aims to determine the interconnection of absolute power and corruption, and to confirm the relationship of power and ideology in George Orwell's dystopian political novel Nineteen Eighty-Four. This study argues the way the totalitarian political regime of Big Brother, misuses power and imposes its ideologies to exploit, deform, and overpower the society and reshape its classes, identity and culture, which ultimately results in the catastrophe of corruption and creates dystopian society inside the novel. This qualitative study adopts thematic analysis to investigate the concepts of power, corruption, and ideology in the narrative text. Besides, it conducts textual analysis of the selected data by employing Marxist Criticism and Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) as analytical tools. The findings of this study indicate that absolute power practices are interconnected with corruption in the novel, and those who are in power impose their ideology upon the society to retain power through manipulating in language and discourse to reformulate awareness and thinking of the society. It is hoped that the current study will provide better understanding of the interconnection of absolute power and corruption as a missing feature in literature on this novel. This study contributes to literature on Orwell's novel Nineteen Eighty-Four in particular and the field of the political English novels in general. It will extend the base of the researchers' knowledge in this area.

Keywords: Absolute power and totalitarianism, Ideology, Class, Corruption, Dystopia, George Orwell and Nineteen Eighty-Four.

Introduction

During the 20th century the narratives encoding human sufferings and aspirations for better conditions have been highly circulated among the readers. In the period of Modernism of English literature the value of the writing is based on the assumption that works of arts and literature must be used as weapons against the corrupt systems. To this end, the 'dystopian literature' has been materialized as a new narrative genre that modern novelists use to unmask the dark side of human lives caused by the evil powers represented by totalitarian regimes. The modern novel deals with the important events that have affected the world and literature (Nouasri, 2015). As explained by Suciu (2013), dystopia has connected its roots with disaster in the thought of the twentieth century. The dystopian novel could fundamentally detect the totalitarian regimes that appeared during the evolution of Nazism, Fascism, and Communism. Arendt (1951), cited in Backes (2007), describes the totalitarian regime as a political regime who controls people and every aspect of their lives. Political themes in dystopian societies and totalitarian states have been the focus of so many literary works, especially the modernist English novel. The novels have reacted to the political situation development and threats brought up by the evolution of new political establishments. These novels were directed by their writers to the readers for bearing in their mind the importance of warning people about the danger of such totalitarian states. Among the most distinctive works written on these themes is George Orwell's novel *Nineteen Eighty-Four*. This novel depicts atrocities that have been committed by Big Brother regime against its subjects, where the inhuman political ideologies have been exercised by this totalitarian regime, which cause physical, mental and psychological torment of the individuals and the society, in order to retain power. Absolute power represented by totalitarian regimes and dictatorships, has occupied large areas of literary and political studies because of the importance and seriousness of this

theme and its impacts on the lives of peoples. In addition, corruption due to political absolute power and abuse of power is one of the most prominent phenomena in our real world. The great negative effects of corruption extend to touch the loaf, dignity and human values. These political themes have been encoded in the political novels, especially the novel under the study.

This study investigates the concepts of absolute power, corruption, and ideology as encoded in Orwell's Nineteen Eighty-Four to determine the relationship between absolute power and corruption in this narrative text. There have been many studies conducted about the theme of absolute power in this novel. Thus, the current study draws on previous research to highlight the gap regarding the link between absolute power and corruption. Previous studies, for example; Sebastian (2001), Pelissoli (2008), Navratil (2008), Suci (2013), Loverinovic (2014), Tereza (2016), and Dikiciler (2017) focused on drawing the form of absolute power and its authoritarian methods and negative effects on society through the interrogation of the narrative text of this novel. However, the relationship between absolute power and corruption in the previous studies about this novel is not researched. Thus, the gap of research could be identified through previous studies that focused on: i) The form of absolute power, and ii) Authoritarian method and its negative effects on society. So, the gap appeared in: i) Lack of research in examining the interconnection between absolute power and corruption, and ii) No study has applied Marxist criticism with CDA (together) as analytical approaches. To bridge the gap, the current study; i) Examines the image of corruption and the social reaction against absolute power practices through inquest of the text to show the evidence of interconnection of absolute power and corruption, ii) Employs Marxist criticism with CDA as the analytical approaches. The use of these two analytical tools together in conducting the textual analysis of the selected data creates integration in the analysis of the narrative text, where the literary and linguistic aspects of the text are covered and surrounded. From the researcher's point of

view, this makes the analysis more in depth, and makes the results more reliable. In order to address the research problem and objectives of the study, this research question emerges: How does absolute power interconnect with corruption, and how does power relate to ideology in the selected narrative text? The contribution (originality) of this study lies in determining the interconnection of absolute power and corruption as a missing feature in the literature. It provides better understanding to this interconnection as a prominent phenomenon that touches people's lives deeply in the old and the modern human history, which English literature widely addresses it. This study contributes to the existing literature on Orwell's political novel *Nineteen-Eighty Four* in particular and the political English novels in general.

Literature Review

This section explains the major terms in this study, in addition to report the findings of the previous studies that related to the topic of the current study. This study investigates the concepts of absolute power, corruption, and ideology as encoded in Orwell's *Nineteen Eighty-Four*. Power, according to Wrong (2017) is often defined as "a capacity to control or influence others" (p.6). However, absolute power means a complete authority which is not restrained by review or supervision to act in an area. The main forms of power are; force, manipulation, and persuasion (Wrong, 2017). When political absolute power is practiced by an individual, a group, or by a one-party government, it will take the form of totalitarian regime or dictatorship. According to Wrong (2017), the term 'totalitarianism' refers to "tyrannical political regimes that wield more extensive, comprehensive, and intensive power than any of the monarchies or tyrannies of the past" (p.19). Progress of technology, techniques of surveillance, new media of communication, and violence instruments increased highly the strength of power in the totalitarian states. Gregor (2004) stated that the aims and strategies of the totalitarian rulers, being very extreme, often described as total or totalitarian, wherein such

regime controls every part of human life. The last century witnessed several inhuman and oppressive regimes that came in power including the major Bolsheviks in the Soviet Union, the Nazis in Germany, and Mao's Communists in China. Roughly, over one hundred million people were killed by these governments (Werth, 1999).

Corruption in the political sense means the abuse of power. Corruption, due to political absolute power and abuse of power, in institutions of a state and a society is one of the most prominent phenomena in our real world. There are great negative effects due to corruption extend to touch the loaf of humans, dignity and values. Literature in general tackles this issue, especially the novel under the study. Corruption penetrates all life aspects of society inside the novel under the study, wherein political, ideological, and social corruption is prevalent. Corruption deprives the society of essential rights and freedoms; it badly affects all aspects of life in the society. Werlin (2013) mentioned that corruption is a "robbing people the opportunities they fought for." (p.4). Thus, corruption, in its all forms, leads to create the dystopian society and finally disintegration of the society. The concept of 'dystopia' is related to absolute power and its corruption in the selected narrative text under this study. 'Dystopia', in contrast to utopia, refers to an imaginary place where everything is bad, in which people are ruled in a dehumanized way and often spent their lives in fear (Navrátil, 2008).

Gramsci explored how the totalitarian regimes use culture as a means to reshape an individual's identity in the dystopian state. Gramsci introduced the theory known as 'cultural hegemony' wherein political regimes controlled the minds and passions of the multitude not just by direct destructive force but by a coherent system of notions to serve their political intentions (Haralambos, 2013). Hegemonic culture propagates its own values and norms so that they become the "common sense" values of all and thus maintain the status quo. If culture is the network system of interrelated doctrines and practices then ideology is central to that

system. Van Dijk (2000) stated, cited in Schäffner (2003), that "ideologies have something to do with systems of ideas and especially with the social, political or religious ideas shared by a social group or movement"(p.6). Ideology "is a basis for the social practices of group members"(2003, p.8). In the novel under study, political absolute power was based on the marketing of its own ideologies to persuade and to subject the society for total authority. The ruling class uses processes of manipulation and distortion of these ideologies, from time to time, in order to retain its power and own interests. In *Nineteen Eighty-Four*, manipulation in language and discourse has been greatly used by the Party to impose its ideology and control people's minds. According to Van Dijk (1999), the process of manipulation has been adopted to be the masterful strategy for influencing the minds of individuals and society by distorting and internalizing of certain ideologies, values, beliefs, or attitudes, through the use of language and discourse.

However, some previous studies can be mentioned by what they have done through investing the theme of power in Orwell's novel. The theme of absolute power in Orwell's novel, *Nineteen Eighty-Four*, was investigated by Sebastian. He stated that the holders of absolute power control over individuals lives. This researcher concentrated on exposing practices of power, wherein the love of power was the major motive behind the political action (Sebastian, 2001). Navratil (2008) focused on revealing the role of absolute power of the totalitarian regimes in creating dystopian society in this novel. Pelissioli (2008), through studying Orwell's novel *Nineteen Eighty-Four*, investigated absolute power and revealed that the signals to Communism as sort of totalitarian regime represented absolute power should be generalized to read as signals to any sort of totalitarian regime (Pelissioli,2008). Loverinovic analysed the features of totalitarianism as absolute power in this novel. Loverinovic stated that the society was governed by strict rules, and explained the absolute obedience of the citizens to their tyrannical political regime (Loverinovic,

2014). Tereza (2016) analysed the dystopian novel, *Nineteen Eighty-Four* and focused on the concept of the dystopian society which created by absolute power represented by totalitarian regimes. However, no previous study has investigated corruption as a result of absolute power, nor determined the link between them in Orwell's novel under the study. Thus, this study is motivated by a desire to contribute to the body of research on *Nineteen Eighty-Four* focusing on absolute power-corruption correlation as a missing feature in the literature in order to fill this gap and enrich the body of research in this field.

Methodology

The data of this study is the text of Orwell's novel *Nineteen Eighty-Four*. Data collection includes extracts taken from the narrative text. This qualitative study adopts thematic and textual analysis of the data. The thematic analysis is a method of analysing qualitative data to examine the data to identify themes (Cresswell, 2003). The qualitative data of this study are in the form of extracts taken from the narrative text to be analysed. These selected data (extracts) are based on the themes that relate to the key concepts of the study; power, corruption, and ideology. Thus, the extracts have been selected based on the mentioned related concepts. The textual analysis is used to describe and interpret the text, where information, assumptions, symbolism and values can be detected from the text. The textual analysis is conducted by employing two analytical tools; Marxist Criticism and Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) to reveal manipulation of language and discourse used in the text. Furthermore, the notion of binarism or binary oppositions is used as a platform to serve the analysis. It is a mode of thought on stable oppositions (such as good and evil). As Tahreem and Khan (2020) have mentioned, binarism or binary relationship has always been established on the basis of power, economy, and politics, in addition to gender and caste. This notion is a central to the literary creation, especially in drama and fiction. The analysis is built on binary opposition in the

society inside the narrative text on the basis of power, ideology, and class. Identifying the social classes in the narrative text helps in tracing class, ideology, and power. The textual analysis of the data of Nineteen Eighty-Four is conducted by using two analytical tools and through two phases as follows:

i) Analysis of the data by employing Marxist Criticism (Marxist literary criticism) which focuses on the role of ideology and class difference within the literary work, the role of money and power, author's ideologies, and the context. The notion of binary oppositions or duality, and manipulative techniques used in the text, such as manipulation and propaganda, are used in doing analysis from literary perspective.

ii) Analysis of the data by employing Critical Discourse Analysis: CDA is used to conduct the second phase of analysing the text (extracts) by using linguistic strategies of implication, euphemism, lexicalization, syntax exploitation, manipulation, and contrast.

It is worthy to mention that the use of these two analytical tools together creates integration in the analysis of the narrative text, where the literary and linguistic aspects of the text will be covered and surrounded. From the researcher's point of view, this makes the analysis more in depth, and makes the results more reliable. The analysis involves the totalitarian regime in Oceania represented by the ruling Party (its symbol Big Brother) which imposes its ideology on the society by various means such as, propaganda, surveillance, violence, torture, and killing in a way that strengthens its absolute power and exacerbates corruption.

Orwell and the World in Nineteen Eighty-Four

This study employs Marxist critique which deals with the text in its historical, political and social context, and the environment of the author and his ideological orientations. In addition to CDA who studies the text in its context. Thus, it is significant to shed light on the text and its author to understand the world behind the text. The purpose of this section is to discuss the context of the study, and to contextualize the text. It provides description and

introductory signals that have significance in understanding the analysis, and paves the way to the analysis. George Orwell is an English novelist, critic, essayist, and journalist. Orwell's writings are characterized by outspoken support of democratic socialism and opposition to totalitarianism (Gale, 1996). In this novel he depicts a futuristic dystopian society and predicts the future of the forthcoming world divided into tremendous power forces where people are run by government propaganda. Orwell's *Nineteen Eighty-Four* has led to appear the term of 'Orwellian', an adjective that describes mechanisms of totalitarian for controlling thought (Tavlin, 2015). The political and ideological thought of Orwell is reflected in his novels. For the subject matter of his novels Orwell made use of the problems of his time and lived in an atmosphere of chaos and political turmoil. He criticized the writers of the twenties in his essay entitled "Inside the Whale" for their lack of interest in the social problems (Orwell and Mackay, 2000, p.129). Orwell assumes that he could do his best writing when inspired by some political purpose. The initial impetus comes from "a sense of injustice, a lie to be exposed or something to be drawn attention to" (Orwell, 1984, p.5).

Oceania, Eurasia, and Eastasia are three superstates that control the world within the novel. For controlling the remaining unconquered lands of the world, there is a perpetual war among the superstates to this end. The social structure in Oceania takes a pyramid shape. At the top there is Big Brother. Although no one has seen Big Brother personally, his portrait has been selected by the Party to become a symbol which represents the whole political system in Oceania. Big Brother is the icon that people worship and fear it, so this serves to accumulate and establish absolute power to the dictator. Under the leadership of Big Brother, The Party has been divided into the 'Inner Party' and the 'Outer Party'. The Inner Party members are much better educated; they are forming the elite ruling minority. No more than six million members, this number forms two per cent of the total population of Oceania, or maybe less. The Inner Party members enjoy many privileges,

while the Outer Party members are deprived of. Thirteen per cent of the whole population the Outer Party members make up. The Outer Party members suffer from poverty and deprivation. They live under hard conditions in tacky, dark and dilapidated departments, opposite to the luxurious living condition of the Inner Party members. The Outer Party members work, day and night, in the four ministries of the State as subordinates to the Inner Party members. The Outer Party members are under surveillance, they have no real privacy, because their apartments are equipped with two-way telescreens. Thus, it is possible to the Inner Party to watch or listen to them any time. Many devices of surveillance, like hidden microphones, have been put by the government to monitor the Outer Party members in public places. However, the written correspondence is under observation, it should be read by the Party before delivering it to someone of the Outer Party members (Yun-fei, 2016). Outside the Party, at the bottom of the social pyramid, there is a great number of people, make up eighty five per cent of the population of Oceania, who are called 'proles' (hint to 'proletariat'). The Inner Party looks at the proles as they are inferiors, and they should be kept in total subjugation. The Party considers them like animals and it is easy to keep them under the control of the Party. Since they are generally ill-educated, they just concentrate on trivial grievances and neglect the greater evils and dangers. The job of the protagonist (Winston Smith an Outer Party member) is to rewrite the past in favour to the Party that makes the people, currently and in the future, unable to realize what has truly happened before. But, Winston is the only man who thinks of the dictatorship of Big Brother, while the others keep in living as usual in a situation of slavery. Winston decides to rebel against the political regime of Big Brother. He starts his secret rebellion by recording down everything that he sees or knows in a diary. In Oceania, people live under the mercy of the party and its repressive apparatus, the most dangerous of which is the Thought Police. Secret agents have been employed to serve in the Thought Police, who pretend as common citizens. The

job of the secret agents is to spy and to report anyone with subversive tendencies against the Party. The Thought Police are recruiting children to report suspicious citizens, including their parents, to the Party. Surveillance covers all people and their details. A tiny hint of rebellion, even a facial expression, can lead to prompt arrest. The people, including and particularly party members, are forced to obedience (Yun-fei, 2016).

Findings and Discussion

In Oceania, the party has created some agencies which reflect the totalitarian regime of Big Brother. These agencies include; the "Ministry of Truth" (Ministry of Propaganda), which is charged with falsification of facts, it distorts the historical records to promote the Party's ideology, the "Ministry of Peace" which is concerned with war, the "Ministry of Love" which is in charge of torturing the people who their loyalty to the party is questioned; it is a place where people are interrogated and tortured, and the "Ministry of Plenty" which falsifies economic figures and plans for economic shortage. Other than these administrations Orwell draws on some institutions such as the Junior Spy for national security, Junior Anti-Sex League, and Thought Police, which practices surveillance and the arrest task (Orwell, 2003). Thus, Oceania is governed by an authoritarian political system, wherein surveillance and spying on people are among the main means that the regime uses to control the entire society. Two groups of characters in this novel seem to be in binary opposition socially, economically and intellectually, and each group represents a class, and there is a conflict between these classes. Identifying the social classes in the narrative text helps in tracing class struggle, discourse, ideology, and power relations. O'Brien is a powerful mysterious member of the Inner Party who rules Oceania under the leadership of 'Big Brother'. On the other side, there is another line, which contradicts the line of totalitarianism, represented by Winston Smith. Winston is a contemplative and intellectual thirty-nine-year-old. He is a proletarian who hates secretly the enforced

repression and the totalitarian control of the government, and he has revolutionary dreams. In the same side there is Julia, Winston's lover. She is a beautiful girl, twenty-six-year-old. She works at the Ministry of Truth in the Fiction Department, in addition to her membership of Junior Anti-Sex League (Orwell, 2003). Julia "hates the Party, and says so in the crudest words, but she makes no general criticism of it" (Orwell, 2003, p.178). Winston's job in Ministry of Truth is to change the history; he burns the old historical records and substitutes old events and people with new one that will go in favour of totalitarian rule. Through Winston's suffering, and breaking his will and spirit at the end of the novel, Orwell demonstrates totalitarianism by awarding its effects on an individual's life (Orwell, 2003).

Interconnectedness between absolute power and corruption, and relationship of power and ideology in the narrative text

The analysis of the data is conducted through two phase:

i) Analysing the text by employing Marxist Criticism:

Extract 1:

"BIG BROTHER IS WATCHING YOU" (Orwell, 2003, P.2).

Everywhere in Oceania, this cautionary statement has been written in upper case. From Marxist critique view, this extract shows that the ruling class represented by the Party, who controls the economic sources, has put the ruled lower class under strict surveillance. The purpose behind this act is to make sure that the whole society is loyal to the political system of Big Brother and its ideology (Ingsoc, English Socialism). The main goal of the ruling upper class is suppress the ruled lower class in order to gain full control upon the society and to retain power. In Oceania, the Party has created some agencies which reflect the corrupt totalitarian regime of Big Brother. The purpose of these agencies is monitoring people, spying on them, restricting their freedoms, practicing violence and torture, and killing if necessary. These agencies include; i) the "Ministry of Truth", which is charged with falsification of facts. It distorts the historical records to promote

the Party's ideology, ii) the "Ministry of Peace" which is concerned with war, iii) the "Ministry of Love" which is in charge of torturing the people whose loyalty to the party is questioned; it is a place where people are interrogated and tortured, and iv) the "Ministry of Plenty" which falsifies economic figures and plans for economic shortage. Other than these administrations Orwell draws on some institutions such as the Junior Spy for national security, Junior Anti-Sex League, which prevents sex, and Thought Police, which practices surveillance and the arrest task (Orwell, 2003). Thus, Oceania is governed by an authoritarian political system, wherein surveillance and spying upon people are among the main means that the regime uses to control the entire society.

The aim of writing this statement in capital letters is to warn the people, and to send a message, that no one can hide himself from the eyes of the Party, and to spread fear among the people in order to tame opponents if there are. What causes fear and terror in people's hearts is that this warning statement is written beneath a big poster of Big Brother with frown and angry face that gazes from the wall. These pictures make people feel that "the eyes follow you about when you move"(Orwell, 2003, p.2). The psychological effects of these posters are very heavy on the people because the pictures are everywhere and the eyes (spies) follow the people. In this terrifying cautionary statement, Big Brother refers to the Party and the government intelligence agencies. The word "watching" means "spying", but the action of spying is not done by Big Brother himself. Instead, it is done by the faithful members of the Party and those who work in the government intelligence agencies, and they represent Big Brother's eyes. The pronoun "you" in the statement indicates everyone who sees the poster, or reads the words of the statement, or hears it from media (Hama, 2016).

Subsequently, it could be said that nobody in Oceania is free; everybody is under surveillance of the Party. The people cannot escape from surveillance, there is no way. Even the sons and the

daughters of the Party who are called 'the junior spies' become Big Brother's eyes. They spy even on their own parents. In addition, if the people in Oceania close their doors and sit in a secure corner and turn off the lights, they will actually remain under surveillance. So, the people cannot find a way to make them feel safe, because 'to be seen' means you will be 'penetrated' (Atwood, 2010). Surveillance used by totalitarian regimes has always been an essential metaphor for dystopian fiction to the extent that the known statement "Big Brother is watching you" has become familiar. It is usually mentioned by many people in any instance of a government that observing its people and intruding upon their privacy, and in terms of security and the retention of power, it becomes useful for them to discuss this statement (Hall, 2008). Thus, it could be said that surveillance is viewed as a manifestation of the corruption of the totalitarian regime; in addition, it is an illegal means of retaining power. In this text, the author exposes the practices of the totalitarian regime and its corruption, and expresses his anti-totalitarianism ideology. Thus, the text is propaganda against the status quo. At the same time, the text supports the issues of the oppressed class and calls for justice and freedom through depicting suffering of the people within the narrative text due to the corrupt absolute power.

Extract 2:

"Power is power over human beings. Over the body – but, above all, over the mind. Power over matter – external reality, as you would call it – is not important. [...] We control matter because we control the mind. Reality is inside the skull" (Orwell, 2003, p.361).

These words have been said by O'Brien to Winston in Room No.101, in the Ministry of Love, during Winston's interrogation who has been arrested by Thought Police. In this extract, O'Brien has tried to inform Winston how the Party sees and understands power. O'Brien is the most prominent member in the Inner Party. Winston, the protagonist of the novel, is an Outer Party member

who has tried to rebel against Big Brother to get emancipation from the totalitarian regime. Two characters in the novel seem to be in binary opposition socially, economically and intellectually, and each character represents a class, and there is a conflict between these classes. O'Brien represents the ruling class; he tries to suppress Winston who represents the ruled class. Winston is a contemplative and intellectual thirty-nine-year-old. He is a proletarian who hates secretly the enforced repression and the totalitarian control of the government, and he has revolutionary dreams. Winston has started his rebellion through writing his own diary. He records his life details, opinions, and thoughts which grow silently against the Party's policy and tenets to extent that he writes in his diary, "DOWN WITH BIG BROTHER"(Orwell, 2003, p.23). Then, he falls in love with a fellow Outer Party member, Julia, who sets out along with him to rebel against the totalitarian and oppressive political regime in Oceania. However, their movements have been monitored by the eyes of Big Brother. It is clear that the individuals in dystopian society of Oceania have been monitored, but most of them are unable to discover the tricks of the Party and realize the reality of their situation (Hall, 2008). According to the Party, Winston has committed many crimes against the political regime; i) he writes 'Down With Big Brother' in his diary, ii) he has an illegal love affair with Julia, and iii) he joins the anti-Party Brotherhood. So, Winston and Julia have been arrested by the Thought Police and sent to the Ministry of Love, Room 101.

Winston's interrogation, done by O'Brien, has conducted by adopting corrupt methods of physical and psychological torture aimed at breaking the morale and the will, then brainwashing and reshaping the culture and identity of the prisoner according to the party's ideology and orientations. O'Brien's words indicate clearly that the most dangerous threat on the total supremacy of the Party is the individual consciousness. Exactly for this cause, it becomes fundamental for the Party to get total dominance over the individuals to the point of reaching inside their skulls and

occupying them intellectually. The individual consciousness is the core in which the seeds of renaissance may root and grow to build an opposition ideological front to struggle against the political regime. This opposition may eventually have the strength to rid of the powerful regime. Winston is a proletarian, but he is contemplative character and possesses the cognitive and cultural ability that is enough to read the political, social and cultural situation. Winston represents the individual consciousness in the novel, and his voice represents the voice of resistance. But, at the end he is forced to give up his idea of rebelliousness. This confirms the political, ideological and moral corruption practiced by the Party due to absolute power and complete control over the society. O'Brien explains to Winston the concept of power from perspective of the Party. He confesses that the Party seeks power wholly for its own sake, and the Party doesn't care about the good of others. The Party interested only in power, 'pure power'. He states that the Party is totally different from all the others oligarchies who have ruled in the past, because the Party realizes completely what must be done. O'Brien confirms that all the others are hypocrites and cowards, even those who are somewhat similar to us. O'Brien says, according to the ideology of the Party, that "The German Nazis and the Russian Communists came very close to us in their methods, but they never had the courage to recognize their own motives"(Orwell,2003, p. 359). O'Brien explicitly acknowledges that the true motives of the Party for seeking and retaining power are subjective and utilitarian. He admits that the Party believes that "no one ever seizes power with the intention of relinquishing it", and according to the ideology of the Party "Power is not a means, it is an end". Furthermore, O'Brien states boldly that "One does not establish a dictatorship in order to protect a revolution; one makes the revolution in order to establish the dictatorship". O'Brien continues to express the corrupt beliefs and ideologies of the Party and its members by saying; "The object of persecution is persecution", "The object of torture is torture", and "The object of power is power"(Orwell,

2003, p.360). From point of view of Marxist critique, the narrative text reveals the ideology of the party and its members, as the ruling class, and in return it sheds light on the ideology of Winston, who represents the oppressed ruling class. Dialogues and events in the narrative text indicate that the author, Orwell, exposes the party's corrupt ideology. He criticizes and attacks the practices of the totalitarian regime, and confirms the interconnection of the overt corruption with the absolute power of Big Brother. Orwell has presented Big Brother as the worst model of corrupt totalitarian ruler that can appear anywhere and at any time. Thus, it could be said that Orwell's cautionary message (of emergence such political regimes everywhere in our world) to the readers has been clearly sent through this novel.

Orwell introduces 'Room No.101' in the climax of his novel; it is the room of torture that lies in the basement inside in the Ministry of Love. In this room, a prisoner is subjected to the worst nightmare that no one has ever seen or imagined it. It is a world of fear or phobia, by and through it, the party attempts to break down the resistance of the prisoner, then to practice brainwashing (Orwell, 2003). Winston is badly tormented in Room 101, and the aim behind that is to not kill him but to break the spirit and soul. He has been forced to accept what the Party wants that 'two plus two equals five', and not four as he believes. However, "This is a fundamental principle that has become the symbol of the Party's unlimited control, reaching even into the individual's mind" (Wien, 2012, p.5). The totalitarian rule of Big Brother makes Winston non-existent and became nothing, "unperson". Thus there is a sense of annihilation. Winston is eventually transformed to a faithful member in the Party; he surrenders his mind and soul to Big Brother. For Winston "the end was contained in the beginning"(Orwell, 2003, p.218). In Nineteen Eighty-Four, Orwell presents the totalitarian political system of Oceania and depicts the corruption which is interconnected with absolute power of the dictator, Big Brother.

Extract 3:

"WAR IS PEACE, FREEDOM IS SLAVERY, IGNORANCE IS STRENGTH."(Orwell, 2003, p.5)

These paradoxical words are the official slogans of the Party in Oceania. These slogans have been deliberately written on the facade of the Ministry of Truth building, which represents the Ministry of Propaganda of the Party. They are introduced at the beginning of the novel in order to serve as an introduction to the reader about the notion of doublethink. Doublethink is a prominent term in Newspeak of Oceania. Doublethink is an intricate idea which refers to accept two contradictory concepts as true. Doublethink is a "psychological means fostering the diminishment of rational language and preventing individuals from imagining rebellious ideas". Since the thought of human "is affected by eliminating words, behaviour is modified towards a manifestation of doublethink"(Muradian, 2017, p.37). Throughout the novel, these ideological slogans have been repeated five times. They represent a powerful example of the idea of doublethink that the Party has invented. Consequently, it is an ideology adopted by the ruling class to retain its power, so it has been imposed upon the ruled class. For imposing its ideology and reinforcing its domination over the ruled class, the Party works on weakening the minds' strength of individuals and their independence. It compels the people to live under a continual situation of fear due to propaganda. As a result of this policy, the Party becomes able to make the people accept anything and any decision decreed by the Party even it is unfair or illogical. By using manipulation, the Party could convince the people of its contradictory national slogans. This shows evidence about the strength of the Party's campaign of mental and psychological control over society. The Party employs these slogans to distort the truth and to make the people ready psychologically to accept the Party's lies. The Party claims that "War Is Peace", because convincing the people of with idea of existing a common enemy makes them united against that enemy, not against the Party. According to the Party "Freedom Is

Slavery", that because the individual who has independence will be doomed to fail. So, each individual should be subjected to the collective will (of the dominant group) to be free from danger. In same orientation, "Ignorance Is Strength" because the Party claims that knowledge brings contradiction that weakens one's mind. But in fact, unconsciousness of the people about the contradictions of the Party's discourse reinforces power of the authoritarian political regime in Oceania. The third slogan "is highly indicative in sustaining the idea that being unable to understand on the part of the masses is a precondition of being safe from the contradiction they may feel if they think or have the ability to know" (Abdu & Khafaga, 2019, p: 426). This reveals how ideology is employed to maintain power. Orwell states, in his essay Politics and the English Language, that "Political language... is designed to make lies sound truthful and murder respectable and to give an appearance of solidity to pure wind" (Hama, 2015, p. 268). The people in Oceania lose the concept and meaning of truth, but they have to accept what is said by the Party as facts.

To carry the meanings that the Party wants, these slogans have paraphrased in Goldstein Book. Therefore, the first slogan means that, in the new age in Oceania, the normal condition is war. This indicates that Oceania will remain in a state of war with its opponents and other countries. From the perspective of the Party, this will institutionalize the forbidden, and will justify violence. Clank of servitude chains to one's environment is the free choice pain; this idea has been communicated in the second slogan. In other words, the people have not to be free. The third slogan has been paraphrased to make it means that owners of knowledge is taken (by their knowledge) to the universe of contradiction thought. The goal of employing these slogans is to manipulate the society for complete compliance to the Party without realizing or thinking of what is happening around them, because clarification make the people think. However, thought is a crime under the regime of Big Brother. Language is a means of producing discourse, which in turn is a means of producing an ideology, then

ideology is employed to gain and retain power. When the Party creates "Newspeak" in Oceania to replace "Oldspeak", the exploiting of language has reached its peak for controlling the people's minds. Newspeak is a language established on the base of reducing the number of words and terms used by the people in order to make the language limited and restricted. Imposing this language to be used by the people makes very difficult or impossible to express the thoughts of freedom that awaken the society to rebel against the totalitarian political regime. Newspeak, a fictitious language created by Orwell in this novel, reflects tragic imaginations of the novel's author about reality. It is invented to serve ideological orientations of English Socialism (Ingsoc) which lead to annihilate the human thought in Oceania. Simply, the purpose of Newspeak is "to make communication, exchange of ideas, preservation of knowledge, and exchange of human emotions impossible, or at the very least very difficult" (Reznikov, 2001, p. 56). Manipulation and deception practiced by the Party become easier through using Newspeak to prevent the people from understanding of the real world. The political discourse of the Party depends on language, so it redefines language in order to fit the Party's dominant ideology. The political regime in Oceania is "relied on the combination of violence, and specific jargon and carefully contrived propaganda to spread their dogmas and justify their atrocities" (Luchini, 2006, p.97). INGSOC, according to 'Newspeak', refers to "English Socialism". It is the political philosophy that has been adopted by the Socialist Party who rules Oceania. INGSOC involves a doublethink meaning. The government of Oceania's totalitarian superstate rules its people by the ideology of "INGSOC", and the orders of the invisible ruler Big Brother. The philosophy of "INGSOC" has three major principles. The first one is 'Newspeak', it is the official language of the Party which communicates its ideology and thoughts effectively, and conveys its messages to the people. The second is 'doublethink', it the idea of holding two contradictory notions in the mind. The third principle is the past

mutability; it is built on the idea of not holding on certain events or beliefs in the past that should be changed to serve the Party's policy (Orwell, 2003). The ruling Party's ideology is based on these three principles. And this ideology is imposed in two ways: the first through massive powerful propaganda, and the second through coercion, by using violence and intimidation. What has been explained above shows evidence that ideology relate to the corrupt power in the narrative text.

ii) Analysing the text by employing Critical Discourse Analysis:

Extract 1:

"BIG BROTHER IS WATCHING YOU" (Orwell, 2003, P.2).

The Party promotes its discourse through various means to control the people and retain power, among them are using of slogans and captions. The party has used simplification's strategy that is represented in the use of slogans and captions. This strategy "is totally based on the use of words. Slogans and captions are considered a form of control" (Abdu and Khafaga, 2019, p: 425). This statement, in this extract, is an important caption created by the Party for this end. Through its manipulative discourse in this caption, the Party has employed many linguistic strategies:

i) Implication: This statement involves 'implication'; it implicates the idea of surveillance (is watching you). This caption is extremely indicative in reinforcing the notion that every individual in Oceania is under control of the Party. It is a message that says the dictatorial leader is always there. This message has been communicated through combination of the big poster of Big Brother and the caption underneath it which serves this end.

ii) Euphemism: The Party employs the word of 'watching' instead of the word of 'surveillance'. The word 'surveillance' means a close observation of criminals or spies in particular, so using the word 'watching' is more conventional or familiar. In its slogans and captions, the Party has used convenient lexis to hide their bad connotations.

iii) Lexicalization: The Party has employed certain lexis to create significance and influence in this caption such as; Big Brother (the powerful symbol of the political regime), watching (it implies threat), and the pronoun YOU (you are targeted).

iv) Syntax exploitation: (is watching) refers to a continuous act. The present continuous tense has been used in writing this caption to indicate continuity, i.e. surveillance is continuous.

v) Manipulation: This statement is an example of manipulative discourse that involves manipulation in language to spread fear among the people in order to control them. This statement has been written in upper case to bring attention. The purpose behind using this caption is to retain the Party's power and control the society. Abdu and Khafaga (2019) mentioned that the posters and captions that the Party has employed in this novel play very significant role in sustaining control over the society. The posters and captions are totally based on the use of words, and "Slogans and captions are considered a form of control" (2019, p.425)

The manipulative discourse of the Party appears in the misleading names of the four ministries. There are two strategies have been used in naming the four ministries include contrast and euphemism:

i) Contrast: It is one of the strategies used by the Party in its discourse to control the minds' people and to retain the Party's power. This strategy appears clearly in the names of the four ministries; Peace, Love, Plenty and Truth. These names are used by the Party for the contrary purposes hidden behind their meanings and literal names. These names are ambivalent lies that cover the real evil activities of these ministries:

i) The "Ministry of Peace", but it is actually a "Ministry of War".

ii) Arts and education in Oceania are the responsibility of the "Ministry of Truth", but it is actually responsible for concerning with the falsification of history and records, in order to match the policy of the Party. It is a "Ministry of Propaganda"

iii) The task of the "Ministry of Plenty" is to develop economy, but in contrary its activities aim at depriving people of living a decent standard and creating economic reduction.

v) Maintaining of law and order is supposed to be the work of the "Ministry of Love", but its real task is the mental conditioning of people by torturing them. In fact, there is no practicing of the real activities of all these ministries; instead they have devoted to do the opposite acts.

ii) Euphemism: In addition to contrast in the names of names of the four ministries, the Party has used the strategy of euphemism in naming the ministries in order to soften the evil actions of these ministries: i) the "Ministry of Peace" deals with "war", ii) the "Ministry of Truth" produces "lies", iii) the "Ministry of Love" makes "pain and torture", iv) the "Ministry of Plenty" provides "poverty and starvation". The four ministries are tools in the hand of Big Brother to suppress the people, and to torture them, as well as they are eyes of Big Brother to monitor the people. These ministries are images of corruption that interconnected with the practices of absolute power.

Extract 2:

"Power is power over human beings. Over the body – but, above all, over the mind. Power over matter – external reality, as you would call it – is not important. [...] We control matter because we control the mind. Reality is inside the skull." (Orwell, 2003, p.361)

The words in this extract have been said by O'Brien to Winston in Room No.101, in the Ministry of Love, during Winston's interrogation. O'Brien's discourse involves the following strategies:

i) Implication: These words indicate the danger of individual consciousness. The Party has to control people's minds; this implication appears in: "over the mind", and "inside the skull". O'Brien's words indicate clearly that the most dangerous threat on the total supremacy of the Party is the individual consciousness.

Exactly for this cause, it becomes fundamental for the Party to get total dominance over the individuals to the point of reaching inside their skulls and occupying them intellectually.

ii) Lexicalization: O'Brien has employed certain lexis to create significance and influence such as; "power", "body", "mind", "we", and "control". The purpose of using these words reflects the policy of the Party that aims to enslave the bodies and minds of the people. O'Brien explains to Winston the concept of power from perspective of the Party. He confesses that the Party seeks power wholly for its own sake, and the Party doesn't care about the good of others. This shows the corrupt practices of Party that linked with its absolute power.

Extract 3:

"WAR IS PEACE, FREEDOM IS SLAVERY, IGNORANCE IS STRENGTH."(Orwell, 2003, p.5)

This extract includes three major slogans of the Party, in which the party has used manipulative discourse for imposing its ideology and controlling the people. For this end, the Party has presented three paradoxical definitions of three essential concepts, WAR, FREEDOM, and IGNORANCE, by using three linguistic strategies:

i) Contrast and language style of paradox: Through these slogans, the Party has linked between concepts that are originally contradictory, because war is the contrary of peace, freedom is the contrary of slavery, and ignorance is the opposite of strength, it also involves a style of paradox. This confirms the doublethink's principle adopted by the party to mislead the people who have to accept two contradictory ideas, in the same time, as true.

ii) Manipulation: The Party has manipulated the people by giving illogical interpretations for the meaning of these slogans. The Party has claimed that "War Is Peace", because convincing the people with idea of existing of a common enemy makes them united against that enemy, not against the Party. According to the Party, freedom is slavery, because individuals who have

independence will be doomed to fail. Consequently, each individual should be subjected to the collective will (of the dominant group) to be free from danger. In same orientation, "Ignorance Is Strength", because knowledge makes people think about the contradictory ideas, issues, and things that knowledge contains, so knowledge weakens people, and so strength lies in ignorance. But in fact, unconsciousness of the people about the contradictions of the Party's discourse reinforces power of the authoritarian political regime in Oceania.

iii) Syntax exploitation: The use of the strategy of syntax exploitation by the Party has appeared in writing these slogans. The three slogans show the same syntactic structure_ they have been written in simple grammatical structures and in the simple present tense_ in order to refer to continuity. This means that these slogans are strategic, not interim. This reveals how ideology is employed to maintain power.

"Newspeak" of Oceania, invented by the Party, is based on reducing of the number of words in the "Oldspeak" is to minify the range of thought. The Party thinks that the old language involves words that allow the people much expression and freedom of thought. So many words have vanished; e.g. freedom, and justice. "Newspeak" is also based on inventing new words in a language; e.g. Newspeak, and Oldspeak. In addition to combining words together, e.g. doublethink, and thoughtcrime. Newspeak is a manipulative language, for example, "Ingsoc" which indicates the ideology of the Party "Socialism" in its apparent meaning, but in fact, it is used to manipulate. The purpose of inventing Newspeak is to serve the Party's ideological agenda, control the people, and retain power. As stated by Fairclough (1989), "the role of language is significant in the production, maintenance, and change of social relations of power". As well as, "the language contributes to the domination of some people by others. Language is a powerful tool in the hands of politicians to manipulate people and history both in the past and present" (Muradian, 2017, p.35). Orwell (1946) states in his essay Politics and the English

Language, cited in (Hama, 2016), that "Political language... is designed to make lies sound truthful and murder respectable and to give an appearance of solidity to pure wind" (2016, p.268). 'Newspeak' is the most interesting idea in the novel that shows the power of language. The language has acquired great importance in this narrative text as a means used by the Party to retain power, because "By controlling language and information through a complex coercive apparatus, the Party realizes a mind control of its subjects". This could be 'total' in intensity and extension together. In intensity, "because any individual thought is totally dominated", and in extension, "because the totality of the subjects is dominated"(Hama, 2016, p.226).

This view makes clear that the political regime of Oceania controls, by using the language as an effective weapon, the minds of the individuals in the society. The novel could be viewed as finding out that totalitarianism is a mind-set, and the major aspect in this novel is the use of language and discourse as an influential means of manipulation and oppression. This is the essential of 'Newspeak' that has been imposed by the Party on the people (Gaupseth, 2004). According to Orwell, the main goal of using "Newspeak" is to minify the range of thought. The Party has imposed this language to be used in Oceania for many aims; decreasing understanding, limiting freedom, and reducing vocabulary in order to manipulate the people. This is a specific system of derivation which allows formation new expressions and vocabulary that serve the Party's ideological agenda; this is morphologically characterizing "Newspeak" to achieve thought control over the people. The Party thinks that the old language involves words that allow the people much expression and freedom of thought. So, these words must be vanished, and this is the purpose behind inventing "Newspeak". Big Brother's regime has decided to control everything, and this will be realized, as the Party thinks, by changing language to fit with its new political system. Thus, many words have been eliminated from the "Newspeak", Such as; "democracy", "justice", "liberty" and

"religion". Muradian (2017) mentioned that "language contributes to the domination of some people by others. Language is "a powerful tool in the hands of politicians to manipulate people and history both in the past and present"(p.35). Finally, the analysis above reveals how the Party has imposed its ideology by using manipulative discourse to retain its corrupt power.

Conclusion

It could be concluded that this study has determined the interconnection of absolute power and corruption and provided a better understanding to this interconnection as a prominent phenomenon in the old and the modern human history that have always been portrayed in the literary works, because it touches peoples' lives deeply. The analysis of the data has clearly shown that the corruption, resulting from absolute power, has appeared in multiple images; political, ideological, and social corruption. The Inner Party, as a ruling class, has oppressed the people in Oceania. The Party has imposed its own language and ideology upon the society. In Oceania, it is forbidden to think. Those who opposed the Party faced torture and murder. The members of the Inner Party have enjoyed a life of luxury. In return, the lower classes have suffered from poverty, and lived in a big prison. This confirms the corruption of the totalitarian political regime of Big Brother that related to its absolute power. Besides, it could be concluded that power is related to ideology in the narrative text. The manipulation of language and discourse and the intense propaganda along with the violence have led to impose ideology of the totalitarian political regime. The findings of this study have expanded the work of the previous research on the theme of absolute power in the selected modernist English novel, *Nineteen Eighty-Four*. The current study has bridged the gap that left by previous research through finding the link between absolute power and corruption as a missing feature in literature. Since this study has focused on political and ideological corruption of absolute power, thus further research is recommended about social,

financial, and moral corruption results from absolute power of the totalitarian regime in the society within the narrative text of Nineteen Eighty-Four. In addition, the link between the corruption of totalitarian regimes and reshaping class, identity, culture of the individuals and the society inside this novel in particular and in the political novels in general.

Influence of Politics and Power in Robert Penn Warren's Novel All the King's Men

ABSTRACT

Historically, politics and power have had a great influence on the lives of people everywhere and at all times in our world. This impact reached into various sides, including individuals' rights and liberties, social fairness, human dignity, and even something as basic as a loaf of bread. Inspired by this idea, this paper attempted to render a critical reading of Robert Penn Warren's novel, "All the King's Men", about the influence of politics and power inside the narrative text that finally resulted in serious consequences. The central objective of this research was to explore how politics and power impact both individuals and society as depicted in Warren's narrative. This qualitative study undertook thematic analysis tackling themes of politics and power, and critical analysis of Warren's narrative text by employing Marxist literary criticism as an analytical approach to analyse the narrative structures of this literary work. The findings highlighted how power altered the character of Willie Stark, the novel's protagonist, turning him from a sincere individual into a corrupt political figure in order to sustain his position. The study concluded that Warren's novel presents a somber portrayal of human nature and its tendency to descend into vice and corruption under the influence of politics and power. The significance of this study was in providing a deep understanding of the negative influence of politics and power on society inside the novel, which is similar to what is happening in our real world. This study would contribute to extending the base of knowledge and enrich the literature in this novel, and the political English novels.

Keywords: Politics, Power, Manipulation, Corruption, Robert Penn Warren, "All the King's Men"

INTRODUCTION

In his monograph "Marxism and Literary Criticism", Eagleton introduces the concept by noting that Marxist criticism "analyses literature (includes the novel) in terms of the historical conditions which produce it; and it needs, similarly, to be aware of its own historical conditions". This statement reinforces the idea that Marxist criticism relies extensively on the "sociology of literature" (Abbas & Sandaran, 2019, p.1148). Accordingly, when an author creates a literary work—such as a novel—that work functions as a cultural product shaped by interrelated political, social, religious, and economic forces grounded in reality. This understanding affirms the Marxist view that literature is a product of society and is inseparable from the historical, social, political, and cultural contexts in which it arises. The modern novel in English literature became more realistic, immediate, and widely read than those of earlier periods because, rather than depending solely on imagination, it grappled with major events that influenced the world and Literature (Abbas, 2021). In the turbulent climate of the twentieth century, novelists emerged to address pressing social and political issues through their fiction. One of the most renowned political novels of the modernist period is Warren's novel, "All the King's Men". Warren's novel, as examined in this study, addresses a political theme. It centers on the populist politician Willie Stark, who starts out as an honest lawyer with strong ideals, cautioning citizens about the dangers of political corruption. Eventually, Stark rises to become the governor of a southern state during the Great Depression. However, the narrative illustrates Stark's shift from a principled and ethical man to one who is opportunistic and self-serving and from an honest figure to a corrupt governor, driven by the lure of politics and power. His overwhelming selfishness leads him into moral decay and corruption. As governor, Stark becomes solely concerned with his own interests. Consequently, Willie Stark brings about his own downfall, harms nearly everyone close to him, and inflicts lasting

damage on both his state and its people. The insights of "All the King's Men" are numerous, but the most significant among them is political corruption. The behavior of corrupt political figures reflects patterns visible not only in fiction, but also in real political life.

The problem of this study has been formulated by considering the political and social situation due to the influence of politics and power on individuals and society as encoded in Warren's novel, "All the King's Men". Thus, the main objective of the study is to uncover the influence of politics and power in Robert Penn Warren's novel under the study. In order to address the research problem and objective of the study, a research question emerges to guide this study: how does the influence of politics and power manifest in Robert Penn Warren's "All the King's Men"? By conducting thematic analysis, depends on the chosen themes of politics and power, and critical analysis of the selected novel of Robert Penn Warren, the current paper attempts to provide a deep understanding of the influence of politics and power in society inside the narrative text of the novel under study. The study adopts Marxist literary criticism as analytical approach to analyse the narrative structures of this literary work. Thus, the author of the text and the external social, political, and historical context in which the text was produced will be considered. As an entry to the analysis, it will be appropriate to briefly highlight the concepts of politics, power, manipulation, and corruption that this study deals with. This will be a platform that serves the analysis and paves the way for reaching the desired results of this study. The findings of this paper assert that politics and power in "All the King's Men" has great negative influences on individuals and society. The findings reveal the influence of politics and power on Willie Stark's character, transforming him from an honest man into a corrupt politician willing to break every rule of just governance to maintain his position. In addition, the findings assert that political corruption could build up the misery of society, and expose that this narrative text truly examines, by

many means, how a corrupt governor can ruin society. The final conclusion of this study is that Robert Penn Warren's "All the King's Men" presents a dark view of human nature and its tendency to descend into vice and corruption under the influence of politics and power, and transforming an idealistic individual into an authoritarian figure. The significance of the current study lies in providing a deep understanding of the influence of politics and power in society inside the narrative text of Robert Penn Warren's "All the King's Men", which is similar to what is happening in our real world. It is hoped that this study contributes to extending the base of knowledge and enriches specifically the literature in this novel, and generally the field of political English novels.

ROBERT PENN WARREN: THOUGHT AND ORIENTATIONS

Robert Penn Warren (1905–1989), often referred to as "the national poet of America," was a distinguished scholar (serving as a professor at Yale University), an exceptional novelist, an influential critic, a notable intellectual, and a celebrated poet who earned recognition as a prolific writer with a major impact on American Literature. He was influential in shaping the New Criticism movement. Originating from Kentucky in the Southern United States, Warren had an impressive academic background. He released nearly one major work each year and also co-authored several publications. While his early writings reflected existing influences, his later works showcased a unique and personal style. He received both the Bollinger Prize and the Pulitzer Prize. Comparable to William Faulkner, Robert Penn Warren had a deep awareness of Southern culture. As a prominent voice of the South, he advocated for an escape from industrialism and a return to cultural values which were found in the South when it had an agrarian base. His focus on Southern traditions gave him a strong platform to explore "the drastic effects of the Civil War and Industrialism. Clara Juncker mentioned that at Yale University, in an interview in 1976 with Warren, "Bill Moyers introduces the

author as a rarity in American letters" because of his Pulitzer Prizes in both fiction and poetry" (Schatz-Jacobsen et al, 2015, P. 93).

While most critics of his works tend to concentrate on his biography and "narrative style, poetics, and writing style," the significance of politics in his writings should not be overlooked. Warren does not merely allude to politics in passing within his political fiction. Instead, he introduces various discourses that depict his characters grappling with "difficult moral and philosophical issues: the meaning of justice, the legitimacy of regimes, how government must accommodate the demands of human nature, and the difficulty of realising ideals in unfavourable circumstances" (Berryhill, 2000, p.5). This indicates a continual struggle between visionary ideals and practical realities. While Warren seems to advocate for a careful balance in both personal and public life, a recurring theme in his works is the failure of individuals to translate their private ideals or visions into concrete actions within the realm of public life.

According to Ogunrotimi et al., Warren was teaching at Louisiana State University when Huey Long was assassinated in 1935. Just as Stark, the lead character in Warren's novel, was targeted, Long was also killed by a physician at the state capitol. Huey Long was nicknamed Kingfish, and it's no mere coincidence that Warren's novel bears the title "All the King's Men." Although Warren attempted to distance himself from any direct link between Willie Stark and Huey Long, the parallels are compelling enough to cast doubt on his denial of influence. Warren was evidently troubled by the threat figures like Long posed to American democracy. Observing how easily Adolf Hitler and Benito Mussolini had dismantled democratic institutions in Europe, Warren quickly developed the theory that the United States might follow a similar trajectory if vigilance were not maintained. Huey Long's life provided Warren with a lens through which to analyze and critique American democracy. Robert Penn Warren maintained a deep and consistent interest in politics and its implications, and it is clear

that politics holds a central place in his literary work (Ogunrotimi et al., 2022).

ALL THE KING'S MEN: AN OVERVIEW AND SYNOPSIS

Marxist literary criticism interprets literature as a product shaped by the social structures and institutions of its time. In this view, writers are products of their societies, influencing and being influenced by them (Abbas, 2021). Published in 1946, Robert Penn Warren's "All the King's Men" reflects the major political developments of its time, focusing on the impact of power and politics on individuals and their pursuit of personal agendas and abuse of power leads to their downfall. While Warren consistently rejected any direct connection, most critics agree that the novel closely mirrors the life of Huey Long, the populist governor of Louisiana during the 1930s. Similar to Stark, Long was assassinated in 1935 by a doctor, although the real motives behind the murder were more ambiguous than those of the fictional Dr. Adam Stanton, the man who assassinated Stark at the capitol building. "All the King's Men" is not just a political novel; it also serves as a psychological and philosophical exploration of humanity confronted with power and corruption, as well as the effect of individual choices on society. Willie Stark, portrayed as a folksy fascist, serves as the governor of a southern state during the Great Depression. Jack Burden, a cunning political operator and loyal aide to "The Boss," is tasked with uncovering compromising information to eliminate anyone bold enough to challenge Stark. The intricate dynamics of their relationship propel the narrative of "All the King's Men." Warren's novel, which closely mirrors Huey Long's dominance over Louisiana, explores a grim possibility: what happens when a single individual exerts complete control over all branches of government? Ultimately, Willie Stark brings about his own downfall, severely impacts those around him, and inflicts lasting harm on both his state and its citizens. While "All the King's Men" offers many lessons, the most significant is its portrayal of political corruption. The behaviors of corrupt

political figures can be traced not only in literature, but also in real-world political landscapes (Smith & Lyons, 2022, p.83).

This political novel centers on the rise of the populist politician Willie Stark. He starts his journey as an idealistic lawyer with strong moral values, cautioning the public about the dangers of political corruption. The narrative opens with Willie Stark alerting citizens about a school constructed with inferior materials as a result of political corruption in Louisiana. Although he repeatedly warns of the school's structural issues, his concerns go unheeded. Consequently, his wife loses her job, and he is defeated in the election for county treasurer, a role he once held. Stark had been aware that G.H. Moore, the contractor, submitted the highest bid, but still secured the project due to connections with a county board member. Stark had cautioned that substandard materials were being used, but the company justified its higher expenses by asserting it employed white workers rather than using "dark-skinned laborers" like the less expensive firms. After his election loss, Stark returns to work on his father's farm. However, tragedy strikes when the school's emergency staircase collapses, killing three children and leaving many more paralyzed. The public then recalls Stark's earlier warnings, and he is hailed as a hero across the state. As the scandal unfolds, journalist Jack Burden arrives to report on the situation. In time, Jack becomes Stark's closest aide and serves as the narrator of the novel, recounting the entire story from his perspective.

Willie Stark launches his campaign for the governorship of Louisiana as a Democrat, not realizing that his candidacy is part of a scheme devised by Joe Harris to divide the rural vote and give MacMurphy the advantage. When Stark uncovers the manipulation, he is outraged and immediately drops out of the race. This incident leads to Stark getting drunk for the first time, signaling the onset of his ethical decline. The following day, he delivers a powerful speech that garners widespread admiration, in which he exposes MacMurphy's plot and announces his intention to run as an independent, distancing himself from Harris's political

circle. Speaking in plain, relatable language, he proclaims, "I'm a country man just like you." His speeches strike a strong chord with rural voters, greatly increasing his popularity and ultimately securing his election as governor of Louisiana. At this turning point, Jack Burden leaves his position at the newspaper, feeling that a single article cannot do justice to Stark's accomplishments. He then becomes Stark's chief political aide.

As governor, Stark begins delivering manipulative speeches to mobilize public support. He also assigns Jack the task of investigating the vulnerabilities and scandals of his political opponents, systematically removing them from power. Stark operates under the conviction that political success justifies any method, showing a willingness to abandon the ideals that once defined him in pursuit of his vision. He believes that achieving "good" outcomes sometimes requires committing "bad" actions, asserting that "good" is born from "evil" because there is no other source for it. At a major rally, he declares to the crowd, "Your will is my power," and "Your need is my justice." His emotionally resonant rhetoric positions him as a savior to the people, using a populist strategy that manipulates public sentiment. Despite the unethical nature of his actions, he maintains strong popularity through significant reforms, including the construction of schools and hospitals, which he claims are for the public good.

Beyond charting Willie Stark's political ascent and downfall, the novel delves into Jack Burden's personal evolution. As the narrator, Jack wrestles with the weight of his past, returning to his hometown to explore his family history, only to uncover painful truths about his mother and longtime friends. He is also caught in moral conflict due to his role in Stark's administration, especially when asked to exploit sensitive information against opponents. As the narrative unfolds, Stark finds himself trapped in a web of political and ethical crises, eventually provoking a coalition of enemies against him. Meanwhile, Anne Stanton—once romantically involved with Jack—becomes Stark's mistress, further complicating Jack's emotional turmoil. Stark grows distant

from his wife and son, showing interest in his son only during football games, as the boy plays on the team.

Stark's corruption is further revealed when his son is involved in a car accident that causes a girl's death, and Stark covers up the incident. At one point, Stark instructs Jack to look into the history of Judge Irwin, one of his main adversaries. Jack's investigation uncovers damaging secrets, which ultimately lead to the judge's suicide. As Stark continues to rationalize his corrupt behavior, the tensions around him grow. He finally reaches his goal of eliminating all his rivals and is acquitted of the charges against him in court, but just as this happens, he is assassinated by Adam Stanton, Anne Stanton's brother and one of his most determined opponents. Stark's assassination represents his ultimate downfall, ruining the lives of those around him, including Jack Burden, who is forced to face the brutal truths of the world and the corruption he helped perpetuate. Other significant characters in the novel include Anne Stanton, the daughter of a respected Southern family, who Burden loves but eventually becomes Stark's mistress; Adam Stanton, her brother and Burden's friend, a renowned surgeon who accepts a role as director of a medical center Stark is building; and Judge Irwin, who was once close to Burden in his youth but is later betrayed by him after becoming Stark's enemy. The plot, growing progressively more complex, concludes with a series of tragedies: Irwin takes his own life, and Burden learns that the man he helped ruin was, in fact, his father; Tom, who plays football while out of shape due to excess, suffers a fatal neck injury; and finally, Adam, upon discovering his sister's affair with Stark, kills him. However, Adam is immediately shot dead by Stark's bodyguard (Warren, 2006).

FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

It is appropriate to briefly highlight the concepts of politics, power, manipulation, and corruption that this study deals with to be an entry to this section in this paper. This will be a platform

that serves the analysis and paves the way for reaching the desired results of this study.

Politics plays a crucial role in shaping society, even if this isn't immediately apparent through intuition. Decisions surrounding life-and-death matters like war and peace are influenced by political ideologies and actions. The state is deeply embedded in daily life—impacting law and order, financial dealings, societal values, and the many ways people from different nations interact. Debates over what is considered right or wrong and the cultural identities that shape individuals' sense of self are also tied to political loyalties. Despite its significance, it can sometimes be challenging to define exactly what constitutes "the politics". Yet, it can be broadly understood that in day-to-day usage, the word "politics" refers to how nations are governed and how governments create laws and rules to effectively manage human societies. Political dynamics are also evident in other social structures such as organizations, institutions, businesses, clubs, educational settings, and religious institutions (Axford et al., 2005). The link between literature and politics, particularly political ideology, can be traced back to proletarian literature, where writing was used as a political tool to promote Marxist-Leninist Communist theory. Politics became a central theme in Soviet literature. Nevertheless, "the novel of politics found its way in Western culture, whether to criticize the totalitarian systems as that Nazism, Fascism and Stalinism, or the authoritarian bourgeoisie in the West, such novel responds to the modern situation of man and communities; it follows the rhythm of human impulse" (Abbas & Sandaran, 2019, p. 1148). This statement holds especially true for many English political novels produced during the modernist period.

Power, absolute authority, totalitarian regimes, and dictatorships are central themes explored in English novels in the modernist period, largely because power has a direct impact on people's lives across the globe. Power, as defined by Wrong, is often seen as "a

capacity to control or influence others", and as Abbas states, "the main forms of power are; force, manipulation, and persuasion" (Abbas, 2021, p. 45). In the domain of political science, "power is often defined as the ability to influence or control the behavior of others, whether through coercion, persuasion, or authority" (Rabinow, 2006, p. 201). Historically, the roots of power can be traced back to early human societies, where those with physical strength or strategic intelligence typically assumed leadership roles and influenced others. As human societies became more complex, power evolved into more organized and hierarchical forms through the establishment of political systems and institutions. These systems—such as monarchies or democracies—created structured ways for exercising power and distributing authority (Bar-Yam, 2018). Moreover, Abbas highlights that "History has shown evidence that among the main reasons that may affect breakdown or progress of a society or a state is the role of command, ruling class, or leadership and its leaders" (Abbas et al., 2021, p. 23).

Manipulation involves influencing others to adopt one's perspective and alter their views on certain topics to align with that of the speaker. This is often achieved through tools such as rhetoric, persuasion, and propaganda (Jewett & O'Donnell, 2012). Those in positions of power commonly utilize manipulation and propaganda—employing eloquent language—to mislead their communities. Ideology is deeply connected to power, often serving as a means to uphold and reinforce power. Van Dijk explains that "ideologies for Marx are related to manipulation" (2000, p.2). In this context, the dominant class's ideas are presented to the broader society in a way that makes them seem normal and natural (Sandaran, 2008). From a Marxist Literary Criticism standpoint, manipulation serves as a technique for analysing narrative literary works. Moreover, it acts as a linguistic strategy within Critical Discourse Analysis, which is used to analyse texts, including literary texts of political purposes.

Corruption is a complex concept that resists a universally accepted definition due to its involvement in nearly every aspect of life. It can be found in various domains, including political, social, religious, administrative, financial, educational, and moral spheres within a state or society. Nonetheless, Waite and Allen noted that studies focusing on police corruption offer a relatively straightforward definition, stating that "corruption is the misuse of public power for private and personal benefit" (2003, p.282). This research primarily addresses the political dimension of corruption, along with aspects of moral corruption. Corrupt governments deprive individuals and communities of their basic rights and freedoms. As a result, corruption contributes to the formation of dystopian societies and ultimately leads to social collapse. It reflects unethical or deceitful actions by people or organizations and can appear in different ways, including bribery and embezzlement. Political or governmental corruption occurs when officials exploit their positions for personal advantage. Abbas stated that "When a nation is ruled oppressively by a dictator based on his desires and interests, this type of government is known as totalitarianism. In such regime corruption is a definite consequence" (Abbas, 2025, p.6).

Above, the novel's author, his ideological and political leanings, the historical, political, and social context in which the novel was written, as well as the concepts of politics, power, manipulation, and corruption were examined. To achieve the study's objective and answer the research question posed by this study, which is: How does the influence of politics and power manifest in "All the King's Men"? The data (the narrative text under study) will be analysed by employing Marxist literary criticism as an analytical approach. The analysis will focus on several axes related to the key concepts addressed in this study: the influence of power in transforming an idealistic individual into an authoritarian figure, exposing the conflict between moral values and personal interests, which is embodied by the struggle of characters, the direct and indirect impact of politics on individuals and society, and to which

extent people in power practise corruption to achieve their personal desires and goals.

Warren's novel "All the King's Men" is mainly a politically focused story, with politics and power playing a central role throughout the narrative. The story traces the ascent and eventual downfall of Willie Stark, a populist figure who leverages his power to manipulate and dominate those around him in pursuit of his political goals. It centers on political developments, portraying the journey of a sincere and well-meaning man from the general population who rises to become the Governor of Louisiana. The novel delves into how power and authority gradually lead him to forsake his ideals and engage in corrupt practices to retain control. The narrative is presented through the perspective of journalist Jack Burden, who reflects on the past to detail the transformation of Louisiana's governor into a completely different person. Moreover, the novel illustrates how power affects Jack Burden as well, turning him into an instrument for Willie Stark—carrying out his orders and uncovering damaging information about Stark's rivals to help secure Stark's ongoing grip on power. The novel depicts Willie's transformation from an ordinary individual into a dominant political figure who relies on blackmail and manipulation to maintain his authority. Simultaneously, Jack discovers hidden truths about his own background and family, offering deeper insight into how power shapes the connection between individuals and society. The story underscores the significant consequences that result from corruption and unchecked ambition. Through a Marxist lens, Willie Stark symbolizes the ruling class, utilizing his authoritative role to exploit and dominate the ruled classes for personal benefit. Stark's manipulation of the political system, along with his ability to influence the public through propaganda and rhetoric, illustrates how those in positions of power exercise their dominance to preserve their control over society.

James Madison (2009) remarked, "But what is government itself, but the greatest of all reflections on human nature? If men were

angels, no government would be necessary" (Federalist No. 51). Madison's viewpoint is reasonable and compelling; however, government should fundamentally exist to serve its citizens and promote the collective well-being. An ideal government ensures the prosperity of its people, safeguards individual rights and freedoms, adheres to the Constitution and legal frameworks, and operates with transparency and integrity. Corruption—both political and moral—stems from the misuse of power; though power itself is not inherently negative if used to advance justice, freedom, and the public good. Nevertheless, the government depicted through Governor Stark in "All the King's Men" fails to embody the principles Madison envisioned.

Willie Stark embodies the highest level of power in Louisiana, and his relentless drive to hold onto that position causes him to lose sight of the true meaning of leadership. He loses sight of the fact that his responsibility is to serve the very citizens who placed their trust in him through their votes, hoping he would restore their state. Instead, he neglects his political promises, including his vow to help the people and work towards a dignified life for the citizens. He persists in delivering manipulative speeches aimed at misleading the public and solidifying his control. When it comes to politically conscious individuals who see through his deceptions, he does not permit them the freedom to challenge him. Rather, he collects damaging information about them, using their vulnerabilities as tools to silence them and eliminate dissent.

Warren's detailed narrative design and carefully ordered events, when viewed in context with the political climate of his era, expose the undeniable impact of politics on both individuals and society. Willie's slogans served merely as political theater, designed to advance his private agenda. His well-known phrase, "The people's will is the law in this state," was nothing more than an empty slogan—similar to the kind the public had grown used to hearing. Sadly, even today, we are often exposed to similarly inflated rhetoric that fails to ease hardship or deliver actual progress. The public frequently believes these claims, not realizing

that those in power have no intention of honoring such pledges—because doing so would jeopardize their own hold on authority. After all, why would they take actions that could threaten their dominance?

An analysis of Willie Stark's behavior and his shift from one identity to another in his unyielding quest for power demonstrates that the lure of power changed Stark and drove him to take steps he never anticipated. He acted solely to preserve his "intoxicating power." Warren skillfully portrays this shift in Stark's personality with great precision. Early in the novel, Stark, during a conversation with his aide, Joe Harris, declines to drink wine, firmly adhering to his strong ethical beliefs. Yet, once in office, Willie not only begins to drink heavily but also experiences a profound change, including in how he interacts with his wife, father, and only son. His insatiable drive for power eventually results in his son's paralysis and later death. This underscores how power impacts not just the governor personally but also deeply affects everyone around him, including the society he governs.

When reflecting on the idea of corruption, the first thoughts that typically arise involve money, along with images of bribery and embezzlement. One might envision a politician, judge, officer, or corporate executive accepting a bribe in return for performing an illegal act that, in some form, ties back to their official responsibilities—providing an unlawful service or benefit to a particular party at the expense of both the law and the public good. In reality, corruption appears in many forms and extends beyond financial misconduct. It closely reflects the essence of political power and how it can be abused, as demonstrated through Stark in "All the King's Men".

Numerous events throughout the novel illustrate Stark's corruption. Byram B. White, one of "Stark's boys," serves as the State Auditor and becomes entangled in an investigation. White is exploiting his position to unlawfully enrich himself, and Stark is presented with two options. He can step back and allow the legal system to proceed, in which case White will likely lose his post

and face prison time—an outcome that would deal Stark a political blow. Alternatively, Stark can shield the guilty White, ensuring his continued loyalty, and employ every tool at his disposal—“legal and illegal”—to halt the investigation and evade justice. For Stark, this choice is simple. The Governor’s Attorney General, whose role is to uphold the law in the state, urges Stark to make the ethical decision, especially since White’s guilt is clear. However, Stark refuses. He takes deliberate action to protect White, and ultimately, White emerges unscathed. Yet soon, Stark himself faces the threat of investigation and impeachment. He overcomes this crisis because he and his associates, such as Jack Burden, have spent years collecting compromising material on potential adversaries. Stark uses this information as leverage, threatening to expose scandalous business dealings, secret affairs, and personal vices. He puts it bluntly to his opponents: "This is your last chance...do you know what I can do to you?" Ultimately, they give in to Stark's demands.

Stark shows no concern for justice or the governmental structures intended to uphold it. Although the state constitution provides impeachment as a safeguard against dangerous governors, Stark does whatever it takes to stay in power—even if it means acting unlawfully—because, to him, it is “necessary.” For Stark and other corrupt leaders, the law holds no true value. Regulations are meaningless to them. Judges can be intimidated or bought off, and laws can be dismissed or rewritten depending on what serves their agenda. As Stark puts it, "The best you can do is; do something and then make up some law to fit". In "All the King’s Men", Stark’s corruption is deeply tied to his own egocentrism. He sees himself as the focal point of existence, and everything around him must conform to his desires and serve his personal gratification. When Jack Burden, in a moment of introspection, is asked to define Governor Stark, he reveals that Stark’s motivations go beyond wealth, lust, or even political influence. Ultimately, "He’s interested in Stark" (Smith & Lyons, 2022).

A critical analysis of "All the King's Men" by Robert Penn Warren, with an emphasis on politics and power, can investigate how ambition, corruption, and the pursuit of authority impact both public and private lives. Through a Marxist lens, the novel reveals how political institutions, class struggles, and economic forces shape individuals and societal values. Warren's depiction of Willie Stark's ascent illustrates the exploitative and class-based nature of political systems, showing how even populist agendas—though appearing to serve the people—can become tools of control. Stark comes to power by appealing to the working class. He is presenting himself as a self-made defender of the average person against the corrupt elite. However, from a Marxist perspective, this populism is merely performative: while claiming to elevate the lower classes, Stark ultimately mirrors the very power structures he once criticised. His rhetoric serves not to revolutionize but to entrench his authority, aligning with Marx's concept of false consciousness, wherein the working class is deceived into supporting a system that sustains their subjugation. Stark capitalizes on this illusion, maintaining dominance while appearing to champion the people.

The novel emphasizes the role of economic conditions in shaping political behavior. Willie Stark's political success is not rooted in moral integrity or democratic principles, but in his ability to control resources, distribute favors, and manipulate systems of patronage. Power operates through transactions. Characters act primarily out of material self-interest—an idea central to Marxist theory. For instance, Jack Burden's involvement in Stark's political maneuvers illustrates how personal ethics are often overshadowed by the need to survive within an oppressive economic and political system. Rather than viewing corruption solely as a personal failing, a Marxist reading interprets it as a structural feature of capitalist politics. Stark's evolution from an idealistic attorney to a power-driven governor reflects how revolutionary ideals can be absorbed and distorted by capitalist systems, ultimately serving as instruments of domination. Even

those who enter politics with genuine intentions are forced into ethical compromises by the demands of maintaining power. Jack Burden, as narrator, embodies the tension between personal conscience and the pressures of a corrupt system. His participation in both revealing and concealing truths for Stark underscores how intellectual labor is shaped by class dynamics. His background in history and education becomes a tool for legitimizing political agendas. From a Marxist standpoint, this reflects how ideology is perpetuated through cultural and intellectual institutions that serve the interests of the ruling class.

A Marxist interpretation of "All the King's Men" suggests that Robert Penn Warren is doing more than narrating the downfall of a morally compromised politician—he is critiquing how capitalist political systems sustain inequality, disguise oppression with populist language, and trap both leaders and citizens in ongoing cycles of dominance, manipulation, and corruption. In the novel, power is not merely an individual pursuit; it is deeply rooted in economic forces and structural class divisions that underpin American democracy.

Eventually, the detrimental impacts of politics and power on Stark, those around him, and the society he governs can be outlined as follows:

- * Once Stark assumed the role of governor, Stark engaged in manipulation by delivering "misleading speeches to the masses." These "emotionally charged speeches" enabled him to take advantage of the public's emotions, successfully deceiving them and creating the impression that Stark was "loyal to them." This perception provided him with a means to rationalise his unethical and unlawful behaviour as being carried out "in the public's best interest."

- * As a governor, Stark engaged in clear political and moral corruption by using "illegal and immoral means" to target and eliminate his political rivals. These unethical tactics involved investigating the "personal and professional histories" of his

opponents to find "weaknesses, scandals, and secrets," then using those findings to "blackmail or defame them" with the aim of removing them. In doing so, Stark came to embrace "the Machiavellian principle that the end justifies the means," which illustrates his complete rejection of the "noble principles and values of virtue" he once upheld.

* Stark's decline in moral and political integrity was evident through his involvement in numerous political conflicts of illegal aims, which eventually caused his enemies to "unite against him".

* Stark instructs Jack to investigate the past of Judge Irwin, one of his political adversaries, with the intention of uncovering "humiliating secrets" about Irwin in order to "defame the judge". This action ultimately results in the judge's suicide.

* Stark's "opportunistic and immoral" approach in the Byram affair further reveals his corruption. Byram B. White, one of "Stark's boys," holds the position of State Auditor and becomes the subject of an investigation due to enriching himself through the "embezzling [of] public funds." Stark intervenes by using his influence to halt the investigation and protect Byram from facing consequences. He does so to avoid a "political shock," since Byram is a loyal Stark supporter, and also to later "exploit and blackmail Byram" to guarantee his continued loyalty.

* Stark concealed and covered up the car accident involving his son, despite the fact that the crash resulted in the death of a young woman. He did this both to protect his son from facing consequences and to preserve "Stark's political reputation".

* Stark committed a deep moral betrayal against his close friend and confidant, Jack, by taking Anne as his mistress—even though he was fully aware that Jack was already "romantically involved with Anne Stanton".

* Upon rising to power, Stark shifted from being a man guided by values and principles to becoming "an opportunist and selfish person," and from someone honest to a "corrupt governor." His overwhelming selfishness led him deeper into moral decay. As

governor, Stark ceased to care about anything beyond himself: "He's interested in Stark".

CONCLUSION

The study explored several key areas related to the main ideas discussed: how power can transform an idealistic person into an authoritarian figure, the clash between ethical convictions and self-interest as reflected in character struggles, the visible and hidden effects of politics on individuals and society, and the degree to which those in authority commit corruption to achieve their own objectives. The findings illustrated that power significantly altered Willie Stark's character, turning him from a man of integrity into a corrupt governor who would abandon the principles of just governance to retain his power. As the governor, Stark betrayed the everyday people who had placed their trust in him and voted for him, using manipulative speeches to tighten his grip on power. As a result, the analysis fulfilled the aim of uncovering the influence of politics and power in Robert Penn Warren's "All the King's Men". Through the lens of Marxist criticism, the study revealed that Robert Penn Warren was shaped by the political climate of his time, as the novel portrays a setting where political candidates make bold pledges to support the disadvantaged and marginalized. Yet, once they attain power, they fall prey to its allure, abandoning those promises and focusing mainly on holding onto their power. Ultimately, the study concludes that Robert Penn Warren's "All the King's Men" offers a bleak portrayal of human nature, highlighting its vulnerability to moral decline and corruption when influenced by politics and power, as well as its role in transforming an idealistic individual into an authoritarian figure. Despite the presence of a democratic system in the fictional state Warren describes, the narrative demonstrates how elections can result in the rise of a dictator who is far removed from the rules of democratic governance. In essence, what unfolds in Warren's "All the King's Men" serves as a

mirror to political realities witnessed in numerous countries around our real world.

Religion and Theocracy in Margaret Atwood's The Handmaid's Tale

ABSTRACT

Merging religion with state power in theocratic society, particularly in relation to gender and class oppression results in ominous socio-political consequences. Driven by this idea, this paper attempted to render a critical reading of Atwood's dystopian novel, "The Handmaid's Tale", as religion and theocracy play central roles in shaping the oppressive regime of Gilead. The primary aim of the study is to examine how Margaret Atwood's "The Handmaid's Tale" critiques the exploitation of religion as a means of enforcing totalitarian control and suppressing gender, and to examine the novel's depiction of political and social dynamics within a theocratic society. The study adopted a qualitative, interpretive methodology grounded in literary criticism and Marxist criticism to examine the portrayal of religion and theocracy in the narrative text. The findings of this study asserted that Atwood revealed the dangers of theocratic rule and challenges readers to consider how religious and political discourses can intersect to sustain systems of oppression. The final conclusion of this study is that religion is used to maintain totalitarian control and enforce gender-based subjugation within a theocratic society inside the narrative text under study. The significance of the current study lies in exposing the socio-political consequences of merging religion with state power, particularly in relation to gender and class oppression in theocratic society in Margaret Atwood's "The Handmaid's Tale". It is hoped that this study contributes to extending the base of knowledge and enriches specifically the literature in this novel, and generally the field of dystopian English novels.

Keywords: Religion, Theocracy, Policy, Patriarchy, Bible, Reproduction, Margaret Atwood, "The Handmaid's Tale"

INTRODUCTION

The value of literature is based on the hypothesis that literary works and art must be served in struggling against the system of vice and corruption as an effective means. Thus, dystopian literature emerged as a new genre of literature. It is a narrative genre that is used by modern novelists to unmask the dark aspects of people's lives caused by evil powers and oppressors (Abbas, 2025). The modern novel in English literature became more realistic, immediate, and widely read than those of earlier periods because, rather than depending solely on imagination, it grappled with major events that influenced the world and Literature (Abbas, 2021). In Atwood's dystopian novel, "The Handmaid's Tale", religion and theocracy play central roles in shaping the oppressive regime of Gilead. The governance in Gilead is totalitarian and theocratic, "where the inhuman political ideologies have been exercised by this totalitarian regime, which cause physical, mental and psychological torment of the individuals and the society, in order to retain power" (ABBAS, 2021, p.44). The novel depicts a theocratic society where the government is grounded in a radical interpretation of the Bible, and religious doctrines justify the total control of women's bodies and lives. The regime uses religious rhetoric to legitimize its actions, particularly the institutionalized enslavement of women as "Handmaids" who are forced to bear children for the ruling class. The novel presents the protagonist, and ostensible narrator, Offred, experiencing her daily existence under the regime of a bourgeois theocracy governed by religious fundamentalists. Sociologically, Atwood's narrative text proves useful for analyzing themes through the lens of Marxist theory. However, the world depicted in "The Handmaid's Tale" is a dystopian nightmare which subjugates the proletariat. On Offred's studying the system of the Gilead, she questions the dominant hegemony of the Gileadan leaders. This leads to

conclude that she belongs to the proletariat. By exposing the lies of the Gilead and the hypocrisy of its leaders, the novel removes the veil from the cleverly disguised bourgeoisie. Offred reveals the control exercised by the bourgeois religious authorities who have confined her and the other handmaids. This narrative text could be analysed through Marxist analysis. The society portrayed in "The Handmaid's Tale" is built upon the principles of the ruling bourgeois class in American culture, who possess complete control over the means of production. Society of Gilead is obviously split into two social classes: upper class (the bourgeoisie), and lower class (the proletariat). It is the handmaids who represent the proletariat (Roozbeh, 2018).

The problem of this study has been formulated by considering the political and social situation due to the theocratic regime where religion is employed to legitimize totalitarian control and gender-based subjugation in Margaret Atwood's "The Handmaid's Tale". Based on this problem, the main objective of the study is to explore how Margaret Atwood's "The Handmaid's Tale" critiques the use of religion as a tool for totalitarian governance and gender oppression, and to examine the novel's depiction of political and social dynamics within a theocratic society. In order to address the research problem and objective of the study, a research question emerges to guide this study, which is: How does "The Handmaid's Tale" portray the use of religion to justify totalitarian control and enforce gender-based subjugation within a theocratic society? By conducting critical analysis of the selected novel of Margaret Atwood's "The Handmaid's Tale", the current paper attempts to provide a deep understanding of the use of religion to maintain totalitarian control and enforce gender-based subjugation within a theocratic society inside the narrative text of the novel under study. This study adopts a qualitative, interpretive methodology grounded in literary criticism and Marxist criticism to examine the portrayal of religion and theocracy in "The Handmaid's Tale". As an entry to the analysis, it will be appropriate to briefly highlight the concepts of Religion,

Theocracy, Policy, Patriarchy, Bible, and Reproduction that this study deals with. This will be a platform that serves the analysis and paves the way for reaching the desired results of this study. The findings of this study assert that Atwood reveals the dangers of theocratic rule and challenges readers to consider how religious and political discourses can intersect to sustain systems of oppression. The findings also provide a clear insight of how "The Handmaid's Tale" critiques the manipulation of religion as a tool of ideological domination practised by theocratic rule. The final conclusion of this study is that religion is used to maintain totalitarian control and enforce gender-based subjugation within a theocratic society inside the narrative text under study. The significance of the current study lies in exposing the socio-political consequences of merging religion with state power, particularly in relation to gender and class oppression in theocratic society in Margaret Atwood's "The Handmaid's Tale". It is hoped that this study contributes to extending the base of knowledge and enriches specifically the literature in this novel, and generally the field of dystopian English novels.

MARGARET ATWOOD: THOUGHT AND ORIENTATIONS

Margaret Atwood, a prolific Canadian writer born in Ottawa in 1939, has gained international recognition for her literary contributions across a wide range of genres, including fiction, poetry, nonfiction, and children's literature. Atwood earned her Bachelor of Arts in English from Victoria College at the University of Toronto in 1961, and went on to study for a master's degree at Radcliffe College in Cambridge, Massachusetts. She has also received several honorary degrees, with Harvard University being one of the institutions that awarded her this recognition (Deboranti & Wedati, 2020). Atwood's works often reflect her deep engagement with themes such as gender, power, environmentalism, and social justice, and her ideological leanings can be traced through these themes.

Atwood's writing exhibits strong feminist views, particularly in her exploration of female characters and their agency in oppressive environments. Her most famous work, *The Handmaid's Tale* (1985), is a dystopian novel that critiques patriarchal structures by imagining a future society where women's rights are severely restricted. Atwood's portrayal of the subjugation of women in this novel and other works reveals her concerns about the potential erosion of women's rights in contemporary society, particularly in relation to reproductive freedom (Atwood, 1985). Her feminist ideology is not solely concerned with victimhood, however; Atwood's characters often challenge or subvert these systems, asserting autonomy and resilience in oppressive settings (Moore, 2005).

Moreover, Atwood's works convey an overarching concern for environmental issues, especially climate change and ecological degradation. In her *Madd Addam* trilogy (2003–2013), Atwood examines the consequences of environmental destruction, genetic manipulation, and corporate greed, presenting a vision of a future that serves as a cautionary tale about humanity's disregard for the planet. Her environmental ideology, rooted in ecological awareness, aligns her with contemporary ecological movements, which advocate for sustainable living and the preservation of natural resources (Atwood, 2009; Barry, 2015).

Atwood's political and ideological views are also marked by her critique of power structures. She often uses satire to highlight the ways in which political, social, and economic systems can exploit vulnerable populations. Atwood's involvement in activism further reflects her commitment to progressive causes, particularly her support for women's rights, Indigenous rights, and the fight against climate change. In addition to her literary achievements, Atwood's work in the public sphere as an advocate for these issues showcases her alignment with a broad, left-leaning political ideology that prioritizes equality, social justice, and environmental sustainability (Atwood, 2015; Rupp, 2018)

In summary, Margaret Atwood's ideological leanings are deeply influenced by her feminist perspectives, environmental concerns, and political critique of power structures. Through her expansive body of work, she not only captures the nuances of human experience but also engages with critical social issues, contributing to ongoing conversations about gender, the environment, and politics.

THE HANDMAID'S TALE: AN OVERVIEW AND SYNOPSIS

In "The Handmaid's Tale", religion and theocracy are central to the oppressive regime of Gilead, where a radical interpretation of the Bible justifies the control of women's bodies and lives. The regime distorts religious values, using them to enforce patriarchal practices, such as the enslavement of women as "Handmaids" to bear children for the ruling class. This manipulation of religious authority serves as a critique of how faith can be used to legitimize social inequality and oppression, particularly against women (Atwood, 1985). Critics praise the novel for its chilling portrayal of a society where autonomy, surveillance, and control are tied to religious extremism and authoritarianism. Atwood's writing serves as a feminist critique of patriarchal systems, cautioning against the risks of political passivity and the gradual loss of freedoms, particularly those related to women's reproductive rights. Through Gilead's theocratic regime, the novel underscores the dehumanization of individuals and the risks of combining religion with political power (Staels, 1995)

Offred, the novel's protagonist and storyteller, lives as a Handmaid in Gilead, a rigidly theocratic dictatorship that replaced the former United States. Belonging to the class of fertile women, she is forced to conceive children for affluent but infertile couples. Her current posting is with Commander Fred Waterford—one of Gilead's original architects—and his wife, Serena Joy, a former gospel singer who treats the Handmaids in her home with cold cruelty. In Gilead, a Handmaid's identity is tied to the Commander she serves; they adopt names beginning with "Of," hence Offred.

Although she recalls her true name, she never speaks it aloud. Each month, Offred undergoes a ceremonial act of intercourse with the Commander, while Serena grips her hands. Her existence is strictly confined—her movements are monitored, her bedroom door never fully shuts, and she leaves the house only to shop, all under the constant watch of the “Eyes,” Gilead’s secret police. Through her narration, she alternates between present experiences and memories of the past, gradually revealing how the regime came to power.

Before Gilead’s rise, Offred had an affair with Luke, who left his first wife to marry her, and together they had a daughter. She was raised by her mother, a committed feminist, and was close to Moira, her outspoken college friend who valued independence but was later forced into prostitution under the new regime. Gilead emerged during a period of societal decay marked by rampant pornography, prostitution, and violence toward women, alongside dangerously low birth rates caused by pollution and toxic chemicals. The regime’s founders seized this opportunity, assassinating government leaders and claiming temporary authority. Once in control, they stripped women of basic rights, forbidding them to work or own property. When Offred and her family tried to escape to Canada, they were caught and separated, and she has not seen her husband or daughter since (Atwood, 1985).

After being captured, Offred’s marriage to Luke was invalidated because his previous divorce made it illegal under Gilead’s laws. She was taken to the Red Center, where women were trained to adopt the principles of the new regime. The Aunts, a group of women loyal to the regime, were responsible for training the Handmaids to obey and accept their reproductive roles. Aunt Lydia, one of the leading figures at the Red Center, oversaw this process, insisting that Gilead’s system provided women with greater security and respect than the old society. During this period, Moira also arrived but managed to escape, leaving Offred uncertain of what became of her.

Once assigned to the Commander's household, Offred's life settled into a rigid routine: she shopped with her walking partner, Ofglen—later revealed as a member of the secret Mayday resistance—passed by the Wall lined with the corpses of executed rebels, underwent regular medical examinations, and participated in the Ceremony, a ritual in which the Commander had intercourse with her as Serena Joy watched. Her routine shifted when a doctor privately offered to impregnate her, implying the Commander might be sterile; she refused out of fear. Soon afterward, the Commander began inviting her to clandestine meetings where they played Scrabble, looked at forbidden magazines, and he requested kisses. During one of her outings, Ofglen revealed her involvement with Mayday. Offred's perception of the Ceremony changed once she began to see the Commander as a person. In their secret conversations, he attempted to justify Gilead's oppressive laws as necessary for societal survival (Atwood, 1985). When Offred still does not conceive, Serena Joy proposes that she sleep with Nick and pass any resulting pregnancy off as the Commander's. As an incentive, Serena offers her a photograph of her daughter, revealing that she has always known the child's whereabouts. That night, the Commander secretly brings Offred to Jezebel's, a private club where Commanders meet with prostitutes. There, she encounters Moira, who had been captured after her escape and chose life at Jezebel's over exile in the Colonies. Offred never sees Moira again after this meeting. The Commander later takes Offred to a hotel, where they have sex, and she pretends to enjoy the encounter. When she returns, Serena arranges for Offred to meet with Nick, a Guardian who works as the Commander's driver and gardener. This arrangement grows into a secret affair, and Offred becomes emotionally attached to Nick, gradually disengaging from her collaboration with Ofglen and the Mayday resistance.

Eventually, Serena discovers Offred's illicit trip to Jezebel's and threatens her with consequences. Soon after, a van belonging to the Eyes arrives at the house. Nick tells her it is actually Mayday

coming to rescue her. Offred leaves with the men, uncertain whether she is being freed or arrested. The novel closes with an epilogue set in 2195, where Professor Pieixoto delivers a lecture on Gilead. He explains that Offred's account was preserved on cassette tapes and speculates that Nick may have aided her escape, though her ultimate fate is never confirmed (Atwood, 1985).

FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

It is appropriate to briefly highlight the concepts of Religion, Theocracy, Policy, Patriarchy, Bible, and Reproduction that this study deals with to be an entry to this section in this paper. This will be a platform that serves the analysis and paves the way for reaching the desired results of this study.

Religion: In "The Handmaid's Tale", religion is used as a tool of oppression. The regime of Gilead is based on a distorted interpretation of Christian scripture. Religious language, rituals, and symbols are employed to justify the subjugation of women and the extreme control over their bodies and lives..... "The Bible is kept locked up, the way people once kept tea locked up, so the servants wouldn't steal it" (Atwood, 1985, p. 99). This illustrates how religious texts are manipulated and withheld to limit knowledge and enforce obedience.

Theocracy: A theocracy is a form of governance where authority is held by religious figures who claim to act on behalf of a divine power. In Gilead, laws and social norms are dictated by a theocratic regime that claims divine authority. There is no separation between church and state, and dissent is punished severely..... "The Republic of Gilead, said Aunt Lydia, knows no bounds. Gilead is within you"(Atwood, 1985, p. 23). This quote reflects the internalization of religious authority promoted by the regime.

Policy: Policy in Gilead is built upon extreme religious doctrine and serves to enforce strict societal roles. Policies determine how women are categorized (e.g., Handmaids, Wives, Marthas) and control every aspect of life, including dress, movement, and

reproduction..... "Better never means better for everyone... It always means worse, for some" (Atwood, 1985, p. 211). This highlights how Gilead's policies prioritize control and hierarchy over fairness or equality.

Patriarchy: The social order in Gilead is built upon the principles of "Patriarchy". Men hold all political, religious, and social power, while women are reduced to roles based on fertility and obedience. The system is designed to benefit men and limit women's autonomy..... "We were the people who were not in the papers. We lived in the blank white spaces at the edges of print. It gave us more freedom. We lived in the gaps between the stories" (Atwood, 1985, p. 57). This quote captures how women's voices are erased in a patriarchal regime.

Bible: In Gilead, "The Bible" is interpreted in a selective and manipulative manner. Only certain passages—primarily those that support the regime's policies—are read and quoted. For example, the story of Rachel and Bilhah is used to justify the use of Handmaids for reproduction..... "Give me children, or else I die. [...] Behold my maid Bilhah. She shall bear upon my knees, that I may also have children by her" (Atwood, 1985, p. 88). This biblical justification is central to Gilead's system of forced reproduction.

Reproduction: In Gilead, "Reproduction" is regarded as the most important role a woman can fulfill. Fertile women are forced into the role of Handmaids and expected to produce children for elite families. Reproduction is state-controlled, and women are treated as vessels rather than individuals..... "We are for breeding purposes: we aren't concubines, geisha girls, courtesans. On the contrary: everything we do is for the good of others" (Atwood, 1985, p. 146). This highlights how women's reproductive capabilities are commodified.

Literary Criticism, or traditional literary analysis, is employed to investigate how Atwood constructs Gilead's religious and political systems through narrative techniques, imagery, and character perspectives. The Republic of Gilead constructs a state apparatus

deeply rooted in selectively interpreted and decontextualized biblical doctrine, using religious rhetoric to suppress dissent, erase female agency, and institutionalize patriarchal dominance. Despite invoking sacred texts, the regime distorts Christian principles to serve political and ideological ends. This raises important questions about the intersection of religion and political authority, and how theological constructs can be appropriated to sustain repressive state power. This theocratic paradigm and the implications help for understanding the potential misuse of religion in political systems.

In "The Handmaid's Tale", Margaret Atwood constructs the dystopian regime of the Republic of Gilead as a theocratic state that systematically appropriates religious doctrine to enforce authoritarian rule. Central to Gilead's ideological foundation is its selective and decontextualized use of biblical scripture. The regime invokes passages such as Genesis 30:1–3—where Rachel offers her handmaid to Jacob to bear children on her behalf—as divine justification for the forced surrogacy system that strips women of their autonomy (Atwood, 1998). However, Atwood's narrative reveals that Gilead's leaders deliberately misinterpret and manipulate such texts to legitimize patriarchal dominance and suppress dissent.

This misuse of scripture reflects what scholars describe as "scriptural authoritarianism", in which religious texts are co-opted by political powers not for spiritual guidance but for social control (Knutsen, 2007). Gilead's religious rhetoric masks its underlying goal: the consolidation of male power through the institutionalization of gender hierarchy. Women are classified into rigid roles—Wives, Marthas, Handmaids, Aunts—each defined by their relation to male authority and reproductive capacity. As Offred asserts, "We are two-legged wombs, that's all: sacred vessels, ambulatory chalices" (Atwood, 1998, p. 136). The sacred language employed here underscores the sacrilegious distortion of Christian symbols to serve totalitarian ends. Despite Gilead's frequent invocation of God and scripture, the regime lacks genuine

spiritual values such as compassion, humility, or love. As Fiorenza (1995) argues, feminist biblical interpretation reveals how patriarchal institutions often misuse scripture to justify oppression, even though the texts themselves may hold liberatory potential. Atwood appears to draw on such critiques to show how religion, when politicized, can become an instrument of domination rather than moral guidance.

This raises important questions about the intersection of religion and authoritarianism. Gilead functions as a cautionary tale that dramatizes the potential for theological constructs to be co-opted into systems of political control. The regime's power depends on its ability to obscure brutality under the veil of divine will, making resistance appear not only illegal but sinful. Moss notes that Gilead's ideological apparatus relies heavily on "ritualized language and performative piety", which suppresses independent thought and promotes obedience (Moss, 2008, p.168). Atwood's depiction of Gilead encourages a deeper examination of how religious language is employed in actual authoritarian regimes. The novel's dystopian landscape reflects contemporary concerns about the political misuse of theology, offering a compelling lens through which to examine the entanglement of religion and state power.

Traditional literary analysis explores Atwood's use of narrative, imagery, symbolism, and character development. It reveals how religious discourse is embedded in the text and how Atwood uses language to reveal the contradictions between religious rhetoric and political oppression. For instance, close textual analysis examines the significance of biblical allusions, ritual language (e.g., "Blessed be the fruit"), and the renaming of women to signify ownership (e.g., "Offred" meaning "Of Fred") as literary strategies that reveal the loss of identity and autonomy. Additionally, the novel's first-person narration is a key to understanding Offred's psychological struggle to maintain her identity in a system that denies her subjectivity. Her fragmented

memories and reflective tone serve as a counter-narrative to Gilead's dominant discourse.

The main conflict in "The Handmaid's Tale" centers on Offred's struggle to maintain her identity under Gilead's brutal regime. This conflict unfolds across three timelines. In the present, she tries to see herself as a person despite being reduced to a reproductive tool by the Commander and his Wife. In flashbacks to the Red Center, she resists the psychological control of the Aunts, who train Handmaids to accept their loss of autonomy. In memories of her past life with her mother, Moira, and Luke, she reflects on how the struggle between male control and female independence existed even before Gilead. Offred remains largely passive throughout the novel. She takes small chances to assert herself—speaking with Moira, meeting the Commander in secret—but never openly rebels. Her quiet resistance contrasts with others: her mother, who joined feminist protests; Moira, who escaped the Red Center; and Ofglen, who was part of the Mayday resistance. Offred's defiance is subtle—holding onto her memories and bearing witness to her reality. The novel suggests that even this small form of resistance is meaningful and reflects the limits faced by many living under oppression.

In "The Handmaid's Tale", religion and theocracy play central roles in shaping the oppressive regime of Gilead. The novel depicts a theocratic society where the government is grounded in a radical interpretation of the Bible, and religious doctrines justify the total control of women's bodies and lives. The regime uses religious rhetoric to legitimize its actions, particularly the institutionalized enslavement of women as "Handmaids" who are forced to bear children for the ruling class. Theocratic rule in *The Handmaid's Tale* is portrayed as a distortion of religious values, where the Bible is selectively quoted to reinforce patriarchal and authoritarian practices. Women are denied access to education, employment, and personal autonomy, under the guise of religious virtue. The regime's leaders claim that they are restoring divine order, yet their interpretation of the scriptures is conveniently

aligned with their desire for power and control. This theocratic framework serves as a critique of how religion can be manipulated to justify social and political inequality. Atwood critiques the use of religious authority to suppress women's rights, drawing a parallel to real-world examples where religion has been wielded to enforce gender roles and oppression. The novel's exploration of religion also highlights the tension between personal faith and institutionalized dogma. Characters like Offred, the protagonist, engage with religious ideas in complex ways—sometimes as a form of resistance, other times as a survival mechanism. In the world of Gilead, faith is weaponized, and those who deviate from the prescribed religious norms are punished, further reinforcing the authoritarian state.

Overall, "The Handmaid's Tale" underscores the dangers of combining religion with political power, showing how it can become a tool for control and the erosion of individual rights. Through its depiction of a theocratic regime, it explores the dehumanization that occurs when people are reduced to mere tools for procreation. Its significance lies in how it resonates with ongoing struggles for gender equality and freedom. "The Handmaid's Tale" is often seen as a cautionary tale about the dangers of complacency in the face of growing political and social oppression. It has remained relevant across generations, especially in times of political unrest or threats to civil liberties.

Drawing on Marxist literary theory, this study exposes how Gilead functions as a class-based society masked by religious ideology. Handmaids, Marthas, and Econowives are positioned within a rigid hierarchy that benefits the ruling elite (e.g., Commanders and Wives), while religious doctrine is used to justify their labor and subjugation. In this context, religion serves the role Marx identified as the "opium of the people" (Marx, 1844), delivering a deceptive sense of purpose that obscures the underlying exploitation and loss of power. By using a Marxist critical lens, the study interrogates the ways in which religion in

Gilead functions as an ideological tool to maintain class and gender.

From a Marxist perspective, "The Handmaid's Tale" can be understood as a critique of capitalist class oppression transposed into a theocratic regime that masks economic exploitation under religious ideology. Margaret Atwood, in *Republic of Gilead*, presents a class-stratified society in which economic power and reproductive labor are tightly controlled by the ruling elite. The regime constructs a rigid hierarchy that mirrors capitalist modes of production, where individuals are reduced to their utility, particularly reproductive capacity in the case of Handmaids.

In Marxist terms, the Handmaids function as an exploited labor class—stripped of autonomy, denied ownership of their bodies, and forced to reproduce for the ruling elite, similar to the way the proletariat generates surplus value for the bourgeoisie. Their work—biological reproduction—is commodified, though disguised as a divine duty. As Federici (2004) argues in *Caliban and the Witch*, the control of female reproductive labor has historically been central to the formation of capitalist systems. Gilead institutionalizes this logic: the Handmaids' reproductive labor is systematically alienated from them and transferred to the Commanders' households.

The ideological superstructure in Gilead, dominated by a blend of religious dogma and state propaganda, serves to legitimize and naturalize this exploitation. Marx and Engels (1846/1970) contend in "The German Ideology" that the dominant ideas within any society reflect the interests and perspectives of the ruling class. In Gilead, biblical language becomes the ruling ideology, used to justify social stratification and mask material inequalities. The regime claims divine authority, but it maintains itself through surveillance, coercion, and material deprivation—mechanisms typical of capitalist states preserving elite dominance. This "unmasks the games played by the political powers to annihilate human awareness" (Abbas, & Sandaran, 2019).

Social classes are rigidly maintained. The Commanders and their Wives occupy the ruling class; Handmaids and Marthas serve as the working class, differentiated by type of labor (reproductive vs. domestic), and the Unwomen represent the discarded surplus population—those who are no longer economically useful. As Offred reflects, "We are containers, it's only the insides of our bodies that are important" (Atwood, 1998, p. 96), emphasizing the reduction of women to laboring bodies whose value is extracted by those in power.

In "The Handmaid's Tale" by Margaret Atwood (1985), the dystopian society of Gilead is structured around strict gender roles, especially for women. Three key categories of women—Marthas, Econowives, and Handmaids—represent distinct social roles, each defined by the woman's fertility, age, and social status. These classifications are rooted in Gilead's theocratic interpretation of the Bible and are used to maintain rigid control over women:

Marthas are infertile women tasked with domestic duties such as cooking, cleaning, and housekeeping. They typically serve in the homes of elite Commanders. The term "Martha" comes from the biblical figure known for her service in the household (Luke 10:38–42), aligning with their submissive, service-based role.... "Rita is a Martha. She works hard, cleaning, cooking. She's not supposed to speak to me except when it's absolutely necessary" (Atwood, 1985, p. 8). Marthas are dressed in green uniforms that represent their servitude and are typically older women deemed no longer capable of reproduction.

Econowives are married to lower-ranking men who do not have the privilege of being assigned Handmaids. They are expected to fulfill all female roles in the household, including wife, mother, cook, and cleaner.... "The Econowives do everything; if they can" (Atwood, 1985, p. 25). Econowives wear striped dresses that combine red, blue, and green—colors associated with the roles of Handmaids (red), Wives (blue), and Marthas (green)—

highlighting the multiple burdens they carry without status or support.

Handmaids are fertile women assigned to elite households for the sole purpose of reproduction. They are forced to bear children for Commanders and their Wives, based on a literal interpretation of the biblical story of Rachel and Bilhah (Genesis 30:1–3). Handmaids are stripped of autonomy and reduced to their reproductive function..... "We are two-legged wombs, that's all: sacred vessels, ambulatory chalices" (Atwood, 1985, p. 136). Handmaids wear red cloaks and white bonnets, symbolizing both fertility and sexual control. Their lives are highly regulated, and failure to produce a child can result in exile or punishment. These three roles—Marthas, Econowives, and Handmaids—reveal the deep stratification and oppression of women in Gilead. Each category is defined not by individual choice, but by state-assigned utility, reflecting Atwood's critique of patriarchal control and the dangers of religious extremism.

Gilead also employs what Marx termed "false consciousness"—a condition in which the oppressed internalize the dominant ideology and fail to recognize their exploitation (Marx & Engels, 1970). Characters like Aunt Lydia perpetuate Gilead's beliefs among women, serving as ideological state apparatuses (Althusser, 1971) that reinforce compliance and mask systemic inequalities as moral or divine necessity. Ultimately, "The Handmaid's Tale" dramatizes how totalitarian regimes can utilize religion and reproductive control as ideological tools to sustain a class-based system of exploitation. Atwood's novel warns against the intersection of capitalist commodification and patriarchal control, particularly how both systems discipline and exploit women's bodies to maintain elite rule.

To deepen this Marxist analysis, the study supports the analysis with following two key concepts:

Louis Althusser's Ideological State Apparatuses (ISAs):

ISA stands for Ideological State Apparatus, a concept developed by the French Marxist philosopher Louis Althusser in his 1971 essay "Ideology and Ideological State Apparatuses". According to Althusser, ISAs—such as religion, education, media, and the family—are institutions that disseminate ideology and serve to reproduce the conditions of capitalist production. In "The Handmaid's Tale", the theocratic state of Gilead uses religion as a primary ISA. The regime does not rely solely on violence (Repressive State Apparatuses) but on ideological control, especially through institutions like the Red Center, where women are indoctrinated into submission under the guise of religious instruction. The Aunts, functioning as agents of the ISA, enforce obedience not through force, but through religious rhetoric, guilt, and psychological conditioning. This aligns with Althusser's claim that "ideology interpellates individuals as subjects" (Althusser, 1971, p. 174)—that is, citizens come to accept their roles not as forced upon them, but as 'natural' or divinely ordained.

Antonio Gramsci's Concept of Hegemony:

Abbas explained that; "According to Van Dijk, dominance is understood as a form of social power abuse, as a legal or moral illegitimate exercise of control over others in one's own interests that often results in social inequality" (Abass & et al, 2021, p. 24). Gramsci's theory of cultural hegemony argues that ruling classes maintain dominance not through direct coercion, but by securing the consent of the oppressed via cultural institutions and ideological leadership (Gramsci, 1971). In Gilead, religious doctrine has been normalized to the point where many citizens—particularly women—internalize their oppression as moral duty or divine will. The regime's success in establishing hegemonic control is evident in Offred's frequent moments of doubt and complicity, even as she privately resists. The novel explores how

hegemony is sustained through ritual, surveillance, and internalized beliefs, and how small acts of dissent, like remembering the past or engaging in forbidden relationships, become meaningful acts of resistance within a hegemonically controlled society.

By combining literary criticism and Marxist criticism, this study attempts to offer a nuanced analysis of how Atwood exposes the socio-political consequences of merging religion with state power in theocratic society, particularly in relation to gender and class oppression.

Merging religion with state power in a theocratic society often results in systemic gender and class oppression. Religious laws typically enforce patriarchal norms, limiting women's rights in areas such as education, employment, legal testimony, and bodily autonomy. Additionally, these systems often legitimize socio-economic hierarchies, favoring elites aligned with religious authority and marginalizing lower classes (Moghadam, 2003). Theocratic governance can thus institutionalize inequality under the guise of divine legitimacy. Separating religion from politics is crucial to uphold democratic values, protect individual freedoms, and ensure equal rights regardless of faith. It prevents the domination of one religious group over others and reduces the risk of discriminatory laws based on religious doctrines (Sen, 2005). Secular governance fosters pluralism and safeguards human rights, especially in diverse societies.

CONCLUSION

The final conclusion of this study is that religion is used to maintain totalitarian control and enforce gender-based subjugation within a theocratic society inside the narrative text of the novel under study. By combining literary criticism and Marxist criticism, this study attempted to offer a nuanced analysis of how Atwood exposes the socio-political consequences of merging religion with state power in theocratic society, particularly in relation to gender and class oppression in her novel, "The

Handmaid's Tale". The findings of this study assert that Atwood reveals the dangers of theocratic rule and challenges readers to consider how religious and political discourses can intersect to sustain systems of oppression. The findings also provide a clear insight of how "The Handmaid's Tale" critiques the manipulation of religion as a tool of ideological domination practised by theocratic rule. "The Handmaid's Tale" offers a bleak portrayal of totalitarian theocratic society inside the narrative text under study, where the deep stratification and oppression of women in Gilead. Class divisions are strictly enforced. The Commanders and their Wives occupy the ruling class; Handmaids and Marthas serve as the working class, differentiated by type of labor (reproductive vs. domestic), and the Unwomen represent the discarded surplus population—those who are no longer economically useful. Atwood's novel warns against the intersection of capitalist commodification and patriarchal control, particularly how both systems discipline and exploit women's bodies to maintain elite rule. Eventually, it becomes clear that merging religion with state power in a theocratic society often results in systemic gender and class oppression. Religious laws typically enforce patriarchal norms, limiting women's rights in areas such as education, employment, legal testimony, and bodily autonomy. Additionally, these systems often legitimize socio-economic hierarchies, favoring elites aligned with religious authority and marginalizing lower classes. Theocratic governance can thus institutionalize inequality under the guise of divine legitimacy.

Interconnection of Orwell's novel *Animal Farm* As a Micro-universe and our Macro-universe

ABSTRACT

George Orwell is best known for his allegorical political novel, *Animal Farm* (1945), written in the period of Modernism in English literature. This novel is read as an offensive on totalitarianism in general, and a political satire against Stalinism Communist totalitarianism in particular. The current paper is conducted to investigate the relationship between the micro-universe which is represented by the narrative text of Orwell's novel *Animal Farm*, and macro-universe which represents the reality or the real world. The main aim of this study is to determine the interconnection of the micro-universe (the narrative text), and the macro-universe (the reality) through finding a convergence between the topics and events of the narrative text and our real world. Marxist Criticism and Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) are used together as analytical approaches to investigate the selected narrative text and the historical, political, and social context in which the narrative text was written. The findings of this study points out that the narrative text of *Animal Farm* represents reality. This confirms the social and moral function of the committed literature which expresses human sufferings and aspirations for better conditions. The significance of the current study lies in provides better comprehension of the interconnection of the narrative text and reality as a missing feature in literature on this novel. This study contributes to literature on Orwell's novel *Animal Farm* particularly, and the field of the political English novels in general. Thus, this study extends the base of the researchers' knowledge in this literary area.

Keywords: Micro-universe and Macro-universe, Modernism, Totalitarianism, Animal Farm.

INTRODUCTION

The modern novel became more realistic, vivid and popular than the written novels in previous periods in English literature, because, rather than just imagination, it dealt with the important events that affected the world and Literature (Nouasri, 2015). Among the best known political novels written in the period of modernism is "Animal Farm". On the heels of World War II, this novel was published firstly in England in 1945 and then in the United States in 1946. Orwell, in "Animal Farm", emphasized the destructive role of absolute power represented by the corrupt totalitarian political regimes that caused misfortunes to humans in the first half of 20th century. Orwell reflected the political environment in which he wrote his novel by depicting political and social scenes for the society in this novel. There was common belief that Russia is a Socialist State. Orwell tried to dispel this belief through writing this novel, in order to expose the totalitarian political regime in Russia. "Animal Farm" addressed totalitarianism as a prominent political theme through depicting the emergence of the pigs as rulers of the farm. The pigs imposed their ideology and discourse to control the rest of the animals to exploit them, and to retain power and interests of the pigs. Eventually, the animals under the rule of the pigs lived in a worse condition than before their revolution against their human master (Shapiro, 2017). In the light of the above discussion, the current study deals with the relationship of the narrative text of this novel and the reality and investigates the representation of this narrative text (as micro-universe) of the real world or reality (as macro-universe).

The literature on Orwell's novel "Animal Farm" has a big bulk of studies that related to the major political themes of this novel, such as absolute power, ideology, and corruption. For example; studies of Goncalves (2017), Nouasri (2015), Monica (2011), Pelissioli

(2008), Sewlall (2002), and Sebastian (2001) focused on exposing the practices of absolute power, dictatorship of communism, and drawing the form of absolute power and its authoritarian methods and negative effects on the society inside the text through the interrogation of the narrative text. However, the relationship between the narrative text and the reality in the previous studies about the selected novel is not researched. Thus, the researcher could identify a gap of research left by the previous studies that focused on the practices of absolute power and dictatorship of communism, and its negative effects on the society inside the text. So, the gap appeared through lack of research in examining the interconnection between the narrative text (micro-universe) and our reality (macro-universe). In order to bridge the gap, this study examines the representation of the narrative text to the reality to show the evidence of interconnection between them. In order to address the research problem and achieve the objective of the study, a research question emerges: How does the narrative text (micro-universe) represent the reality (macro-universe)? The methodology of this study involves using Marxist criticism and CDA as the analytical approaches to find a convergence between the topics and events of the narrative text and our real world. The significance of the current study lies in provides better comprehension of the interconnection of the narrative text and reality as a missing feature in literature on this novel. This study contributes to literature on Orwell's novel "Animal Farm" particularly, and the field of the political English novels in general. Thus, this study extends the base of the researchers' knowledge in this literary area.

LITERATURE REVIEW

This section provides a comprehensive commentary on the relevant terms and concepts. It explains the major concepts in this study, in addition to report the findings of the previous studies that related to the topic of the current study. The period of Modernism in English Literature occupied the years from 1890 through

approximately 1965 (Drabble, 2000). Modernism was looked upon as diverse forms of art. Through the period from 1890 to 1930 the modernism had been developed. After the appearance of this movement, new schools of thoughts, narrative techniques, and new theories of art and literature were emerged such as symbolism, feminism, nihilism, objectivism, and naturalism. This involved different literary genres including novel, drama, poetry, and short-story. During the period from 1910 to 1930 an economic depression happened. The high modernism began soon after the First World War wherein the politics, society, art and literature developed new emotions. According to the description of Virginia Woolf (cited in Sanders(1994)) ; "this is an accumulated sense of exhilaration at a variety of new beginnings and rejections of the past" (Sanders, p.506). Modernism is not an accurate label rather a way of presenting to the efforts of various individuals across the arts who attempted to stir away from the traditional modes of depiction in formalized or political forms. In the literature, the move to new forms required a reconsideration of the imaginative writing (theme, character, narration and plot), the awarding of time and space, imagery and especially language (Childs, 2009). In the West, a constant change happened since 1930 and onwards such as an economic breakdown and unemployment. Meanwhile, the development of the major Bolsheviks in the Soviet Union, Fascism in Italy, Mao's Communists in China and Nazism in Germany kicked off the violence, leading to the invasion of Abyssinia, the Spanish Civil War, and eventually the Second World War (Werth and Panne, 1999). Nevertheless, Stalin, Hitler, and Mao hold the power for long enough to cause severe damage to the civilians. So Michel Roberts, W. H. Auden, C. Day Lewis, William Palmer, and Stephen Spender turned their poetry in to propaganda and Louis Mac Niece and George Orwell did the same through prose. Thus, the emergent modernism can be viewed as a distinctive cultural movement during the recent past. Eventually, it could be said that first half of the twentieth century witnessed many great events and dangerous turns that have brought about a dangerous

and important turning point in the history of the modern world. These events negatively and seriously affected the lives of people in most parts of the world. The most prominent of these political events are: i) World Wars I and II, when millions of people were killed, and the cold war between US and Soviet Union (after the Second World War) .ii) Production and use of atomic bomb. It is not easy for the world to forget the victims of those bombs, wherein The Air Force America dropped the first atomic bomb on the Japanese cities of Hiroshima and Nagasaki in 1945, and 120000 civilians were killed (Giangreco,2009). iii) The emergence of totalitarian political regimes and dictatorships that repressed peoples in many parts of the world imposed their total control over the people, and deprived rights and freedoms of individuals and society (Beauchamp, 1986). iv) The development of technology that has been used by totalitarian governments and dictatorships to impose their ideology on the people and to market false slogans, for more hegemony and the maintenance of power. As well as restricting freedom of opinion and suppression of anti-government ideology, in addition to the harsh social conditions, where poverty, unemployment and lack of education, and so on. In that era and under such aggravating circumstances, the novel under the study was written.

In literature and culture two distinct, yet interrelated circulated terms exists called micro-vision and macro-vision. However micro is a prefix and may be applied to word describing something at small scale. Conversely, macro is a prefix implying large, over a long period and the big picture. There is a trend in literary studies stating that when an author writes a literary work, say a novel, then the novel is a cultural product of various factors such as political, social, religious, and economic that related to reality. Whilst the micro focuses on the individual, the macro stresses the massive which lies outside. Therefore, it is essential to unravel different discourses related to the narrative text for unlocking the world of the text. The narrative text or the micro-sphere is inevitably related to physical world or the culture of the given

group which interprets their concepts, rituals and actual activities. The system of such human activities is termed as the macro-universe. The micro-universe (the narrative text) integrally represents the macro-universe (the culture or the outside world / reality). In other phraseology, there is connectedness between the phenomenal world or the experiential world and the verbal world of the text linguistics (Scholes, 1982). Scholes defined the linkage between the world of the novel and the physical world. He stated that "one context, made out of perceptual and experimental data held in common by author and audience, is always invoked any fictional or mimetic context, whether 'realistic' or 'fantastic'. This 'real' context provided a background against which one perceives and measures the pseudo-experiential or fictional context presented to us" (1982, p.6). Scholes stressed that fiction could generate what is faded of the experimental events or data, thus "the passage of real experience into the past is not itself fictional, but all attempt the reconstruct are precisely that fictions. Fiction is not what is lost but what is constructed"(1982, p.30). These two perspectives of looking events in a systematic way are significant in the analysis of the literary text. Actually, bundles of events in the novel or a story are structured on the basis of logic based so called cause and effect mode in a certain spatial - temporal setting as well as in the narrative works of analysis. These sequential events are indeed the repetitions of certain phenomena in the real world. Knowing the fictional truth is in a way bounded to the phenomenal or the experiential events in the physical world (Scholes, 1982). Also, in the language of the text, CDA researchers examine how the microstructures of language are linked with and help to shape the macrostructures of society (Mayr, 2008).

However, some previous studies can be mentioned by what they have done through investigating the theme of power represented by totalitarian regime in Orwell's novel *Animal Farm*. Goncalves (2017) exposed the practices of absolute power. Nouasri (2015) revealed Orwell's purpose behind his writing on theme of

corruption. Monica (2011) exposed dictatorship of communism and showing the discrimination between upper class and the lower class. Pelissioli (2008) Revealed Communism as sort of totalitarian regime represented absolute power that should be generalized to read as signals to any sort of totalitarian regime. Sewlall (2002) read *Animal Farm* as an attack on dictatorships, and the title of this novel was shifted to be a remarkable term refers to the deterioration of utopian ideology. Sebastian (2001) exposed practices of power, wherein the love of power was the motive behind the political action. However, no previous study has investigated the interconnection of the narrative text and the reality, nor determined the link between them in Orwell's novel under the study. Thus, the current study is motivated by a desire to contribute to the body of research on *Animal Farm* focusing on the representation of the narrative text (micro-universe) of the reality (macro-universe) as a missing feature in the literature on the novel under the study in order to fill this gap and enrich the body of research in this field.

METHODOLOGY

The data of this qualitative study is the text of Orwell's novel "*Animal Farm*". The research question of this study does not deal with specific data (extracts) taken from the text, rather it deals with the entire text (themes, events, and characters) and its relationship to reality. To answer the research question, and show evidence about how does the narrative text (micro-universe) represent the reality (macro-universe), the analysis depends on; the Marxist criticism perspective, which views the text as a historical product of a social and cultural structure, and CDA perspective that links the text to its context. Thus, it is important to study the external context surrounding the literary text in the period in which the text has been produced, and this includes the social, political and conditions of that period. Marxist criticism (Marxist Literary Criticism) views literary works as reflections of the social institutions where from they emerge. According to Marxists, even

literature itself is a social institution and has a specific ideological function depending on the background and author's ideology (Abrams, 2009). Being the body of human experience, literature encodes human clash of wills in an imaginative creative way (Williams, 1977). Literary ideologies in the texts, according to Eagleton (2010), reshape the image of reality. Marxist criticism cares about context in which a literary work is written, in the light of the historical evidence. It includes the social and historical circumstances of that time, and certain facts about the author's life in order to understand the world behind the literary text. CDA studies discourse through analysing the text in its context, rather than analysing it as isolated text. Thus, what distinguishes CDA, from other linguistics, is the emphasis on context. Through CDA, context has been treated as: it is space, time, practice, or change: i) space means the location or physical setting in which the text has been occurred or produced. ii) Time means the sequence of the text according to other events or texts. iii) Practice means locating the text the scope of related values, ideas, or methods of operating (economic, political, ideological, and socio-cultural). iv) Change means identifying the field in which the text is circulated to shift, alter, or impose new understandings or actions (Leitch and Palmer, 2010).

ANIMAL FARM

Animal Farm is an allegorical novel that tells a story of animals live in a farm under hard conditions that push them to revolt against a human farmer, the owner of the farm, under the leadership of the pigs. The animals dream to build up their society in a way ensures that they can live in justice, equality, freedom, and happiness. Eventually, the revolution of the animals is betrayed by pigs, and the farm ends up in a bad situation under the dictatorship of the pigs and their leader, Napoleon (Orwell, 2001). Animal Farm is a parallel story of Russian history. According to Gorge Orwell, the novel depicts events leading up to the Russian Revolution in 1917, as well as the Stalinist era in the Soviet Union.

Orwell showed the totalitarian nature of Stalin in the form of his animal character, Napoleon who exploited the whole society. Orwell personified the animals in the tradition of allegory so that they could represent real historical figures. *Animal Farm* was also an influential satire wherein Orwell used irony to undermine the tenets of totalitarianism, especially the Stalinism (Khan, 2017). In *Animal Farm*, Orwell clearly revealed classes' difference. Napoleon and the pigs represented the ruling class while the rest of the animals represented the lower class (proletariats). Orwell portrayed the picture of exploitation and showed the abuse of power as well as totalitarianism of pigs when they become the leaders of the animals. Napoleon somehow got control over the farm and the animals, and became a dictator. Symbolically, this was what Stalin did as he was also a proletarian and assured people of utopia. However, Stalin only gave his dictatorship and tyranny to generate dystopia. In *Animal Farm*, all principles, to get utopian life, were changed in such a way that life became dystopian. All animals (except the pigs and the dogs) were broken and scared; there were no justice but dictatorship. Orwell depicted the effects of totalitarianism on the society and as a result the civilization could turn into dystopia. Orwell proved that all the utopia ideas and promises were abused by only totalitarian dictator (Raza, 2016).

FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

Literature, includes novels, represents a container and, in the same time, a response to the social and political issues in the real world. So, literature could inform reality. The narrative text of "*Animal Farm*" involves events, themes, characters, symbols, and implications which indicate that the literary work is related to real life. After the success of the animals' revolution on the farm and the expulsion of Mr. Jones, the animals have changed the name of the farm from "*Manor Farm*" to "*Animal Farm*". Changing the name of the farm indicates the transition to a new era in which the animals live in freedom and justice. The animals adopt the song

of Beasts of England as the national anthem for the farm. This song refers to the unity among animals to live together in peace without being tyrannized, oppressed, or controlled by humans. The animals raise their own green flag with a white hoof and horn on the farm. The green colour of the flag represents the fields, and the hoof and the horn symbolize the animals. They undertake the principles of "Animalism" (which have been phrased in the form of the Seven Commandments) as a constitution for the farm. It is a bundle of laws and principles for the farm written by pigs based on thoughts of the Old Major; this constitution is binding on all animals (Orwell, 2001). Hence, all these symbols indicate that the farm is a metonymy of a state. Marxist criticism and CDA are concerned with studying the external historical, political, and social context in which the literary text has been written, as it represents the cultural production of a particular society in a certain period. Going back to the date of writing Orwell's novel "Animal Farm" (in the period of modernism) and the outstanding events that this historical period has witnessed in our real world, in addition to the author's ideological orientations which are anti-communism, a rapprochement can be revealed between the text and reality. Moreover, the interpretation of the events, symbols and connotations involved in the narrative text indicates the existence of this rapprochement between the narrative text and reality. Thus, it could be realized that the animal farm within the narrative text symbolizes Russia at that time. Likewise, Mr. Jones (the owner of the farm) symbolizes the last Tsar, Nicholas II (the King of Russia), Old Major who convinces the animals to rebel refers to Karl Marx, the father of communism (both Karl Marx and Old Major dies before their dreams are realized), the animals' revolution in the farm indicates the Bolshevik revolution, principles of 'Animalism' or the seven commandments refers to communism, and Napoleon represents Stalin. In this novel there is a sense of unification of Orwell's political worldview. According to Kingsley (1975), there is a relationship among themes to anti-communist intention, emphasizing the association of the animals

of the tale to Trotsky, Stalin, and Marx. Furthermore, it could be said that the October Russian Revolution in 1917 is the situation which has inspired Orwell to write this narrative text (Monica, 2011). To criticize and attack Stalin and communism, Orwell has intentionally written this novel allegorically, on the tongue of the animals, for political reasons, because Britain is allied with Russia at the time of writing the novel.

"Animal Farm" is full of symbolism, being an allegorical novel. Just as the farm symbolizes Russia and the neighbouring farms symbolize contemporary European powers of the Russian Revolution, individuals or groups from Russian history are represented by the animals in the narrative text. Remarkably, there are similarities between Communism and "Animalism". Communism urges the low class workers to rebel against capitalists and not to work for their benefit. Whereas "Animalism" urges the animals rebel against humans and not to keep working for their benefit. It calls for treating all the animals equally. Thus, "Animalism" in the text refers to Communism in Russia at that time. In the text, Napoleon objects the ideas that Snowball offers, because Napoleon dislikes to see Snowball gains more popularity than himself, and to become the leader of the farm. So, Napoleon expels Snowball from the farm by using violence. This matches what has happened in Russia after the revolution wherein the falling-out between Joseph Stalin and Leon Trotsky. Napoleon could not win the trust and affection of the animals, as his rival Snowball does. So, Napoleon, to enforce his dominion, turns to his special police force (the nine dogs), like Stalin. In order to build his power, Napoleon works secretly and behind the scenes, as Stalin has done, and uses deception and manipulation. However, Snowball, like Trotsky, dedicates his efforts to gain popular support by presenting positive ideas and suggesting practical solutions for problems. The narrative structure of Animal Farm is parallel to the social structure in Russia after the revolution and during Stalin's era. In the text, Orwell confirms many key points that related to the pigs and the communist leaders

in Russia. The pigs deceive the other animals, because the pigs are manipulative animals. Likewise, the communist leaders are manipulative humans, and use deceptive language. The Proletariat is treated unfairly by the communist leaders. In the same time, the communist elite always give justification about their gaining more privileges than other people. So, the communist leaders distract the thinking of people from this unfairness by reminding them of the oppression of the previous system of the czars, like the pigs who remind the animals of the oppression of Mr. Jones. The pigs employ Squealer's eloquence to market their discourse through deceptive language. Squealer represents Stalin's follower, Molotov, the head of Communist propaganda. It could be also said that Squealer symbolizes Pravda, the Soviet newspaper. Orwell, in this narrative presents a clear example of how the educated elite class abuses language in order to control the lower class.

The flag of Republic of Animal Farm carries a white hoof and horn to indicate the solidarity and unity between the animals. It is a reference to the flag of communist party which carries the hammer and sickle as a symbol of the solidarity and unity between the peasantry and working-class. Boxer's loyalty and strength is fully exploited by the pigs that use him as a tool. When Boxer is getting age and no longer strong and useful, the pigs rid of him. Unfortunately, Boxer is exploited by both Mr. Jones and the pigs. He symbolizes the working class and Russian peasants in the Tsar Nicholas II time, then in Stalin's era. It is possible to realize the significance of the literary discourse of Animal Farm as commentary which reinforces the conceptual linkage between the oppressed animals within the text and the downtrodden working classes of Russia and the world. Monica (2011) has stated that Marx has wanted a classless society but this never materialized. The novel, Animal Farm, explains how the communist movement begins with promises of supporting and helping the people and talking about freedom of everyone to have a voice and thought in their own lives, But the Communists have broken their promises. The central point of the novel is criticizing communism, and the

manner in which it has been applied in the Soviet Union. *Animal Farm* represents a metaphor of the Communists Soviet Union. But more broadly, the novel indicates any human society ruled by totalitarian regime, whether it is communist, capitalist, socialist, or fascist. The characters of pigs represent a metaphor for the authority of the society within the text, and each one of the other characters in this literary work implicitly serve as metaphors for other identical instances that exist in reality. The pigs, the educated elite on the animal farm, have reshaped culture in the farm community according to their ideology that they have imposed through their influential deceptive discourse and manipulation of language, as the Communists in Russia have done. As a result, the identity of society and individual has been reshaped, new stratification has been created, and the disparity between social classes (ruler and ruled) has been extended. In keeping with the social function of literature, this narrative text of Orwell represents a response to the social and political issues in our real world. However, "*Animal Farm*" could be read as a global appeal to reject any dictator everywhere in our world, and Orwell's aim of criticizing and attacking totalitarianism is not solely directed to Stalin. The novel has exposed the fake claims of the revolutionaries who pretend that they condemn and reject absolute power and corruption, but when they get absolute power they turn into ruthless corrupt dictators. Thus, George Orwell's allegory has come to warn the reader from the evils of totalitarianism. George Orwell suggests that leadership and power must involve the responsibility to operate as a safety valve for preventing corruption and the abuse of power (Khan, 2017). Since the narrative text is a cultural product of a social structure that actually exists in reality, the text depicts the external context which produces that text. This means that the author of the text communicates intellectually and culturally with his surroundings through the text, and thus the author communicates with the readers to convey ideology, ideas, moral lesson or an implicit message through the text. Orwell's implicit message, which he has

sent through his novel *Animal Farm*, can be summarized as a warning to the readers, and to the people from totalitarian regimes everywhere. Orwell warns of totalitarian rulers and calls not to allow selfish, ruthless, and shrewd politicians to reinforce their power, because they will take away liberties and rights of the people gradually. Orwell warns deeply, as if he demanding readers to be wary of diverse methods of manipulation, deceptive language and discourse, and fake propaganda that have been used by the totalitarian regimes control the people, and then to oppress them. According to the notions of Marxist criticism and CDA that link the text with its context, and based on what has been presented above, the analysis has dealt with the historical, social and political context of the structure that has produced the text. So, the analysis has shown evidence about the relationship between the narrative text and the reality. Thus, the requested findings have been reached. The ideological situation of the prominent characters in the narrative text of *Animal Farm* and the social structure within the text have been tracked, in addition to shedding light on the external historical, political and social context in which the text has been written, with extrapolation the writer's ideology. Consequently, a close convergence has been revealed between the narrative text and our real world. So, the analysis has provided an answer to the research question of the study.

The representation of the narrative texts to reality has been confirmed through the findings of the study. The political and historical environment has been considered during the period when the novel was written to confirm the connection between the narrative text and reality. Orwell has personified the animals in the tradition of allegory so that they could represent real historical figures. *Animal Farm* is also an influential satire wherein Orwell used irony to undermine the tenets of totalitarianism, especially the Stalinism. Despite general agreement with many Marxist principles, Orwell did not accept the communist explanation of socialism because he found many similarities between the communist and the czarist government in the old Russia. To

Orwell, communism is intrinsically a hypocritical notion. When the upper class or the elite class possesses many tools like; power, money and economy, and propaganda compared to common masses, the upper class usually exploits these tools for the sake of domination and suppression of the lower classes. Orwell has revealed the linkage between totalitarianism and the dystopian society. Orwell has tried, in *Animal Farm*, to show how the corrupt leaders who hold absolute power in the farm feel that they have immunity against accountability. Orwell, through an allegorical animal farm, has portrayed a realistic life picture of how man acts towards his human fellows once he assumes power. Orwell has concluded that revolutionaries, who reject the oppression and the corruption of absolute power, have turned into megalomaniac rulers and ruthless dictators once they have possessed absolute power. On the contrary, Orwell believes that leadership and authority must operate as a safety valve which prevents the corruption and the abuse of power (Khan, 2017). It could be said that this novel is a story that depicts the emergence of the totalitarian regime of Joseph Stalin, and the rise and decline of socialism in the Soviet Union. Anyway, Orwell's attack on totalitarianism and communism is not limited to Stalin; rather it could be read as a universal appeal. It is in a broader sense a critique of totalitarianism in; Nazi Germany under the rule of Hitler, fascist Italy under Mussolini's rule, Spain under Franco, China under Mao, and capitalism in America, England as well as in the Soviet Union. The major message of this novel embodies Lord Acton's saying that power corrupts, and absolute power corrupts absolutely.

CONCLUSION

The findings of this study have expanded the work of the previous researchers on Orwell's novel *Animal Farm*. The results of the current study have confirmed the interconnection of the narrative text of Orwell's novel *Animal Farm* and our real world. Thus, the final statement of the study can be formulated by saying; the

literary work represents reality. The analysis has clearly confirmed that the corruption, resulting from absolute power, has appeared in multiple forms; political, ideological, social, financial, and moral corruption. Napoleon and the pigs, as a ruling class, have oppressed the animals, they have deceived them and stolen the farm resources, and they have enjoyed a life of luxury. In return, the rest of the animals have turned into an oppressed and deprived lower class. In *Animal Farm*, the opponents of Napoleon were killed, Snowball has been expelled by force, and the rest of the animals have hid their rejection of injustice and remained silent. Thus, it could be concluded that the narrative text (the micro-universe) represents the reality (the macro-universe). This conclusion asserts the findings that have been obtained through the analysis. Literature, includes novels, represents a container and, in the same time, a response to the social and political issues in the real world. So, literature could inform reality. Linking this text with the historical context and the social and political structures which have produced this text has confirmed that this narrative text depicted a real period in our modern history. The narrative discourses of *Animal Farm* have involved events, themes, characters, symbols, and implications which indicate that the literary work is related to real life. In addition to the author's ideological orientations which are anti-communism, a rapprochement has been revealed between the text and reality. Thus, it could be concluded that the animal farm within the narrative text symbolizes Russia at that time. Likewise, Mr. Jones symbolizes the last Tsar, Nicholas II. Old Major refers to Karl Marx, the animals' revolution in the farm indicates the Bolshevik revolution in 1917, 'Animalism' or the seven commandments refers to communism, and Napoleon represents Stalin. Furthermore, the effect of the themes and the topics that have been addressed by Orwell's novel *Animal Farm* has extended to involve the reality of the 21st century. The researcher sees that despite that the political systems in many countries, at the present time, are democratic in their form, but they are in fact totalitarian regimes

and they abuse their power and practise corruption. Peoples in different regions in our world today suffer from domination of political systems, injustice, corruption, inequality and restricted freedoms, as if they recopy the same story of the novel under study.

Governance and Leadership: A Critical Reading of William Golding's Lord of the Flies

ABSTRACT

The pursuit of power originated in the beginnings of human history, manifesting in various forms and motivations, starting from individual desires for control and dominance and reaching to the expansionist ambitions of nations. The struggle for power has shaped societies and fuelled conflicts, including major wars like World War I and II. Driven by this notion, this paper attempted to render a critical reading of William Golding's novel, "Lord of the Flies" regarding the struggle for power and the forms of governance and leadership in society within the narrative text that finally resulted in chaos and savagery. This study aimed at investigating the struggle for power and determining the forms of governance and leadership in this literary work. As analytical approaches, Marxist literary criticism and the notion of binarism have been adopted to analyse the conceptual framework of this study. The findings of this paper asserted that the power struggle leads to a plunge into chaos and cruelty, exposed two forms of governance and leadership represented by democracy and dictatorship, and the merits, demerits, and results of each form, and how a corrupt regime, governance, and leadership can ruin society. The final conclusion of this study is that Golding's novel presents a dark view of human nature and its tendency to descend into savagery in the absence of organised governance and wise leadership. The significance of this study lies in providing better comprehension of the power struggle and the forms of governance and leadership within the narrative text. It contributes to enriching the literature in this novel, and the field of political English novels.

Keywords: State-building, Leadership, System of Governance, Democracy, Dictatorship, William Golding, "Lord of the Flies"

INTRODUCTION

History and literature have shown evidence that among the main reasons that may affect the breakdown or progress of a society or a state is the role of command, ruling class, or leadership and its leaders (Abbas, 2022). The pursuit of power originated in the beginnings of human history, manifesting in various forms and motivations, starting from individual desires for control and dominance and reaching to the expansionist ambitions of nations. The struggle for power has shaped societies and fuelled conflicts, including major wars like World War I and II. The 20th century witnessed the rise of powerful nations and diverse political and economic systems, such as capitalism, socialism, and fascism, further intensifying the struggle for power and resources. This often leads to social divisions, ongoing tensions, injustice, oppression, exploitation, and certainly the destruction of communities. While the struggle for power plays out on a grand scale in the real world, its dynamics can also be explored through the lens of literature. Being the body of human experience, literature encodes the human clash of wills in an imaginative creative way (Abbas, 2021). Confirming the significance of literature, in this respect, Dobrolyubov "asserted that literature should be active and aimed at societal development, and he criticized works that, in his view, did not reflect the life of society or contribute to its progress"(Ahmed, 2024, p.872). The novel under the study depicts a group of British schoolboys stranded on a deserted island due to a wartime plane crash. As they attempt to establish a semblance of order and civilization, a struggle for power emerges over who will take over the power position on the island. The boys feel free from all the binds and rules. However, "humanity freedom is based on human nature after freeing itself from all the binds and rules leading to downfall and to savagery" (Baker, 2018, P.229).

The problem of this study is related to the issues raised by the power struggle as well as the form of leadership and governance in William Golding's *Lord of the Flies*. Thus, the objective of this study is to investigate the manifestation of the struggle for power and the form of governance and leadership in Golding's novel, *Lord of the Flies*. In order to address the research problem and objective of the study, a research question emerges to guide this study: how the struggle for power emerged and evolved, and what are the forms of governance and leadership within the narrative text of William Golding's *Lord of the Flies*? By conducting a critical analysis of the selected novel of Golding, the current paper attempts to provide a deep understanding of the struggle for power and the forms of leadership and governance inside the narrative text of "*Lord of the Flies*" by William Golding. The study adopts Marxist literary criticism and the notion of binarism as analytical approaches to analyse the narrative structures of this literary work. Thus, the author of the text and the external social, political, and historical context in which the text was produced will be considered. Dobrolyubov "believed that criticism should be based on facts and objective evaluation, and according to him, realistic criticism is based on the realistic analysis of literary works, rather than the subjective impressions of the critic" (Ahmed, 2024, p.872). The findings of this paper assert that the power struggle in "*Lord of the Flies*" leads to a plunge into chaos and cruelty. The findings expose two forms of governance and leadership represented by democracy and dictatorship, and the merits, demerits, and results of each form. In addition, the findings assert that corrupt power could build up the misery of society, and expose that this narrative text truly examines, by many means, how a corrupt regime, governance, and leadership can ruin society. The final conclusion of this study is that Golding's novel, "*Lord of the Flies*", presents a dark view of human nature and its tendency to descend into savagery in the absence of sensible leadership and well-organized governance. The novel reveals the fragility of democratic values and noble principles in the face of the instinct

for survival and the desire for power and control. The significance of the current study lies in providing better comprehension of the power struggle and the forms of governance and leadership within the narrative text of William Golding's *Lord of the Flies*. It contributes to extending the base of knowledge and enriches specifically the literature in this novel, and generally the field of political English novels.

WILLIAM GOLDING: THOUGHT AND ORIENTATIONS

William Golding, a British novelist, poet, and dramatist, lived from 1911 to 1993. His receipt of the Nobel Prize in Literature, for his book *Lord of the Flies*, stands as his greatest literary accomplishment. Furthermore, he is considered one of the most significant writers of postwar novels. William Golding can be considered as a modern British novelist. His writings reveal an awareness of the age in which he wrote, as well as an acknowledgment and recognition of the eternal truth about the human nature, the very nature which writers long before him tried either to hide its true shape or polish it shining and glamorous (Baker, 2018,P.229). Golding believed "that all human beings are born with original sin and are about balanced between potentiality for good and potentiality for bad" (Baker, p.230). As literature often serves as a reflection of society, it frequently mirrors its culture and aspects of life and presents a portrayal of reality. During this time period, written literature showed a sense of gloom and darkness. British writers vividly described the extent of the devastation inflicted upon Europe, specifically Britain, as a result of the war. The shock of losing companions, the disruption of normal life, and the disintegration of communities motivated authors such as Golding to recreate a somber depiction of the harsh reality that World War II imposed on European countries. This is evident in his works. Golding is recognized as a writer who actively engages with political and social issues, employing his narratives as a vehicle for articulating his viewpoints. He witnessed the emergence of totalitarian regimes such as Nazi

Germany under Adolf Hitler and the Soviet Union under Joseph Stalin, along with the aftermath of World War II. These historical circumstances undoubtedly shaped his perspective. By illustrating the negative effects of authoritarianism, Golding provides a critique of the system. He illustrates the adverse effects of unregulated power, such as the neglect of human necessities, the manipulation of individuals, disintegration of society, and the gradual degradation of moral principles. Additionally, he criticized social structures including centralized political systems, social discrimination, and religious hegemony (Paccia, 2015).

Lord of the Flies (1954) is a political and social allegory, using the stranded boys on the Island as a representation of broader societal themes. Through the characters and their behaviors, the novel explores the conflicts and tensions that emerge within human communities, reflecting various political and social ideologies. It depicts concrete political issues of his time, including totalitarian personality and authority, privilege, and power, as was the case under the 20th-century totalitarian regimes, making it a historical and political allegory. Many critics argue that *Lord of the Flies* is Golding's best-selling book and one of the most significant literary works of the 20th century. This novel "is a fable vital to our times for three reasons: the urgency of its questions, the audacity of its answers, and the formal originality of its investigation" (Baker, p.231). Golding discusses several thought-provoking topics about human nature, society, mortality, and power. The existence of evil and darkness in human nature is among the most significant issues. Golding argues that people can indulge in their most primal tendencies, which can result in violence, cruelty, and the disintegration of moral principles, when they are not constrained by society or its law. Civilization Vs. savagery, Golding's notions about savagery may be outdated and based on colonial stereotypes, but they are clear to everybody as the lads wear masks to dehumanize themselves and their growing passion with hunting leads to an increasingly animalistic mentality. The idea of power and its corrupting influence are also explored in the novel. A

power struggle, representing competing ideologies, breaks out among the boys as they try to create authority and order on the island. A society that is already in decline is made worse by the thirst for power and control, which breeds conflict and the misuse of authority. It could be observed that "one of the prominent issues in *Lord of the Flies* is man's need for civilization; the story shows that laws and rules, policemen and schools are necessary to keep the darker side of human nature in line" (Baker, P.230).

SYNOPSIS OF LORD OF THE FLIES

The story starts with a group of six- to twelve -year-old British schoolboys being evacuated from their plagued country. After their plane crashes, they end up left on a deserted Island with no adults. In a conch shell, Ralph and Piggy tripped suddenly. Ralph blew into it with a sound resembling a trumpet, which immediately drew all the children to the Island. The boys decide to choose one leader. The boys vote for Ralph, but the choirboys support Jack. Jack obviously wants the role, but Ralph receives the majority of the vote. Ralph asks Jack to lead the choir and the group of boys to act as their hunters, in an endeavor to appease Jack. Ralph decides to take Jack and Simon on Island exploration because he understands that they need to get to know what is new to them. When the explorers return, Ralph calls the boys to a beach meet-up by ringing the conch shell. He tells the group that they will have to make some plans to take care of themselves because there are no adults on the island. Ralph declares that, at meetings, the conch shell will be used to determine which boy has the right to speak. Everyone else will remain silent while the person holding the conch shell speaks. Piggy cries that they might be stuck on the Island for a long time and that no one is aware that they have crashed there. Little child who says he saw a monster or something that looked like a snake the previous evening. The thought that a monster might be stalking the island sends a rush of panic through the group. Despite their terror, the older lads try to reassure the youngsters that there isn't a monster.

Ralph suggests that, In order to increase the likelihood of a rescue, the group light a big signal fire atop the island's central mountain. This way, any passing ships will be able to see the fire and realize that someone has become trapped on the island. The boys gather a heap of dead wood, concentrate sunlight on it with Piggy's glasses, and then light the wood on fire. They succeed in starting an immense fire, but it dies out very soon. Jack consents to continue the signal fire with his hunting party. But their haphazard and disorganized attempts to restart the fire led to a wide expanse of trees catching fire. The boys, Ralph and Simon, started to work building huts to live in. Ralph gripes because Jack and the other boys haven't volunteered to assist construct the cottages. He implies that the hunters and Jack are neglecting the real labor by claiming their hunting duties as a justification. Jack responds by defending their priority of wanting meat. Jack and Ralph get more combative toward one another as their disagreement intensifies. Once Jack and the hunters discover pig droppings, he covers himself in clay and charcoal and becomes obsessed with hunting pigs. Along with a few other youngsters, he heads into the jungle. Ralph and Piggy spot a ship approaching from the horizon, but they also notice that their signal fire has gone. It's too late to rekindle the fire as they rush to the top. They are invisible to the passing ship. Ralph began accusing Jack and the hunters of failing to keep the fire going. When Jack and the hunters return, they are holding a dead pig on a pole. They are so ecstatic and insane with thirst for blood that they hardly hear Ralph's objections once they actually manage to catch and kill a pig. When Piggy complained about the hunters' Immaturity, Jack forcefully slapped him. The boys roast the pig, and they dance aggressively around the fire, singing and reenacting the brutality of hunting. Late In the evening, Ralph decides to call a meeting to attempt to bring the group back into line. The boys assemble on the beach after he blows the conch shell. He delivers a speech intended to restore order. After the meeting, combat breaks out between military

aircraft over the island. Unaware of the explosions and flashing lights, the boys are sleeping below. On Signal Fire Mountain, a parachutist descends to the ground, lifeless. However, the twins, the responsible for tending to the fire that night, are asleep and don't witness the parachutist land. When they wake up, they hear strange flapping noises from the parachute and catch a glimpse of its imposing shadow. Frightened, they run back to camp, convinced that a beast is nearby and has attacked them.

The boys plan an expedition to hunt for the enigmatic monster. Upon reaching the opposite side of the island, Jack voices his desire to construct a fortress by the shore. Ralph, on the other hand, stresses how important it is to keep the fire going in order to signal for help. During their search, they come across a boar, which attacks Jack. However, Jack manages to stab it. The hunters then chant in celebration of their victory over the pig. Ralph becomes aware of Jack's animosity towards him and confronts him about it. Jack ridicules Ralph for his reluctance to participate in hunting. Their tensions grow. Ralph is almost removed from leadership after Jack accuses him of being cowardly, but the others disagree. Jack calls the hunters to follow him as he marches off in wrath. Ralph arranges for the boys to start a fresh signal fire on the shore. But the majority gives up on the call to go with Jack. Jack proclaims himself as the chief of the hunters and announces their intention to build a fort and hold a feast at the castle rock. After hunting and slaying a pig, they place its severed head on a stake as an offering to the beast. Jack then brings some hunters back to the shelters, inviting the other boys to join their tribe and offering them food as an incentive. Simon, while he was alone in the woods upon encountering the bloody head, has a disturbing vision where he hears the head speaking, claiming to be the Lord of the Flies and revealing that It exists within everyone. Simon faints and later discovers a dead parachutist on the mountain. Realizing that the beast is within each individual, Simon goes to the beach to share his discovery but is attacked and killed by the others in a chaotic frenzy. The next day, Ralph and Piggy discuss their

actions, but they are attacked by Jack's hunters who steal Piggy's glasses. Ralph's team makes an unsuccessful attempt to negotiate with Jack at his stronghold. In the ensuing battle, Piggy is killed, and the conch shell is shattered. Ralph manages to escape the spears. Ralph hides, while the others hunt him down. In order to smoke Ralph out, Jack gives the order to burn the forest. After destroying the sow's head, Ralph feels compelled to go to the shore, where he anticipates being killed. Exhausted, Ralph collapses but is discovered by a British naval officer who noticed the fire. The officer is overwhelmed by the sight of the barbaric boys and requests Ralph to clarify. Ralph, feeling safe but emotional about the events on the island, breaks down in tears. The other boys also start sobbing, the officer turns away to allow the boys to compose themselves (Golding, 2001).

FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

In the following sections, an analysis of this paper's conceptual framework will be conducted:

STATE-BUILDING

Each State has the four essential characteristics; population, territory, sovereignty, and government. According to the form of ruling or governance (the action or manner of governing) in States, there are kinds of States; Authoritarian Governments, Oligarchic Governments, and Democratic Governments. State-building is the process of creating and strengthening the institutions necessary to support long-term economic, social, and political development, as well as fortifying nation-state's infrastructure and institutions. In order to promote stability and sustained development, it involves setting up or reconstructing the fundamental elements of an effective state, such as a legal system, government, security forces, and public services. Reducing conflict and enhancing the general well-being of a nation's populace are typically the objectives. Governments can work to uphold law and order, defend individual

rights, and provide basic services through state-building. The first step in forming a state is the establishment of a legitimate government that enjoys the acceptance of the majority of the populace. Without a leader who can provide stability, start reform initiatives, and have the power and ability to enforce laws and regulations, a state cannot function (Fukuyama, 2004).

The boys on the island decide to hold elections in order to choose a representative. Children elect a leader and resolve to find a way to salvation during the first assembly. Ralph is the best candidate to take on a leadership role. He has the physical strength to look after other boys, and because his father is a Navy commander, he seems to have control over them. Meetings are designated by the conch shell, and during them the boys discuss issues and possible solutions for the island. Similar to a democratic parliament, where issues and solutions are deliberated for the benefit of the nation, Ralph proposes that the person holding the conch has the right to speak first. It becomes a means of communication that is employed to promote freedom of expression or equal rights (Türk, 2019). As Vaidyanathan pointed out, "the conch is a vessel of political legitimacy" (Aldouri and Mohammad, 2011, p. 84). This looks exactly like what happens in parliaments. If any member of the parliament wants to speak, he has to have the loud speak in order to be heard, just like the boys they cannot speak unless they have the conch. With his first leadership mission, Ralph is determined to build shelters to protect them from animals, the sun, and rain during their stay on a tropical island. He feels that building shelters provides a sense of security and peace, particularly for young children who fear having nightmares when sleeping in the open. He also assigned tasks; the tasks involve lighting a fire and entrusting a group of children with the responsibility of keeping it lit as a signal for the purpose of rescuing individuals on the island when a ship passes by. In addition, the work is divided among the children, with some gathering fruits, others collecting potable water from the forest and covering it with tree leaves, whereas Jack headed a different crew

that was tasked with hunting. Thus, a "society with rules began to form on the island" (Aldouri and Mohammad, 2011). Infrastructure and resource management are essential to the creation of a state building. For these resources to survive and for their civilization to remain stable, good management is essential. After some time, the boys' community started to decline, and their commitment to the rules began to wane as some of them became engrossed in playing and having fun while the others got busy with hunting, neglecting the responsibilities assigned to them. Only Ralph and Piggy understand what it takes to survive in this jungle on their own, Simon is trying with them to complete building the shelters (Türk, 2019). Jack becomes increasingly obsessed with hunting and rejects Ralph's authority and establishes his own set of rules, emphasizing the importance of hunting and satisfying desires. It seems that society is starting to lean towards division. It is worthy here to mention that "binarism is a mode of thought on stable oppositions (binarism of good and evil) or a specific dichotomy subscribed to or reinforced in such thought (the binarism of West and East)" (Abbas & Sandaran, 2019, p. 1150). In this novel, there are two characters appearing to be in binary opposition intellectually i.e. Ralph and Jack.

With the children's inclination towards hunting and their desire for pursuit and violence, it demonstrates Jack's success in fulfilling their desires. Ralph fiercely criticized the opposition led by Jack, particularly after his failure, along with his supporters, to maintain the fire's flame. Jack and his allies launched a coup because they could no longer stand President Ralph's criticisms of him. Jack took over as separatist leader while Ralph stayed the leader of his loyalists. Jack and Ralph's disagreement gets more heated. Ralph promotes common good and cooperation, whereas Jack grows more hostile and authoritarian. This conflict leads to a power struggle between the two leaders and their respective followers. The escalating conflict between Ralph and Jack, fueled by their contrasting leadership styles and priorities, serves as a prime example of the challenges inherent in establishing a functional

society. Their struggle for power and influence lays bare the fragility of democratic principles when confronted with individual desires and the allure of authoritarian leadership. To understand the extent to which democratic ideals were applied within the boys' society on the island, we can use Larry Diamond's framework for evaluating democratic systems. Larry Diamond defined four keys for democracy. We can look through it to what extent democracy can be applied in the boys' society on the island. A system where people can choose and change their government through fair elections, where citizens actively participate in politics and community life, where everyone's human rights are protected, and where laws and procedures are applied equally to all citizens (Diamond, 2004). Initially, Ralph is selected as chief through a somewhat democratic process, with the boys participating in meetings and creating rules together. However, over time, power becomes centralized under Jack, transitioning the leadership structure towards autocracy. As the story progresses, the involvement of boys in the process of decision-making is decreasing. Authority becomes concentrated in the hands of a select few, like Jack and his hunters. All of the island's boys' fundamental human rights are not upheld by the government. As things descend into savagery, there is a disregard for others' rights and a lack of due process. Bullying and violence escalate. As chaos engulfs the island, laws and order collapse. The establishment and enforcement of laws become ineffective, leading to a state of anarchy instead of an organized governance system respecting individual freedoms. It seems that the government formed by Ralph and the boys on the Island does not fully apply all elements of democracy. The boys' project of society-building fails eventually for all of these reasons.

LEADERSHIP

The concept of leadership could be interpreted from different perspectives. Delia (2018) enumerated a variety of perspectives on the concept of leadership. Leadership is defined by experts "as a

process of social influence in which the leader requires the subordinates' willing participation to an effort for achieving the organizational goals". The leadership is a representation of "the capability to exert influence on individuals and groups, directing their efforts towards achieving the organization's goals". Others consider leadership "as a process of social influence in which the leader seeks the voluntary participation of the subordinates as a reward for achieving the goals. Leadership is a mutual action between people manifested in particular circumstances by means of the communication process and focused on choosing specific goals". Other definition of this concept is that leadership "consists in influencing people in such a way so that they devote all their efforts, willingly, for the common goals achieving". Leadership also refers to "the ability to efficiently use all the existing power resources to transform a vision thought for others into reality" (Delia, 2018, p.329).

One might wonder when or how leadership can be obtained. And since the study investigates the struggle for power within the novel, is leadership the same as power, or Is there a connection between the two? The concepts of power and leadership share a strong connection. Based on definitions above, we can understand that Leadership is a process through which an individual exerts influence and direction over a group of individuals, inspiring them to contribute their best efforts towards the achievement of common objectives, while power can be considered as the ability to influence others (Lunenburg 2012). The common trait between the two is that both involve the ability to influence, whether it is positive influence or negative one. It's worthy to mention that leadership and power are not identical concepts. Leadership is the ability to command and have others voluntarily follow commands. Power can also make others obey commands and remain in line, but they may not do it voluntarily. Bilginoğlu (2020) finds that Leadership cannot exist without power, a person who does not acquire power cannot lead, and any leader who does not know how to use power cannot be a great leader. According to (Baehaki

& Arti, 2019) Successful leadership is determined by various factors. These factors include the ability to maintain order and control, make sound judgments, inspire and motivate others, and foster organizational unity.

Dee Houk (2000) once said, "Control is not leadership; management is not leadership; leadership is leadership". One of the main concerns of William Golding's novel *Lord of the Flies* is leadership. Throughout the novel, two characters who take on leadership roles, each with their own characteristics and ambitions. These leaders are Ralph and Jack. Ralph, striving to establish a society, starts by electing a leader to create the groundwork for civilization and democracy on the deserted island. Ralph keeps carrying out his plan after winning the majority of votes and being elected chief. By holding the conch shell, he creates a framework for the boys to voice their thoughts and be heard. He also endeavors to keep the children united by maintaining a signal fire atop the mountain for the purpose of rescue. Despite the challenges and fears on the Island, Ralph takes on the responsibility of making life easier for the boys. He even tried to create a map to ensure their safe movement and protect them from harm but he failed, because they haven't any paper (Deyab, 2016). Fairness and inclusivity serve as the foundation for his decisions, but as the plot develops and the balance of power changes, Ralph must contend with Jack's strong, autocratic leadership in order to hold onto his position of authority. Golding chooses Ralph character to be a leader in the novel because he embodies the qualities of British leadership and democracy. The democratic election emphasizes the boys' belief in the superiority of democracy over dictatorship. Despite his lack of certain leadership skills, Ralph willingly accepts the role and represents a civilized world. In contrast to Jack's dictatorial style, Ralph embraces a democratic approach associated with the Western world. His physical attributes, social status, and possession of the conch symbolize British democracy and contribute to his selection. The boys reject the leadership that caused war, and

Ralph embodies British gentlemen and their democratic ideals. Despite his limitations, Ralph's dedication to British values and culture, along with his ability to recognize others' abilities, leads to his victory in the elections (Ponížilová, 2020). In contrast, Jack declares at the beginning of the novel that he is hungry for power and authority: "I ought to be chief, because I'm chapter chorister and head boy". (Golding, 2001, p.15) He learned a lot about the value of the class system from his privileged upbringing in choir school, including the belief that the head boy of such a place should be a top guy everywhere. Even though he did not win the majority of the boys' vote to pick Ralph as leader, this is not enough to prevent him from holding the position. First, he disobeys the rules that Ralph established. He turns into a true tyrant who delights in his hunters' worship. Ralph takes the opinions of the children into consideration, which is a characteristic of leadership that embodies democracy; Jack makes decisions individually without consulting any members of his group. He decides when they hunt, how they spend their time, and what their priorities are. Even before overthrowing Ralph, he consistently ignores the opinions and suggestions of others, especially Ralph and Piggy. He focuses on hunting and satisfying his primitive desires, disregarding the importance of maintaining the fire as a means of rescue. Furthermore, he uses violence and intimidation as a means of control and silencing opposition.

POWER AND SYSTEM OF GOVERNANCE

According to Wrong, "power is often defined as a capacity to control or influence others" (ABBAS, 2021, p. 45). In sociology, power is seen in the dynamics of social groups and institutions, where individuals or groups may hold power over others due to their social status, wealth, or access to resources. In political science, power is often defined as the ability to influence or control the behavior of others, whether through coercion, persuasion, or authority (Rabinow, 2006). The origins of power can be traced back to early human societies, where individuals

with physical strength or strategic skills often held leadership positions and exerted influence over others. As societies evolved, power became more structured and hierarchical, with the emergence of political systems and institutions. These institutions, such as monarchies or democracies, provided a framework for the exercise of power and the distribution of authority (Bar-Yam, 2018). Those who are in power, who are the political decision-makers, are the only ones who determine the nature of leadership and the form and system of governance, and they shape the government, whether it is authoritarian government, oligarchic government, or democratic government. Power is a major and important theme in William Golding's novel *Lord of the Flies*. In this novel, there are two forms of governance and leadership, wherein power inside society in the narrative text manifests in two distinct kinds; democratic power represented by Ralph and dictatorial power represented by Jack.

DEMOCRATIC SYSTEM OF GOVERNANCE

The boys learned that they were the only people on the island after arriving and going on a tour of discovery. As an attempt to maintain the culture and order in which they have been brought up at their home, so they decided to make decisions collectively. They set up a government. The first step for building this system was to elect a leader since elections were found to make democracy possible. The process of starting the election begins with the suggestion from one of the boys to make a vote. "Let's have a vote". "Yes! Vote for chief ! Let's vote" (Golding, p.15). Ralph won the majority of the electoral votes, despite the presence of another candidate, Jack, who was elected by the choir members. After Ralph takes charge, he calls for a meeting on the beach. During the meeting, Ralph proposes the idea of establishing rules, organize tasks, and maintain order. He thinks that by doing so, their chances of being saved will rise. In a democratic system of governance, the leader assumes several important roles and responsibilities. He serves as the head of state, representing the

people, hold executive power, overseeing the implementation of laws and making important decisions of governance. The leader also participates in policy formulation, working with advisors to develop laws and reforms. They communicate with the public and address concerns. Ralph's first steps towards leadership were prioritizing the need for rules and an organized system of governance on the island. Starting by holding organized meetings through the conch shell, this was found by Piggy. He said; "We can use this to call the others. Have a meeting. They'll come when they hear us"(Golding, p.10).

Piggy suggests that they could summon all the boys by using this instrument as a horn. The significance of the conch shell goes beyond being a tool for holding council meetings, but rather, it highlights its importance in a broader sense. The conch shell they find on the beach becomes one of the most important symbols which represent order and civilization (Türk, 2019). After a while, the function of the conch slightly changes. It is still used as a tool to create order in the group, but in a different way. One of the most central values that lie as a foundation of a democratic society is the freedom of expression; this democratic value can also be pointed at in *Lord of the Flies*. These words refer to this notion; "I'll give the conch to the next person to speak, he can hold it when he's speaking" (Golding, p. 25). The boys decide that the person, who is holding the conch at the time of the meeting, gets to speak and share their thoughts and opinions. While the person with the conch is speaking, the rest must be quiet and listen. When the conch is used like this, one can argue that it symbolizes freedom of expression as well because it makes it possible for each person to speak their mind. As we know, a democracy is more than just a government (Basile, 2007). Something else; "We can't have everybody talking at once, we'll have to have 'Hands up' like at school". He spoke while holding the conch near his mouth and in front of his face;"Then I'll give him the conch"(Golding, p.25). This quote showcases his understanding of the necessity to maintain order and ensure that everyone has the opportunity to be

heard. It also shows that the shell becomes a symbol of parliamentary order, as only the one holding it during the boys' meetings had the right to speak. This regulation demonstrates that the conch represents law and order, which is a fundamental aspect of a democracy (Wójcik, 2020). Another example of Ralph's attempt to improve the boys' situation on the island is by building shelters. After Ralph is voted leader, he decides to improve and organize the conditions for everyone on the island. Additionally, it is a means of preserving the civilization on the island. Having something that the boys can call a home also helps them to overcome their fears. For settlers, establishing a dwelling was the first step toward creating civilization. This is exactly what Ralph wants to do too (Bruns, 2008). Ralph was trying to find out of ways to make a fire for the boys, so that the haunted things can be eaten and also the fires can make the possibility bring the rescue team to come to them and save them. "We've got to make smoke up there, or die." (Golding, p.69). He was very much intelligent, and he used Piggy's glasses to make fire from the sun's shining to the woods. The marooned boys organize their lives and specific duties are assigned and regular meetings are held for discussion. They are happy to belong to the island. Ralph says; "This is our island, it is a good island" (Golding, p.27).

Another element of the government after voting, symbol of government authority, is committees. Ralph does not specifically choose committees in the novel but instead, he assigns various tasks to different boys in order to maintain order and ensure the survival of the group. He focuses on establishing priorities and assigning roles based on the abilities and interests of the boys. For example, he designates Jack as the leader of the hunters, recognizing his skills in hunting and tracking. "The choir belongs to you, of course. They could be the army or hunters" (Golding, p.16). This allows the boys to provide food for the group and address the immediate need for sustenance. We cannot consider Piggy as just a passing figure, but he played a crucial role as a prominent scientist, thinker, and intellectual in the state. He

enjoyed widespread support from Ralph, who considered him his advisor, a key reference, and always respected his opinions. Ralph's leadership would have been undermined far sooner without his advisor. Piggy not only understands the importance of the conch, but also puts on the glasses that allow Ralph to start the fire, whose smoke is their sole hope of survival. Piggy also realizes that building the shelters is at least as important for their long-term survival as keeping the fire going. In addition, Piggy is the one who recognizes how deeply Jack despises Ralph. Despite all of his intelligence, Piggy is essentially useless without Ralph. Piggy's asthma makes him physically weak, and he is a man of ideas rather than action. He and the conch are both destroyed at the same time by a huge rock rolled down a cliff by Roger. He is doomed in a society where irrational fears and physical strength are more respected than science, law, and dialogue. Because of that William Golding wrote this novel as a political and social allegory, associated with the tumultuous events that occurred in the 20th century, such as World War II and the Cold War, it is possible to consider his character and Ralph's represent the political figures of the Allies during the Second World War, and it is clear from the tone set on the island that Piggy and Ralph are essentially the good guys in contrast to Jack and his careless and destructive leadership of the lads. The author offers a perspective on the failure of democratic systems, highlighting their weakness in leadership or the contradiction between the values and principles they aim to uphold and the existence of systems that operate in complete opposition to those ideals. Ralph's failure to establish an organized democratic society is simply the result of the children's disregard for the established rules imposed by democracy in order to establish stability. They deviate from following this system and gravitate towards Jack's tyrannical and oppressive regime. It could be said that *Lord of the Flies* is showing how a democratic society starts to fail, as the members of the society is succumbing to basic instincts of human nature.

DICTATORIAL SYSTEM OF GOVERNANCE

Simply, a dictatorship is a form of governing where only one person or a small group of people have complete authority. Citizens do not have a say in the government or any of the decisions they make (ABBAS, 2021). After Ralph assumed power, Jack began leading the opposition against him with a sense of resentment, hatred, and animosity. It was clear that Jack, from the start, disregarded all of Ralph's orders and statements. This was especially evident when Jack resorted to hunting and maintained that the boys required hunting in order to obtain meat. Jack exerts significant effort in portraying Ralph as a poor leader, all in an attempt to seize power and gain control. He slowly attracts the boys away from Ralph's influence. He quickly turns into a rival leader who enrages Ralph and jeopardizes social order since his hunting activities are so alluring that the group's rescue-oriented motive is jeopardized and the fire is left neglected. Jack's bunch begins to swell and drift away from order, incidents lead to the mounting general belief that the island is roamed by a beast. Since there is no money on the island, there is nothing else of value, except hunting which is the work of Jack's tribe. As a result of their hard work with Jack, the boys receive a reward, it is the flesh of the pig that they can nourish themselves with. The symbol of the beast is mentioned as a way for Jack to exploit it and attract the boys towards him (Bruns, 2008).

The beast in "Lord of the Flies" is a potent symbol that stands in for the boys' shared anxieties. The boys call it the beast because Jack manipulates them into feeling this terror and gives it a physical shape. All the boys are frightened, even though the beast does not actually exist. Jack exploits this fear to strengthen his dictatorial power system. When the boys discover a dead parachutist, their fear of a beast from the air intensifies. Jack capitalizes on its existence to gain followers and control their actions. Fear becomes the source of Jack's power. Consequently, many of the boys join Jack's newly formed tribe in search of safety, which he promises to provide. Jack believes that by hunting

down the beast, he can further win the loyalty of the boys. However, in reality, he himself embodies the beastly nature by instilling a reign of terror. His behavior reflects the inherent evil that exists within every individual. (Bruns, 2008). As fear of the beast quickly grows, Jack's opposition wins popularity among the boys, who see Jack as a defender against the threat of the mysterious beast. Some boys join Jack's tribe to find safety, which he promises. Jack thus exploits this fear to seize control and then solidify his autocratic rule. Fear is the source of totalitarian power. People give up their freedoms and rights when they feel fear. Thus, it was the cause of the characters' sacrifice of equality and freedom in Golding's novel. They chose safety over freedom and friendship, considering them less important (Wójcik, 2020). In the novel, the tribe is portrayed as the primary symbol of Jack's dictatorial power. Jack's power structure wouldn't work without the tribe. In order to fulfill his goal of overthrowing Ralph and his democratic power structure, Jack depends on the collective mindset. The tribe is essential for Jack's strength and survival, as he is not only the leader but also the mastermind behind the group. Jack ensures the tribe remains intact and weakens the democratic power to strengthen his position. In a similar vein, the guys in the tribe look to Jack for leadership, but Jack requires the tribe to recognize him as the leader. Once the tribe is united and powerful, Jack has all the authority he desires (Bruns, 2008). Now he becomes such a dictator that whenever someone is up against him, they are going to have a big punishment. Jack has obtained his power by force. Ralph and Piggy are detained because Jack thinks that they will become threat to seize his tribe. Jack even imposes fear toward his own tribe too (Pinakari, 2017).

The power-hungry personality of Jack is solely to blame for all the island's ruin and devastation. Jack is the real antithesis of Ralph. From the very beginning of the novel, Jack desires power above all other things. He gives the choirboys instructions, and recommends obeying. The very first description of Jack's character in the novel reveals that he is power hungry. When he first

encounters Ralph and Piggy he shows his power not only manifested on his appearance but also in language. Jack seizes every opportunity to show his power. He utilizes every instrument of power that comes to his hand. He loves authority and tries to maintain it at any cost. He occasionally resorts to violence to uphold his dominance, and sometimes arouse fear on boys (Bhattarai , 2006). Jack is an example of a dictatorial leader who plays on the emotions of his subjects. He rules by charisma and hysteria. The henchman required for such a totalitarian ruler to maintain power is Roger, the youngster who enjoys killing the pigs the most and who throws the rock that kills Piggy. Death to death, killing to killing, is the main characteristic of this political system set by Jack. Seeing blood and killing are a game for him. Jack's ruling system is characterized by death and killing. The pig head is among the most significant symbols in the novel. The pig head, that Jack's tribe invented, is a representation of strength and savagery. After killing the first sow, Jack decides that the sow's head should be on a stick: "Sharpen a stick at both ends" (Golding, p.121). Since the tribe is afraid of a beast roaming around the island, Jack decides to offer something to the beast, in order to win its goodwill: "This head is for the Beast. It's a gift" (Golding, p.122). However, the pig head is transformed into more than a simple sacrifice. Very quickly the rotting head is surrounded by flies. This makes the pig head the lord of the flies. If we consider the boys to be useless flies in need of a vessel, then Jack is the true "lord of the flies" on one level. Jack establishes a totalitarian system, restricting freedom of speech and using intimidating tactics. His leadership style is compared to 20th century tyrants' tendencies in ruling. Jack's ruling system is characterized by death and killing. Jack represents the captivating force of authoritarian ideas that irrevocably took the world into an inferno. Golding subtly criticizes tyranny in his portrayal of Jack. It makes the world blind and brutal. It drives humankind toward instinct-based primal savagery. Golding rejects the thesis that dictators can lead

the world to Civilization (Chavan, 2013). On the contrary; it leads the world only to one thing to destruction.

Eventually, from a Marxist perspective, it could be said that "Lord of the Flies" can be read as an allegory of class struggle and the dynamics of power and resource control. Ralph, embodying democratic ideals, initially leads with an emphasis on collective well-being, shared responsibility, and rational organization—values aligned with a more egalitarian distribution of resources (e.g., the conch as a symbol of equal voice). Jack, in contrast, adopts authoritarian methods, monopolizing resources such as meat and using fear (the "beast") to consolidate power. In Marxist terms, both Ralph and Jack represent different factions of the "ruling class", alternating in dominance over the island's resources and means of survival. The rest of the boys form the "ruled or working class", whose labor (hunting, building shelters, gathering food) sustains the leaders' authority but who have little actual say in decisions once power is centralized. The novel illustrates how shifts in leadership style do not necessarily dismantle class divisions—control merely changes hands. Jack's dictatorship makes the exploitation more explicit, using coercion and spectacle, but even Ralph's democracy maintains a top-down structure. From this angle, Golding's narrative reflects the Marxist critique that without fundamentally altering class relations, any change in leadership risks reproducing the same inequalities under a different guise.

CONCLUSION

The findings of this study expose two forms of governance and leadership that have been represented by democracy and dictatorship, and the merits, demerits, and results of each form. In addition, the findings assert that corrupt power could build up the misery of society, and expose that this narrative text truly examines, by many means, how a corrupt regime, governance, and leadership can ruin society. The final conclusion of this study is that Golding's novel, "Lord of the Flies", presents a dark view of

human nature and its tendency to descend into savagery in the case of wise leadership's absence and lack of sensible governance. Through the power struggle between Ralph and Jack, the novel reveals the fragility of democratic values and noble principles in the face of the instinct for survival and the desire for power and control. The island, which initially symbolized hope and salvation, eventually becomes a stage for chaos and violence, where the boys transform from innocent beings into bloodthirsty monsters. This transformation highlights the failure of democratic leadership represented by Ralph, which lacked the decisiveness and strength necessary to control the unruly Instincts of the boys. On the other hand, Jack succeeds in exploiting their primal desires and fears of the unknown, leading them towards a dictatorial system based on violence and force. The symbolism of "Lord of the Flies" extends beyond the boundaries of the isolated island to reflect a bitter reality about power struggles in the real world. Often, democratic principles crumble in the face of the lust for governance and control, leading to conflicts and wars. The novel also raises questions about the nature of humanity and its ability to discern between good and evil, as well as the Influence of the surrounding environment on shaping behavior. In the end, "Lord of the Flies" serves as a warning against succumbing to primal instincts and disregarding human values. It reminds us that the true monster does not lie in the dark forest, but within the human self.

Beyond the Ideological Siege: A Critical Reading in Bradbury's Fahrenheit 451

Abstract

The current paper is set to investigate the clash of ideologies and cultures as encoded in the American novel "Fahrenheit 451", written in (1953) by Ray Bradbury. This study is a qualitative research aims at analysing the narrative text, in terms of Marxist perspective and Foucault's perspective on power and knowledge. It is hypothesized that knowledge and anti-knowledge reshape the clash of cultures in human communities. The objectives of this research paper are to investigate the clash of ideologies or, more specifically, the clash of epistemic systems in a dystopian society. As well as to unmask the games played by the political powers to annihilate human awareness and identity convincing the community to practice the culture of bourgeoisie. Being a mass consumption community this anti-intellectual ideology results in the sterility of life. One finding of the study is that the cultural shock experience by, Montag, the protagonist enable him to resist and break the ideological siege which is imposed by power. He became the modern hero of the culture who joined the elite or the sophisticated culture experiences by the Book people or the renegade intellectuals who believe in the progress of mankind through the sophisticated philosophy of loving and reading books. Keywords: Power and Ideology, Culture and Cultural Trauma, Intellectuals, and Binarism

INTRODUCTION

The history of mankind has witnessed a long trail of clashes or struggles among nations or in one single nation of divergent kinds: religious, economic, historical, social or cultural. What is

characteristic about these clashes or combats is that they are based on the principle of binarism or binary oppositions. These clashes, however, are not always physical, they are intellectual too. Literature as it is generally argued, is a social activity; a form of culture which transmits messages carrying a set of visions, concepts and worldviews (Williams, 1977). Thus, the humanistic field that immortalizes these faces of struggle is literature, more specifically the novel. Being a form of human culture, the novel is inseparable of political reality, but is often predicted, or contributed to change it. It contributes in shaping our awareness of the world around us, politically and socially. In the monograph "Marxism and Literary Criticism", Eagleton embarked on the term by stating that Marxist criticism "analyses literature (includes the novel) in terms of the historical conditions which produce it; and it needs, similarly, to be aware of its own historical conditions". This stressed the assumption that Marxist criticism drew heavily on the "sociology of literature" (Eagleton, 2003). In the tumultuous climate of twentieth century, novelists come in the scene to tackle such issues. Ray Bradbury, in his novel Fahrenheit 451, criticized the absolute power and totalitarian politics of the State. He reflected the political atmosphere in which his novel was created. The main research problem of this paper is to investigate how the State, in the novel under the study, reshapes human community to become waste and sterile by burning books, because of the claim that knowledge is dangerous to the human soul and mind. From it flows that the society is adapted to consumable culture while the elite or the book lovers are the only socio- cultural sector which believes in the progression of mankind through epistemology and reading books (Bradbury, 2004). So, the study aims at investigating the clash of ideologies and culture, and revealing the games played by the political powers to annihilate human awareness and identity. Thus, two research questions are emerged; i) how to determine the clash of ideologies or, more specifically, the clash of epistemic systems?, and ii) how to reveal the games played by the political powers to annihilate human awareness and

identity?. In *Fahrenheit 451*, Bradbury underscored and criticized material communities who are reshaped by bourgeois cultures that underestimates man's mind and changes humans into material. In contrast, one hope for the progression of mankind and civilization is the Book Lovers who believe in knowledge as one privileges process of man's prosperity and progress. The mainstream divergent activities in one society may lead to a sort of combat or clash among its classes and identities. Historically and socio-culturally, this dialectical act necessarily leads to a new image and vision of human progress and human future. This philosophy is plainly sorted out in Bradbury's *Fahrenheit 451*.

LITERATURE, IDEOLOGY AND POLITICS

The relationship of literature to politics, more specifically to political ideology could be traced back to the so-called proletarian literature where literature as verbal has been politicized to serve as propaganda for the Marx- Lenin's Communist theory (Cook, 1998). Politics became the prominent canon of the Soviet literature. The novel of politics found its way in Western culture, whether to criticize the totalitarian systems as that Nazism, Fascism and Stalinism, or the authoritarian bourgeoisie in the West, such novel responds to the modern situation of man and communities; it follows the rhythm of human impulse. This is true to so many modernist English novels like; Orwell's *Animal Farm*, and *Nineteen Eighty-Four* as well as Bradbury's *Fahrenheit 451*.

In the proletarian literature, it is argued that literature should be a weapon in the hands of the class to struggle against the bourgeoisie powers. This ideology made literature as a means for marketing the Marxist ideology. In his essay "literature and Ideology", Farrell delineates the function of the writer and literary products in such authoritarian states. He says: "The writer, accepting this conception and attempting to make it operative in the actual construction of novels, would have to see politics first and then life, and he would have to deduce life from political programs" (1942: 262). Farrell's point of view is partially true.

Not all fictional works of art which hold a political ideology ignore the stylistic features of literature, nor all of them are bad models of political literary canon.

FAHRENHEIT 451

The research paper will be confined to the narrative text of Fahrenheit 451 as data for critical analysis. The study will highlight the thread by and through which ideology and power are interweaved in the fabric of the novel. Bradbury's Fahrenheit 451 is a novel of politics though in a symbolic form; it is a symbolic critique of the reshaping of human communities by the elusive ideology of the dominating political powers. Fahrenheit 451, the title of this novel, refers to the temperature at which a paper burns. It is a science fiction whose episodes take place in a fictional American city, it is about "Montag", the fireman, whose task is to put down fires, not to burn books in a dystopian deformed society, but his task becomes burning of books. Without questioning the secret behind burning books, the protagonist practices the act of burning, until he is shocked by the question of Clarisse McClellan, a gentle seventeen-year-old girl who asks him whether he reads the books he burns and whether this act brings him relief. Moreover, she shows him the hollowness of his mind, life and vision. In contrast to young intelligent Clarisse stands Mildred, Montag's wife, a television addict, who represents the mass consumable culture in that dystopian society who prefers pleasurable lifestyle to intellectual one (Bradbury, 2004).

METHODOLOGY

This study is qualitative (narrative/storytelling), it adopts analysing of data that taken from the narrative text of the novel under the study. The following procedures will be applied to conduct the textual analysis: i) selecting a set of notions to generate and build up a conceptual paradigm, ii) describing the thematic structures of the selected data, i.e. Bradbury's Fahrenheit

451, iii) analysing the selected narrative text in terms Marxist criticism and Foucault's perspectives, and iv) drawing findings and conclusions elicited from the critical analysis.

MARXIST CRITICISM

Terry Eagleton defined Marxist criticism; "Its aim is to explain the literary work more fully; and this means a sensitive attention to its forms, styles and, meanings. But it also means grasping those forms, styles and meanings as the product of a particular history" (Eagleton, 1976). Marxist criticism cares about context in which a literary work is written in the light of the historical evidence. It includes the social and historical circumstances of the time and certain facts about the author's life in order to understand the world behind the literary text. According to Marxists, literature has a specific ideological function depending on the background and author's ideology (Tyson, 2006). It reflects the influence of the class conflict prevailing in the writer's environment. The literary work has been looked by Marxist criticism, as a product whose creator or producer focuses on the role of ideology and class. So, Marxist critics study the text and its author, and the context (Siegel, 2006). Marxist critics believe that the social transformations are caused by the struggle between existing opponent forces, and this make the society progresses. Marxist criticism aims to expose the hidden ideology in the literary work. It helps to determine whether literature can change the world or fail.

FOUCAULT'S PERSPECTIVE

Foucault's theories primarily address the relationship between power and knowledge, and how they are used as a form of social control through societal institutions (Rouse, 1994). Based on Foucault's Perspective, power is based on knowledge. In one hand, power benefits from knowledge, on the other hand, power reproduces knowledge in order to shape it according to its

intentions. Foucault has developed a methodology (genealogy) which is wholly based on history context in approaching texts. Being influenced by the political thought of Louis Althusser, Foucault's Marxist perspectives were omnipresent in his book "Mental Illness and Psychology" in 1954, which is about a history of psychology, Foucault concludes that mental illness is a result of alienation caused by capitalism. Foucault believes that power is not a supernatural phenomenon; it is omnipresent in everyday life. For Foucault "power is everywhere, and power relations are embedded in social life. Life in society, literally from the cradle to the grave, inevitably involves actions being exercised on others actions" (cited in Daldal, 2014:167). In addition, Foucault relates power to ideology. He believes that ideology is a level of "speculative discourse" that cannot explain the great technologies of power. That is to say, while power is a crucial part of the physical world since it is practiced in human daily life, ideology is within the sphere of mentality. It is not "in the realm of material realities. It is an abstraction" (ibid). Based on what has been mentioned above, it could be said that Foucault wittingly generates a network system between ideology and power and their influence on the identity in specific and the social class in general. Foucault deciphers power mechanisms on the basis of force relations, while ideology is an abstraction, a level of speculative discourse, Foucault's epistemological patterns of thinking here above serve as an introduction to interpret Bradbury's Fahrenheit 451 as a narrative of politics. In Bradbury's novel, the modern human situation in its darkling sphere is exposed, where humans become the tools to perform the controlling ideology.

FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

In order to answer the research questions of this study by conducting the analysis, a set of prominent terms to be exposed, this process may serve as a platform to the critical analysis itself. The study will tread the path of the terms Culture and Cultural

Shock, Intelligentsia and Binarism, in addition to Power and Ideology through the analysis.

CULTURE AND CULTURAL SHOCK

A universal term like culture is difficult to define since the term is dealt with differently within different human fields. However, culture, in the general sense, is a network system of beliefs, behaviors and patterns of thinking. The notion of culture is central to the history of ideas and the order of politics. In one more notion, culture is "a way of life of a group of people- the behaviors, beliefs, values, and symbols that they accept, generally without thinking about them, and that are passed along communication and imitation from one generation to the next" (Choudhury, 2018). This sort of communication is symbolic in nature since it is transmitted in one system of signs, namely, language. What is significant about the notion of culture is that it implies the mental products of man, and the beliefs that a culture group believe in, to reshape its cognitive ways and its daily behaviors. The cultural individual is committed to that way of thinking and practice. However, when the individual experiences a new culture due to immigration or a move between social environment or simply transition to another type of life, the so-called cultural shock happens. Thus cultural shock, Macious and Gerber, is "an experience a person may have when one moves to a cultural environment which is different from one's own" (2010:54).

Intellectuals or Intelligentsia

Though culture is a social activity, it is often related to those creative minds or intellectuals in society. In other words, the term is often associated with Intelligentsia. In a broadest sense, Intelligentsia (from Latin *intelligentia*) is "a status class of educated people engaged in the complex mental labours that critique, guide, and lead in shaping the culture and politics of their

society" (Intelligentsia, 2018). The intelligentsia includes artists, teachers, and academics, writers, journalists, and so on.

Binarism or Binary Opposition

The history of ideas witnesses the clash of ideas, wills or culture. In its basic structure, any clash or struggle necessarily construes two opposing furnaces, whether physical or mental, visible or invisible. This opposing process has come to be called binarism. So, binarism (as defined in Merriam Webster, 2018) is "a mode of thought on stable oppositions (such as good and evil or male and female) or a specific dichotomy subscribed to or reinforced in such thought the binarism of West and East". Two characters in the novel appear to be in binary opposition, socially and intellectually, i.e. Beatty, Montag's supervisor and fire chief, and Faber, the retired English professor. While Beatty unravels to Montag the futility and uselessness of books from the State's ideological point of view, so it is obligatory to burn all books in the city. Montag's increasing and developing awareness of his existence as human brings him closer to Faber, who explains to Montag the human value of books: books give meaning and depth to human life. The development of awareness of knowledge necessity makes Montag read Arnold's poem, *Dover Beach*, to Mildred and her trivial company. They accused him of breaking the rules of book prohibition. Things are getting worse when Montag killed Beatty. This turning-point event makes Montag flee to the wilderness, where he meets a group of intellectuals or book lovers who believe in reading books as a way to build up the new vision of the universe (Bradbury, 2004).

Binarism or binary oppositions are central to the literary creation, especially in drama and fiction. Fictional works of art mostly erected on the opposing struggle between two cosmetic forces as in good and evil, the noble and the villain. These terms are not selected haphazardly. Rather, they are viewed as a coherent system of ideas, and these terms are related to sphere of culture and cultural products. The clash of ideology is artistically sorted

out in various narrative forms, of which is Science Fiction. Heinleni speculates that "a handy short definition of almost all science fiction might read: realistic speculation about possible future events, based solidly on adequate knowledge of the real world, past and present, and on a thorough understanding of the nature and significance of the scientific method" (Franklin & Frank, 1980). Science Fiction, in this sense, is a genre of speculative fiction; it is a form of what has been referred to as a literature of ideas.

Power and Ideology in Fahrenheit 451: Critical Reading

Fahrenheit 451 is a science fiction written by Ray Bradbury. Bradbury is widely known for his dystopian novel Fahrenheit 451. In his commentary remark on the science fiction as narrative genre, Bradbury says: "First of all, I don't write science fiction. I've only done one science fiction book and that's Fahrenheit 451, based on reality. Science fiction is a depiction of the real. Fantasy is a depiction of the unreal". The novel based on real event in the 1950s, in the United States. In that time, a blacklist appeared, it included names of certain filmmakers, actors, and screenwriters who are considered Communists by the FBI, in addition to faculty purging at universities for the same reason (Bradbury, 2018). The sequence of events in Bradbury's Fahrenheit 451 takes place in an anonymous location and an unspecific time. Put simply, the setting is nowhere and everywhere, and this may give the act of burning books its own universality. The political power imposes its ideologies upon its society, and prevents the society and individuals to get knowledge or certain culture, so reading or possessing books is forbidden. Reading books is looked at as a sort of crime by the doctrine of the authoritative powers. This knowledge prohibition, which is based on falsified claims, reshapes the awareness of the people of the city who become hungry eaters of mass culture productions. The modern human situation is getting worst. Therefore, instead of the reading

pleasure, "it was a pleasure to burn". By this devastating sentence starts Fahrenheit 451:

"It was a pleasure to burn. It was a special pleasure to see things eaten, to see things blackened and changes. With the brass nozzle in his fists, with great python spitting its venomous kerosene upon the world, the blood pounded in his head, and his hands were the hands of some amazing conductor playing all the symphonies of blazing and burning to bring down the tatters of and charcoal ruins of history. With his symbolic helmet numbered 451 on his head, and his eyes all orange flame with the thought of what came next, he flicked the igniter and the house jumped up in gorging fire that burned the evening sky and yellow and black. He strode in a swarm of fireflies. He wanted above all, like the old joke, to shove a marshmallow on a stick in the furnace, while the flapping pigeon-winged books died on the porch and lawn of the house, while the books went up in sparkling whirls and blew away on a wind turned dark with burning. Montag grinned the fierce grin of all men signed and driven back by flame" (2004:3).

These earliest lines of the narrative serve as an epilogue to what follows in that sterile world where the mass material culture predominates at the expense of knowledge. What is characteristic about the onset is the style. The setting is symbolic; the style is descriptive. The language of the onset swings between metaphor and metonymy. The diction is mostly derived from the treasury of reality (e.g. brass nozzle, kerosene the igniter, marshmallow, etc.). The onset, moreover, is not without metonymic tokens like with his symbolic helmet numbered 451 on his solid head, or a simile as in He wanted above all, like an old joke, to shove a marshmallow on a stick in the furnace. All these metaphorical modes of expression where the selection of diction witnesses a sort of meaning transfer stand as an analogy to the dystopian State in real. It is the function of language to build up the mental picture of the world. What is significant to point out is that power, in its Foucault's sense is exercised by an identity who executes the ideology of the authoritative class. For Foucault, as has already

been stated, power is not a supernatural phenomenon; it is omnipresent in everyday life. For Foucault power is everywhere, and power relations are embedded in social life. To carry out the ideology of the ruling class, Montag, the fireman, performs the act of burning books. He is pushed to do that while he finds some pleasure in that unfair act, where "his hands were the hands of some amazing conductor plying all the symphonies of blazing and burning to bring down the tatters of and charcoal ruins of history". The mental power, i.e. ideology, is implemented by the physical power, i.e. fire for burning. But is burning books in unnamed city is viewed as an individual act, what about the attitude of the community where the knowledge doomsday takes place and where the flapping pigeon-winged books died on the porch and lawn of the house?

To highlight the image of society in the novel, and since power is a degree of influence exercised in human communities by institutions on individuals. Accordingly, the society in Bradbury's *Fahrenheit 451* is wholly intoxicated and reshaped by the ideology of the political class. While the State totally prohibits the act of reading books, the State, as one institutions and as individuals, encourages the proliferation of mass consumable culture. People in the city is wholly preoccupied with enjoying nature, spending time by themselves, having trivial conversational turns, watch excessive degree of television on wall-size sets and listen to the radio on Seashell Radio. This political strategy leads to the spreading of ignorance and triviality among the communal individuals and in the texture of the society as an adapted human structure. For exposing the representations of the sector (s) of society under the influence of the political ideology, it well to comprehend the semantic organization of the narrative text in quest. Bradbury's *Fahrenheit 451* is fundamentally based on the notion of Binarism or binary oppositions: ignorance vs. knowledge. It is the contrast between the mass consumable culture which is backed by the political ideology or strategy and Intellectualism which is backed by intellectual group or Books

Lovers. In that Panoramic vision, symbolism plays an influential role or function transmitting the message of the narrative text. Of these symbolic signs are the city, the books, fire, blood, the phoenix, and the Salamander. If semiotics is the theory of signification and the way in which meaning is constructed by sign use, this meaning is encoded in a symbolic manner. Therefore, to unravel the meaning(s) in Bradbury's *Fahrenheit 451*, it is of interest to interpret the symbols of the narrative text. The events of *Fahrenheit 451* take place in a city. Strangely, this city is unnamed; it is the location where knowledge is decreased, while ignorance is increased. This anonymous setting may give the hint that this city is everywhere and nowhere: thought it cannot be spotted on the geographical map, but it exists where the unfair human situation exists, where man become a thing due to the oppressive ideology of the State.

This city is populated by humans who are actively idealized in a way to make them stop questioning the world around them. It is place where the human mind is totally paralyzed because of the order of the State. In all human cultures the books represent knowledge. They stand for the enlightened visage of humanity. Books symbolize knowledge and knowledge is a mental power: it is the knowledgeable anti-power to the ignorant power imposed by the authoritative political institution. So, the planned schema of stopping reading books by the individuals of the society, prohibiting them and then burning those serves to stop the human mind to question the political ideology in which the people live by. Here comes the significance of fire as a symbolic token. Fire, the next symbol, is of dyadic sense. In the general sense, the fire is the fourth element of creation in the Greek philosophy. The human progression couldn't be in history without the invention of fire. Fire, however, is manipulated to represent mass destruction against knowledge. In this context, the scene of burning performed by Montag, the fireman, is symbolically descriptive; it is constructed in a metaphorical or connotative style: "With the brass nozzle in his fists, with great python spitting its venomous

kerosene upon the world". Let us consider the selection of the noun python and the epithet venomous to highlight the monstrous process of burning knowledge. Fire also operates in an opposite way. While the fire is destroyer, it can function as creator and reformer too.

When Montag flees to the jungle, he meets a group of humanitarian intellectuals around the fire. It is the reunion of human minds after destruction by the means of fire. The next symbol in importance is blood. In the classical dramatic theories, blood, as a human origin is related to human nature and human mood. In the novel in quest, bold stands for repression of the soul. The hero's infatuations and fits are circulated in his blood: "the blood pounded in his head, and his hands were the hands of some amazing conductor playing all the symphonies of blazing and burning to bring down the tatters of and charcoal ruins of history". The primal psyche of Montag's active even when he performs the destructive act of burning. While the hearth in the symbolic heritage symbioses the fireplace or home, the salamander represents the anti-fire mythic creator, which is officially attributed to firemen and their fire trucks. In its mythic sense, the salamander cannot be consumed by fire.

Bradbury wittingly uses the symbols, as that of the fire and the salamander, is a contradictory style to deepen the tragic human situation when it is politicized and reshaped by unfair and unjust powers. On the same track of mythology is the snake. In Human symbolic traditions, the snakes symbolizes differently. The snake might be a symbol of evil, as in the myth of Orpheus. The might be a symbol of life as in the token of pharmacy, or it has its sacredness, as in the Indian ritual traditions. Bradbury's Fahrenheit 451, the snake is mentioned as the Electric – Eyed Snake machine. In the quoted phrase, the sense of the snake is taken away from its mythical context to have a dead technological meaning. Modern technology destroys the primal soul of man, a character like Mildred , becomes the obedient salve to the Electric–Eyed Snake machine. This is an additions contrast between Montag in his

burning blood and Mildred in her frozen blood because of her addiction to modern technology. Modern technology is invented for the welfare of mankind, but too much absorption and obsession in modern technology may lead to self-slavery and psychic corruption. All these connotative or incongruent expressions may create the hellish life in a dystopian State as that of Fahrenheit 451. Symbolically, the Electric-Eyed Snake machine might represent the developmental stage of modern technology in the human race and history.

Reading Fahrenheit 451 closely unravels that there is a sense of critique to modern technology in ruling modern human life. Bradbury's novel is based in a futuristic time where technology rules our lives and books are viewed as a bad thing because it brews free thought. Although today's technological advances haven't caught with Bradbury's F 451, there is a very danger that society might end up relying on technology at the price of intellectual development. Treading the path of symbols and symbolism, the names are deliberately selected to serve meaning and meaning-making in the walks of the novel. Montag's meaning the active soul, serves as a foil to Mildred, meaning mild spirit. While Montag daily deals with the force of fire, Mildred is preoccupied with luxurious life and silly talks. Beatty's name refers to tough leadership with his stubborn and aggressive attitudes towards books, education, and knowledge in general. Ironically he quotes Pop's lines of verse to persuade Montag of the futility of learning. He serves as a foil to Faber, whose name stands for enjoying change and developing intellectuality. Clarisse's name, the young girl who is killed by car accident, implicitly refers to brightness, mildness and glamour. It is Clarisse's words which bring the cultural shock and, then, the dramatic change to Montag's personality. Clarisse stands beside Montag in his change. In this fatal visionary image, even the characters and their names become symbols operating in a reciprocal way to build up the mental world of the novel. The characters are painted in different characterization and individualization.

Rimmon comments on the term characterization by saying that character can be described in terms of a network of character traits. By assembling various character indicators distributed along the text-continuum and, when necessary, inferring the traits from them, it is these indicators that are defined as characterization. When a character uses a language of distinctively individual features, this specific use of language is referred to as individualization (Rimmon-Kenan, 2002). Kermode thinks that "Shakespeare characterizes his dramatic persona fully as much as their words as by their actions". Every voice is so individualized (Kermode, 1974).

Fahrenheit 451 starts with an ironic sentence structure; it was a pleasure to burn. Burning books, not extinguishing them, is not a pleasurable process by itself. But in a sterile society dominated and conditioned by the ideology which claims that books are dangerous to the human mind; burning knowledge becomes a normal process. In terms of Foucault, Ideology is a set of strategies- mental in origin- but they are inactivated by physical power, i.e. fire to destroy knowledge (i.e. Books) in a systematic system (proclaiming of danger of books, stopping reading them, burning them). The real motif is to stop the human mind from questioning the secret of his existence and the refutation of the source of suffering because of the controlling political powers that rule societies in severe inhuman manners. In consequence the ignorant members of the society become slaves to modern technology and political propaganda.

Beatty implicitly is marketing the political propaganda of the authoritative ruling class that knowledge, even in small doses, may intoxicate mind, so, it is necessary not to read at all. Hence, while Montag uses fire to destroy books by burning them, Beatty, in his conversational turn with Montag, tries to persuade him not to read books because reading is a dangerous process to the mind. Beatty unravels to Montag that people need leisure and entertainment, not insight and questioning; what reading books brings is sadness and overstress. If Mildred and Beatty are the representatives of

consumable material culture led by the ideology of the ruling powers, the Intellectual side is represented by Clarisse, Faber, and the Intellectuals in the wood. What is interesting here is to unlock the relationship between the seventeen-year-old young girl and Montag. Preoccupied with his job as a fireman burning the book in a reshaped city, carrying out the orders of the State, Montag is questioned by Clarisse about whether he reads the books he is burning and whether he feels happy in doing that destructive process. In reality, these inquiries ignite or trigger the awareness of the fireman; he restarts to reassess his life and career differently. Clarisse remains the catalyst which causes a cultural shock to the fireman. He starts keeping books and reading them; he becomes closer to Faber, the retired academic mind. After his escape to the jungle, here comes the river, which Montag floats as a dividing line between the unworthy past of the fireman and the life of meaning which he lives by in his new culture. The protagonist since the cultural shock he undergoes brings a dramatic change to his whole care. With life of meaning, there should be hope and progress for mankind.

From the perspective of Marxist criticism, the narrative text showed the role of ideology and the clash of classes. The novel presented conflict between the ruling class, which imposes its ideology using force and violence, and the educated class, which adopts intellectual resistance, and believes that knowledge is the path to freedom and the hope for a better future. The writer adopts the idea of defending the oppressed class, and the novel represents propaganda against arbitrariness exercised by absolute power. It supports the aspirations of the oppressed community in freedom and a better life.

CONCLUSION

Bradbury's *Fahrenheit 451*, as a well-known narrative text, it depicted the events from socio-political and historical perspective. What is unique about this study is that it analyses the narrative point of view from Foucault's intellectual perspectives and from

Marxist stance. The French thinker stresses the interconnectedness of ideology to power and how the ruling States reshapes human mind in dystopian communities. Through the analysis, the study has shown the clash of ideologies or, more specifically, the clash of epistemic systems, and revealed the games played by the political powers to annihilate human awareness and identity. In a sterile society dominated and conditioned by the ideology of the State which claims that books are dangerous to the human mind, so burning knowledge becomes a normal process. Literature is a mode of communication; it communicates the readers with the realities of the world with view of different intellectuals in order to seek experience and knowledge. These realities of the world are artistically encoded in the imaginatively works of arts, more specifically in the narrative literary form. This is true to Bradbury's *Fahrenheit 451*. This is an a science fiction standing for a certain actual society accustomed to materialism and ruled by the ideology of the Sate. What lies beneath the surface structure of the novel is the conceptual network system of ideology and power. Ideology and power, as the research study has shown, are inseparable in theory and practice- they are the two faces of the dystopian Sate, where people's awareness is reshaped in a way to increase trivial entertainment and ignorance, and decrease knowledge and faith. Still, the cultural shock that has happened to the protagonist in his spiritual suffering leads to a new life which is full of hope in the futurity of man. The characters' visions, aspirations and worldviews are encoded into associate incongruent style which gives the fabric of *Fahrenheit 451* its universality as a par excellent narrative of politics.

Dehumanization in Orwell's Dystopian Novels: An Overview on Totalitarianism and Ideology

Abstract

Dehumanization of the individual and deformation of humankind are regarded as the prolific ideology of dystopia and dystopian States. Driven by this idea, the current paper renders an overview of how totalitarian regimes abuse their absolute power in order to exploit, deform, and overpower people that eventually resulted in the disaster of corruption in communities. Such an assumption could be applied to Orwell's two novels, "*Animal Farm*" (1945) and "*Nineteen Eighty-Four*" (1949), as narrative texts. It is hypothesized that the deformation of human nature is not intrinsic. Instead, it is the ideologies which are inhuman, and imposed by totalitarian regimes, that cause people's anguish physically and psychologically. To unfold such intricacy, this paper investigates the relationship between totalitarian power and ideology. The primary object of this study is to relate the concept of absolute power and power abuse exercised by totalitarianism, through its corrupt ideology, to corruption that leads to dystopia, then to the dehumanization, deformation of man, and reshaping human culture in a dystopian State. As analytical approaches, Marxist literary criticism and CDA are adopted to analyse the conceptual framework of this study. The findings of this paper assert that the exercises of totalitarian regimes lead to corruption and create dystopia. Thus, it concludes that this could build up the misery of humankind, eventually leading to the mental and cultural deformation in dystopian States. The significance of this paper lies in tackling a dominant phenomenon in the history of humankind linked to totalitarianism. Thus, it contributes to providing a better understanding of the dehumanization of man and the inhuman

situation under the unjust ruling of totalitarian regimes depicted in literary works.

Keywords: Totalitarianism, Culture, Ideology, "Dystopia", George Orwell, "Animal Farm", "Nineteen Eighty-Four"

Introduction

The conflict of wills or ideologies among the political, religious, economic, or social forces has been observed by scholars in the domain of history, politics, and philosophy. As a mental structure for our life, literature historically encodes the everlasting political clash between unjust totalitarian regimes and peoples. Dobrolyubov "asserted that literature should be active and aimed at societal development, and he criticized works that, in his view, did not reflect the life of society or contribute to its progress"(Ahmed, 2024, p.872). During the 20th century, the narratives encoding the suffering of people and their hope of living in good circumstances were greatly spread. The value of literature is based on the hypothesis that literary works and art must be served in struggling against the system of vice and corruption as an effective means. Thus, dystopian literature emerged as a new genre of literature. It is a narrative genre that is used by modern novelists to unmask the dark aspects of people's lives caused by evil powers and oppressors. Suciú mentioned that "dystopia has connected its roots with disaster in the thought of the twentieth century" (Suciú, 2013, p. 685). Thus, "the modern novel became more realistic, vivid and popular than the written novels in previous periods in English literature, because, rather than just imagination, it dealt with the important events that affected the real world and literature" (Abbas, 2021, p.27). The dystopian novels basically reveal the totalitarian regimes that came to light after the rise of Stalin and Hitler and other dictators in power. Backes, according to Arendt, defines the totalitarian regime by saying: it "is a regime that controls every aspect of the life of the people", wherein "people living under this type of regime generally also support it, thanks to extensive propaganda missions

that are designed to promote a positive view of the government"(Backes, 2007, p. 8). Likewise, Beauchamp believes "totalitarianism to be a matchless threat in human history, more terrifying on account of more total than any preceding form of tyranny" (Beauchamp, 1986, p. 57). Among the most famous dystopian novels in the world during the 20th century are "*Animal Farm*" and "*Nineteen Eighty-Four*", written by George Orwell. Inspired by above discourses, this paper attempts to establish a correlation between the notions of ideology and culture that were wittingly used by the totalitarian forces to dehumanize humankind and reshape man's identity by and through power abuse.

Thus, the research problem of this paper has been formulated by considering the inhuman situation as encoded in the two novels under the study, and addressing the dehumanization of the individual and the deformation of humankind in a dystopian society controlled by totalitarian power through certain ideologies. The primary objective of this paper is to relate the concept of absolute power and power abuse exercised by totalitarianism, through its corrupt ideology, to corruption that leads to dystopia, then to the dehumanization, deformation of man, and reshaping human culture in a dystopian State. However, to tackle the problem of this study and achieve its objective, a research question arises: how would totalitarian forces dehumanize, deform, and reshape human culture in a dystopian State? Through critical analysis of the selected novels of George Orwell, the current paper intends to unearth a deep understanding of the concept of totalitarianism (absolute power) towards human visions. The study undertakes Marxist literary criticism and CDA as analytical approaches to analyse the narrative structures of these literary works. So, the author of the two texts and the external social, political, and historical context in which these texts were produced will be considered. Dobrolyubov "believed that criticism should be based on facts and objective evaluation. According to him, realistic criticism is based on the realistic analysis of literary works, rather than the subjective impressions of the

critic."(Ahmed, 2024, p.872). The significance of this paper lies in the confirmation of the moral and social function of these literary works. It tackles a dominant phenomenon in the history of humankind, which is linked to totalitarianism and abuse of power. Thus, the current paper contributes to providing a better understanding of the dehumanization of man and the inhuman situation under the unjust ruling of totalitarian regimes depicted in literary works. The study also contributes to enlarging the body of research on dystopian literature in general, and especially the two dystopian novels by Orwell: "*Nineteen Eighty-Four*" and "*Animal Farm*".

Findings and Discussion

The conceptual framework of this paper will be analysed in the following sections:

Culture

In the structure of politics and the history of thought, the concept of culture is central. Diversified definitions relate culture to assorted fields of humanities and social sciences related to theory of knowledge, philosophy and psychology. Culture, in one's viewpoint, is the network of beliefs, behaviors, and thinking patterns. Every human group on the planet has its own culture. Thus, "a universal term like culture is difficult to define since the term is dealt with differently within different human fields, however, culture, in the general sense, is a network system of beliefs, behaviors and patterns of thinking" (Abbas, & Sandaran, 2019, p.1150). Thus, culture is "a way of life of a group of people, the behaviors, beliefs, values, and symbols that they accept, generally without thinking about them, and that are passed along communication and imitation from one generation to the next" (Choudhury, 2014, p.2). Gramsci, an Italian Marxist philosopher, investigated the way in which culture is used by the political totalitarian regimes as a prolific means for reshaping the identity of individuals in dystopian societies. Through cultural hegemony, the theory that was introduced by Gramsci interpreted how the

political totalitarian governments dominated the passions and minds of the masses, not only by through strength and violence, but through a consistent order of concepts to help the totalitarian regimes' purposes (ABBAS, 2021, p.45).

Cultural hegemony depicted "how the state and ruling capitalist class, the bourgeoisie utilized the cultural institutions to uphold power in capital societies. In Gramsci's outlook the bourgeoisie developed a hegemonic culture using ideology rather than violence, economic force or coercion"(Haralambos, 2013, p.597). The hegemonic culture of totalitarian regimes spreads its own norms and values in order to be the familiar beliefs of entire society, and then preserve the current situation of domination. Gramsci very much spread out this idea and made a severe study to reveal capitalists as a ruling class could establish and maintain their dominance (Anderson, 1976, pp.5–78). Ideology, as to Gramsci, was "the analysis of ideas; more precisely, the search for the origin of ideas". From Gramsci's perspective, "a class or a social group from the start had a first level of existence, which was mostly economic" (Sabau, 2013, p.23). Gramsci referred to further social communities that underwent collective oppression inside many dystopian States.

Ideology

As mentioned above, culture is a network system of practices and doctrines that connect to one another, and then the central to that system is ideology. For van Dijk, "ideologies have something to do with systems of ideas and especially with the social, political or religious ideas shared by a social group or movement", so, ideology is "systems of ideas of social groups and movements", and "ideologies make sense in order to understand the world, from the point of view of the group, and as a basis for the social practices of group members"(ABBAS, 2021, p.45). One judges a certain ideology (especially popular ideologies such as communism, socialism, liberalism, etc.) as negative or positive based on one's own point of view or the point of view of the

members of the group to which one belongs. (Schäffner, 2003, pp. 23-42). Mayr believes that "Definitions usually fall into two broad categories: a relativist definition, denoting systems of ideas, beliefs and practices, and a critical definition, allied with Marxist theory, which sees it as working in the interests of a social class and/or cultural group. When critical discourse analysts argue that discourse embodies ideological assumptions, they use the term ideology in a critical sense" (Mayr, 2008, p. 10).

In order to persuade and subject societies to their total authority, the totalitarian power, in the novels under the study, depends on promoting its own ideologies through discourse and propaganda. To retain its own interests and its power, processes of distortion of these ideologies and manipulation were used by the ruling class from time to time. The process of manipulation, according to Van Dijk, becomes the powerful strategy that has been adopted by the totalitarian power for controlling people's minds and individuals through internalizing and distorting specific ideologies and beliefs by using language and discourse (ABBAS, 2021, p. 45). In Orwell's two novels under the study, totalitarian regimes greatly used the process of manipulation in language and discourse in order to impose their ideologies and to control people's minds. It's worth mentioning that "ideology, for Marx, is related to manipulation, and capitalist relations are essentially rooted in ideologies and not only in economic relations" (Abass & et al., 2021, P. 25).

Using specific language and discourse, from Van Dijk perspective, is "critical social practices influenced by ideologies", that leads to effect on "how we acquire, learn or change ideologies" (Van Dijk, 2000, p. 9). Eagleton stressed on the realistic aspect of ideology, and mentioned that "ideology is not in the first place is a set of doctrines, ideology signifies the way men live out their roles in class-society, the values, ideas, and images which tie them to their social functions and so prevent them from a true knowledge of society as a whole" (Eagleton, 1976, p. 8). Besides, Eagleton makes a connection between ideology and arts by saying: "all art

springs from an ideological conception of the world" (Eagleton, 1976, p.15). To generate a systematic network among culture, ideology, and power, some scholars commented that culture interprets the notion of ideology, since ideology is viewed as a mental system. Therefore, ideology is divergent from power, because ideology is a mental practice, while power is a physical one. Overall, the totalitarian regimes use these devices to dehumanize and consequently deform human nature as emphasized hereunder.

Totalitarianism and totalitarian regime

When a nation is ruled oppressively by a dictator based on his desires and interests, this type of government is known as totalitarianism. In such regime corruption is a definite consequence, where the public resources or powers are abused for personal gain. Thus, the emanating brutality and oppression can radically alter human behavior transforming normal human beings into selfish servants for the ruling government. The goals and plans of such ruler "being very extreme often described as total or totalitarian wherein such regime controls every part of human life" (Gregory, 2000, p.40). Propaganda totally controlled over mass media. More thoroughly, the totalitarian power holders are able to indoctrinate their subjects with passionate and unconditional loyalties to the political regime, by using psychological methods for thought reforming (Wrong, 1995, p.21). Generally, "oppressed people living under such government support it, transforming the classes into masses without any identity, however, a fierce loyalty to so-called a leader" (Arendt, 1973, p.341).

The twentieth century witnessed tragic scenes in our real world after several oppressive and inhuman totalitarian political regimes came to power, such as "Stalin in the Soviet Union, Hitler in Germany, and Mao's Communists in China. Harshly, about one hundred million people were killed by these totalitarian regimes". (ABBAS, 2021, p.45). However, in the twentieth century there were many dictators who remained in power for a long time and brought destruction, tragedy and severe suffering to their people.

George Orwell in his two novels could describe accurately the activity of such totalitarian regimes for attaining and maintaining the power. Besides totalitarianism capitalism was emerged, wherein the lower class of society was exploited by the upper class, who controlled the economy. Consequently, the devastating effect of dictatorship and capitalists was the generation of dystopian.

Corruption

The meaning of corruption has been dealt out in this paper from the political, ideological and social sides of this concept. Power abuse, politically, socially, religiously, financially...etc., means corruption. Inside the novels under study, all life aspects of societies are penetrated by corruption due to the practices of totalitarian regimes, which abuse their power, that govern societies inside the literary texts, wherein social, ideological and political corruption is widespread (ABBAS, 2021, p.45). Werlin states: "corruption is robbing people the opportunities they fought for" (Werlin, 2013, p.4). There is an interconnection between absolute power and corruption, and the relationship between them is cause and effect, i.e. where absolute power exists, corruption will therefore exist, and this paper investigates this relationship in Orwell's two novels. Waite & Allen mention that; "corruption is the misuse of public power for private and personal benefit" (Waite and Allen, 2003, p.282). However, corruption prevents society from having its freedoms and rights. Thus, all aspects of the state and all aspects of life in society were affected by corruption within the novels under the study. Consequently, it creates a dystopian society and, lastly, leads to society deterioration due to the clash of classes. Therefore, it can be said that corruption linked to absolute power eats away at society and contributes to the dehumanization of society and individuals, and this is what Orwell has depicted in his two novels under this study.

Dystopia and dystopian State

The concept of 'dystopia' has been presented to be related to the totalitarian regime and its corruption in Orwell's two novels. 'Utopia' and 'Dystopia' are two distinct terms exist in modern fictional literary studies. The concept of 'Utopia' means an imaginary ideal place where the conditions of social life are ideal with a just government and ideal laws that grant rights and freedoms to society and achieve social justice. Contrariwise, the term 'Dystopia' means a very bad place where the conditions are the worst, and in it people are governed in a dehumanized way. In a dystopian society, everything is bad, and often people live their lives in fear and anxiety. The term dystopia was first mentioned in history in 1868 in a speech by the British politician John Stuart Mill, who used the word metaphorically to indicate a bad place. Later, the term became commonly used to indicate an oppressed society living under authoritarian rule, yet its members claim that their living conditions are perfect and ideal. About thirty years after the term "dystopia" emerged, two narrative texts inspired by the meaning of the term were published: "When the Sleeper Wakes" and "The Story of the Days to come" (Navrátil, 2008, p.12). The corrupt methods and means used to control society and state institutions are what create a dystopia. Yet, a dystopian society pretends to be good and presents itself as a utopian, concealing most of its problems and suffering. The state totally controls all economic activities and use propaganda to deceive people by convincing them that their living conditions are good under the political regime. Suciú stated that "dystopia connected its roots with disaster in thought of the twentieth century" (Suciú, 2013, p. 685). The dystopian novel, as a genre that flourished during the last century, which reflect the prevailing concepts of absolute political power and the emergence of the totalitarian and dictatorial regimes as the worst political regimes which established due to the great events in the last century, such as the two World Wars, inventing of the nuclear bomb, and technological advances.

A Coherent Network of Totalitarianism and Dystopia

There is a deep rooted connection between totalitarianism and corruption, and dystopia comes as a final result of this connection. They together form a coherent network as encoded in Orwell's two novels. Totalitarianism is established to be a kind of cruel and oppressive government wherein a dictator rules the country based on his personal will. Unfortunately, human history, especially in the last century, is replete with dictatorial and totalitarian regimes and their horrifying effects on the societies they ruled. The term totalitarianism was defined by Brzezinski (1962) as:

"A new form of government falling into the general classification of dictatorship, a system in which technologically advanced instrument of political power are wielded without restraint by centralized leadership of an elite movement for the purpose of affecting a total social revolution, including the conditioning of man on the basis of certain arbitrary ideological assumptions, proclaimed by the leadership in an atmosphere of coerced unanimity of the entire population" (47).

Totalitarianism is a type of government that controls everything starting from individual to entire society. There are two basic concepts that represent the characteristics of a totalitarian system: (1) totalitarianism has its own philosophy that aims to subjugate the entire society to its authority, and (2) totalitarianism is a doctrine of coercion or compulsion, as the entire society must carry out the orders of the authority without question or hesitation. The head of the regime, the ruling dictator, has absolute control over the people, does not allow any voice of opposition, and often brutally punishes those who oppose his rule. The dictator also changes laws, principles, and values whenever he wants, according to his personal will, interests, and desires. In our contemporary history, after World War I, a group of brutal totalitarian regimes emerged in a number of countries around the world. These regimes came to power by riding the wave of revolutions that erupted in their countries. At first, these regimes

claimed that they came to provide their people with a better life on the path to freedom and prosperity. However, their true nature was soon exposed, as the leaders of the revolutions transformed into tyrannical totalitarian rulers, such as Stalin, Hitler, Franco, and Mussolini in Russia, Germany, Spain, and Italy.

Suciu mentioned that "George Orwell in Nineteen Eighty-Four connected the abuse of human value as a heinous trait of totalitarianism; the new ideals of totalitarianism control the present and future of the masses" Suciu explained that "Orwell showed the motives of dictatorship through dialogue between O'Brien and Winston during the latter's questioning, wherein the writer used his imagination to create perfect scenarios of dystopia, and he could actually foresee the future and create the allegory of the future through narrative works"(Suciu, 2013, p.681). At the beginning of the last century, with technological advancements, technology became an important factor in strengthening the dominance of totalitarian regimes over their people. Arendt cited Hitler's model wherein he climbed up to authority through the mass system and stayed ruling, despite the party's conflict, by taking the support of the masses. The same thing happened to Stalin. Propaganda was largely used to form such masses. In fact, totalitarianism had absolute control and propaganda was substituted for indoctrination, leading to violence not just to specifically frighten individuals and society, but to convey a real sense of ideological dogma (Arendt, 1973, p.341).

George Orwell

The famous novel by Orwell, "Nineteen Eighty-Four", written in 1949, predicted a bleak future world divided between the major superpowers, where government propaganda is the effective tool by which people are governed. Conversely, the other famous novel written by Orwell in 1945, "Animal Farm", is a bitter satire on totalitarian Communists. When he was inspired by a political purpose, Orwell could be creative in his writing and perform at his best as a writer. So, the primary motivation for writing is "a

feeling of partisanship, a sense of injustice, a lie to be exposed or something to be drawn attention to" (George, 1994, p.5). Orwell confronted the power structures of the capitalist system within Great Britain as well as within the broader sphere of politics, power, and ideological conflicts. All of this enabled Orwell to acquire a penetrating and distinctive political vision. He briefly and clearly defined the new intellectual direction of writing by saying: "Every line of serious work that I have written since 1936 has been written, directly or indirectly against totalitarianism, and for democratic socialism, as I understand it" (Orwell, 1994, p.5). Orwell wrote that "Every writer, especially every novelist, has a 'message', whether he admits it or not and the minutest details of his work are influenced by it, and all art is propaganda" (Crick, 1981, p.378). Regarding the abuse of power and the ways in which it was used to deprive people of their rights and freedoms, Orwell had a very important and urgent message that he wanted to convey to the world and to all of humanity. Orwell wanted to attack all the ways and methods that lead to the control of man (the ruler) over man (the ruled). Through the writing of these two novels, Orwell was able to expose the destructive role of totalitarian power and its corruption, which caused disasters and tragedy for the people of the earth everywhere.

In order to analyse the two novels, under the study, through the political perspectives, this paper focuses on Orwell's political ideas in his literary works, particularly the two novels under study, and the way he expressed these ideas to convey to readers his inner world and ideological stances toward the issues of his time. Connelly mentioned Orwell by saying: "his reputation lies in the independent standing in era dominated by rigid party. He wrote clearly and directly without hesitating. Furthermore, he was brave enough to attack the existing system, and writing dystopian scenarios for the future. He valued personal liberty more than anything and he feared that it could be lost under dominance of existing totalitarian systems" (Connelly, 1987, p. 28). Therefore,

Orwell is counted as one of the pivotal and prominent figures in the history of English literature.

Orwell was not just a writer and author; he was a man who carried people's concerns and was a conscious politician who sought to make people aware of the hidden truths that were the cause of their social problems. Orwell believed that literature had a social and moral function, so it should not be limited to esthetics, especially in an age like ours. He despised the arrogant attitude of his contemporaries and accused them of living in ivory tower. He emphasized "the value of writing as a kind of weapon that must be directed against the vice of the system" (Crick, 1981, p.380). Orwell insisted that "The invasion of literature by politics was bound to happen" (Orwell, 1968, p.59). From Orwell's perspective, the transition to a better world and a fair reality could only be achieved through social structural change and political reform (Orwell, 1968, p.60).

Animal Farm

The novel starts with a strong call for animals to start revolution to expel their master human, the owner of the farm, Mr. Jones, who abused the animals. Old Major tries to inspire all animals to revolt against the cruel human owner, "Let's face it, our lives are miserable, laborious and short" (Orwell, 2001, p. 27). Old Major "tells the animals his dream in the form of the song (Beasts of England) of unity among animals living together in peace without being tyrannized, oppressed, or controlled by humans" (Khorsand and Salmani, 2014, p.225). After the revolution, and expulsion of Mr. Jones, the pigs adopted a specific flag for their farm as well as chose their own national anthem, and before that, the name of the farm was changed from "Manor Farm" to "Animal Farm". Furthermore, the three leading pigs of the revolution, Napoleon, Snowball, and Squealer "elaborated old Major's teachings into a complete system of thought, they called it Animalism"(Orwell, 2001, p.38). Later, the major two leaders, Napoleon and Snowball, achieved success in decreasing the concept of "Animalism", which

was built on Old Major's ideologies, to "The Seven Commandments" as "an unalterable law by which all the animals on Animal Farm must live forever after" (Orwell, 2001, p.42). The pigs came to authority and ruled the farm. After the revolution succeeded and the animals took over the farm, the animals no longer tire of working long hours for the common good. "The Seven Commandments" is an expression taken from religious texts and is a model of familiar and euphemism expressions, "a word which is substituted for a more conventional or familiar" (Fairclough, 2001, p. 97). Religion was used by the pigs as a means of dominating the animals because they believed that the true source of inspiration for animals is religion. Thus, religious ideology and its influence were used as a means of controlling and dominating the animals. This pig politics was exposed by Orwell from the beginning of the novel. Karl Marx described "the effect of religion as the opium of the people" (Papke, 2015, p.1). From Marxist criticism view, this reveals the role of ideology in this literary narrative text by Orwell.

The principles of 'Animalism' or "The Seven Commandments", includes three main axes; 1) The first two commandments defined the characteristics of the enemies of animals and the characteristics of those who are their friends. (1. "Whatever goes upon two legs is an enemy", and 2. "Whatever goes upon four legs, or has wings, is a friend") (Orwell, 2001, p.42). This is an ideological concept that establishes the principle of hostility towards humans in general, who have persecuted animals and caused their suffering. 2) Instructions, orders, and laws that are forbidden to be violated are specified in the third, fourth, fifth, and sixth commandments. (3. "No animal shall wear clothes", 4. "No animal shall sleep in a bed", 5. "No animal shall drink alcohol", 6. "No animal shall kill any other animal") (Orwell, 2001, p.42). Pigs wrote in the texts of these commandments; "No" to emphasize the prohibition, and "shall" to indicate a command. The text confirms on the compulsory action, as it is an order or rule. 3) The last commandment No.7 The last commandment (No. 7)

emphasizes a fundamental principle: equality among farm animals in terms of rights and duties; 7. "All animals are equal"(Orwell, 2001, p.42).

There are activities and practices associated with human behavior that were originally strictly prohibited by the Seven Commandments. But Napoleon and Squealer began to engage in partaking them, such as trading, drinking alcohol, living in a house, and sleeping in beds. Ultimately, the pigs' betrayal happened when they established a good relationship with Mr. Jones. So, they started altering the commandments according to this 'humanization', in order to legitimize and justify their violation of these commandments, as well as to find new ideologies that support and give legitimacy to their absolute authority. The pigs practiced manipulation and distortion by using language and discourse as a means of deceiving the rest of the animals, in order to promote ideologies that serve their own interests. So they revised five commandments out of seven commandments, knowing that the first commandment was revised twice. For example they practiced of manipulation and distortion by employing under-lexicalization of strategy that refers to "the phenomenon in which a lexical item that would precisely refer to a concept, is deliberately avoided, suppressed, or substituted for another one" (Fairclough, 1992, p.193). Manipulation "is considered as a delicately ingenious strategy for influencing the minds of an audience or readership through the distortion and internalization of certain beliefs, values, attitudes, or ideologies" (Van Dijk, 1999, p.465). Using Language and discourse is the "critical social practices influenced by ideologies", which in turn also influence "how we acquire, learn or change ideologies" (Van Dijk, 2000, p.9). Foucault believed that "ideology was a level of speculative discourse that could explain the power"(Daldal, 2014, p.154). The hypocrisy of the pigs is clearly revealed through the distortion of the Seven Commandments and the deception and exploitation of the animals. Therefore, the evidence of the corruption of the pigs' power, which was unexpected at the

beginning of the revolution, is the change in the commandments and the emptying of them from their true content.

The Seven Commandments could be considered the cornerstone of this novel, and the foundation on which Orwell has built his novel, because the idea of 'The Seven Commandments' tackle the concepts of absolute power, corruption, ideology, class, identity, and dystopian society. The flag of the farm, the national anthem, and the seven commandments (a metaphor for the Constitution), these symbols indicate that the farm is a metaphor for a State. By reading the historical context in which this novel has been written and the ideology of the writer, this state is Russia, the revolution is the revolution of 1917, and 'Animalism' refers to communism, thus Old Major refers to Marx, and Napoleon represents Stalin. Mr. Jones and Napoleon both could dominate the entire society and economy for their personal interests, they did it in different way, but both exploited the animals. Monica mentioned "that Marx wanted a classless society but this never materialized" (Monica, 2011, p.38). It can be said that this novel reflects Orwell's political and social view of the world around him. Orwell's anti-communism is evident in the themes of this novel, which confirms the connection between the Bolshevik Revolution in Russia, Marx, Stalin, and Trotsky with the pigs of the farm, and the revolution of animals in the novel. Nonetheless, Orwell's goal in this novel was not only a stinging critique, but an attack on totalitarianism in general and Stalin and communism in Russia in particular, rather a universal appeal. Orwell employed the artistic skill of a metaphorical farm of animals to symbolize the whole world. In this novel, Orwell portrayed a real-life image of the way in which humans act towards humans when they come into power. This novel showed evidently that the leaders of the revolution who were attacking previous power and its corruption turned into ruthless dictators once they gained absolute power. Orwell suggested that "leadership and power must involve responsibility to operate as a safety valve for corruption and the abuse of power" (Khan, 2017, p.637).

Nineteen Eighty-Four

This novel presented a totalitarian regime that surrounded and suffocated a society and practiced oppression against masses. With this insight, Orwell depicted the terrified scene of the society inside the text that looks like a nightmare. He described the ways used by the totalitarian regime to controlled people, and explained the apparatus' ruling functions (Huang, 2012, p.18). Orwell, in this novel, predicted the state and life of a man who was cruelly intimidated, tortured, and finally subjected to brainwashing in the favor of the totalitarian regime. The author of the novel portrayed the oppressed society of "Oceania", in which Orwell created several burner and destructive organizations to depict the totalitarian ruling of the dictator. These organizations involve; "Ministry of Truth", its task is to distort the records of history, "Ministry of Peace", its task to conduct wars, "Ministry of Love", its task is to create hatred, and "Ministry of Plenty", its task is to plan for economic scarcity. Beside these administrations, Orwell presented some foundations such as; "Junior Anti-Sex League", "Thought Police", and "the Junior Spy for national security". In addition to surveillance, "Thought Police" was assigned the duty of arresting people (Orwell, 2003, p.22). The novel showed totalitarianism in its peak. However, Orwell demonstrated the totalitarian regime by showing its consequences on the life of an individual. Orwell explained how, under totalitarian rule, man is transformed into miserable, shackled slaves. This illustrates the danger and brutality of totalitarianism. This novel was unlike "Animal Farm" which illustrated the effects of a totalitarian regime on the entire society.

A man in his thirties named Winston considered getting rid of the grip of the totalitarian regime and sought to free himself, but he was afraid of the brutal punishment that awaited him if he were caught. The novel "Nineteen Eighty-Four" tells the story of Winston (the protagonist), a poor proletarian, isolated, depressed, and sexually starved. Winston worked for the "Ministry of Truth," and his task was to falsify history, replacing old characters and

events with new ones and then burning the original historical records. Through this work, he supported and propped up the totalitarian regime (Orwell, 2003, p.32). Winston and his mistress Julia fell into a taboo, and he was subjected to serious criticism as a result of their sexual relationship with Julia, because sex was considered a political act forbidden by the totalitarian regime (Howe, 1983, 112). Society in "Nineteen Eighty-Four" was chopped into three classes: "Ruling Class", "Ignorant Outer Party", and "The Poles" who were looked as stupid people. In this novel, the author clearly portrayed the classes' difference. Awan and Raza mentioned that "totalitarian dictatorship stressed complete submission of the masses where no one could go against it and all individuals must show complete obedience" (Awan and Raza, 2016, p.25). The totalitarian regime of Big Brother cruelly tortured Winston, and the purpose of tormenting him was not to kill him, but to destroy Winston's soul and spirit. Thus, Winston became no person, nothing, or non-existent. Winston started suffering from a sense of annihilation. Eventually, he was reshaped to be loyal to Big Brother's regime. Winston surrendered himself and his will to Big Brother and transformed into a un-person from person so-called nothing (Awan and Raza, 2016, p.26). Political issues indeed exploited the social values. In this regard, hatreds mattered a lot as individuals started loathing the figures of political leadership or they started loathing the life itself, while some uneducated and unaware people started holy the commanders and look at them as gods. "Nineteen Eighty-Four" elucidated the brutality that was practiced by political dominated regime. Moreover, Ideologies were exploited badly and people faced dehumanization (Awan and Raza, 2016, p.29).

Studying the connection of power, ideology, and language is the aim of Critical Discourse Analysis. It offers a critical reading of diverse and different discourses especially political propaganda, the literary discourse of the political narrative is no exception. Critical Discourse Analysis provides answers to questions like; how a social group has been presented in certain discourse, and as

a means to confirm a group dominance, how could ideological socio-politically discourse of this group be constructed. So, from Critical Discourse Analysis perspective it could be said, in the world where totalitarianism is dominating, the reason behind remaining the oppressed mass under oppression is the loss of its own discourse (Huang, 2012, p.32). In Orwell's Nineteen Eighty-Four, the totalitarian regime drew its power through its own discourse, and its ideologies imposed in that discourse. Constitution of totalitarian power could be observed in the novel, in addition the interactive impact of power discourse upon the society, and the significance of discourse in political conflict and social life.

Orwell depicted the discourse of hegemony and described the people under oppression in his novel, he exposed the real intention of the dictator (Big Brother) behind his discourse to manipulate and deceive his people for more controlling and power. Orwell clearly depicted the corruption of the totalitarian regime (Huang, 2012, 34). Orwell presented the system of power in Nineteen Eighty-Four, its rules of operation and structure. He described in details; discourse of the ruler of control apparatuses (Big Brother), Doublethink, Newspeak, and Telescreen. In addition, Room 101, depicted by Orwell, may be one of the harshest places in the novel's geography, and it strongly exposes the horror of the totalitarian regime. It's a special room for horrific torture, located in the basement of the "Ministry of Love." This room truly embodies a world of fear and terror, as the prisoner who enters it faces a horrific nightmare he could never have imagined. In this way, the prisoner's will is broken, his resistance is ended, and his spirit is shattered. The prisoner is then brainwashed and transformed into an individual loyal to the totalitarian regime (Orwell, 2003, p.120).

Based on Foucault's theory of power and discourse, the totalitarian regime has means to manipulate power discourse. It seems hard for society and individual to attain self-awareness under the repression and oppression of totalitarian power discourse.

Therefore, individuals under totalitarian regime are demanded to struggle for gaining discursive power for resistance in a long-term. Foucault believed that rewriting discourse of knowledge should be done by intellectuals, because they are the center of their society, and that's why Foucault spoke highly about the intellectual's resistance. Although Winston failed, from Foucault's perspective, but he presented a serious attempt and a good example for the resistance of intellectuals. The significance of gaining discursive power has been pointed out by Orwell in this novel, as well as he pointed out the limitations of individuals, and how the resistance of proletarian against totalitarian regime is very important. "Nineteen Eighty-Four" became "a vision of the ways in which totalitarian governments, whether right-wing or left-wing, can destroy individual thought and feeling" (Carter & McRae, 2001, p.464).

Through Orwell's narrative text, it could be understood that for gaining justice and freedom of mass it is very important to deconstruct the discourse hegemony, the total control of discourse is the essence of totalitarianism (Huang, 2012, p.35). Through his novel, Orwell sent a warning message to people about the dire consequences of totalitarian rule and called on them to confront the tyrannical and unjust rulers. Howe stated that Orwell's novel intimated the audience that Stalinism was actually the beginning of totalitarianism (Howe, 1983, p.114). "Nineteen Eighty-Four" was a unification of satire, allegory, dystopia, totalitarianism. It showed a real image of totalitarianism and a dystopian State. Orwell criticized Stalin, Hitler, and each dictator through symbol of Big Brother.

Conclusion

The analysis of the conceptual framework of this paper has shown the correlation between totalitarianism and ideology. The paper asserts that the exercise of absolute power represented by totalitarian regimes leads to corruption and creates dystopia inside the narrative texts under the study. It confirms that the totalitarian

forces dehumanize the society inside the literary text, deform it, and reshape human culture in a dystopian State. Such arguments are truly applicable to the two novels by Orwell. Despite being imaginative works of art, the two celebrated novels by Orwell, "Animal Farm" and "Nineteen Eighty-Four", essentially mimic reality. Orwell theoretically elucidated the dominant class or the oppressors in totalitarian regimes that used culture as one power to reshape the awareness of people. The process of gradual reshaping led the oppressed or humans under absolute power to lose their identity and become deformed images. In one way or another, power in its forms was the exclusive result, not only of corruption but of the dehumanization of people. Analysis of "Animal Farm", from the views of Marxist criticism and CDA could clearly reveal the way in which political systems are established. They are run in an inhuman and unfair manner with the practice of ideological manipulation, deception, violence and repression to keep their own interests and to retain their power, and ultimately become corrupt. In "Nineteen Eighty-Four", Orwell depicted totalitarianism by exposing its consequences on individuals and society and life. Through the plight of Winston, Orwell explained clearly that the totalitarian regime had confiscated human rights and freedoms, especially freedom of thought. The political regime offended humans' dignity, robbed his safety, and established a republic of fear with a dystopian society. Orwell presented the head of the political regime, Big Brother, as a symbol of tyranny, injustice and corruption, and summarized in his character all the meanings that indicated to the concepts of totalitarianism and corruption. The most prominent features of the tragic scene depicted by Orwell's two novels are the domination of the ideology of the totalitarian regime, the reshaping of the identity of society, the absence of social justice, and dehumanization of people. Thus, society turns into a dystopian one.

The findings of this paper assert that the exercise of absolute power, represented by totalitarian regimes, could build up the misery of humankind, eventually leading to mental and cultural

deformation in dystopian States. Truly, the two novels examine in many means how a corrupt regime can ruin society. Thus, Orwell's two novels under study could be considered brilliant examples of the political novel in the Modernist period in English literature, wherein the political novel became a severe critique of the inhuman practices of oppressors throughout history. Eventually, it could be said that although this paper has focused on totalitarianism and ideology as two key concepts in Orwell's two novels under the study, and some minor concepts that are related to. Thus, there is surely the possibility for further research to examine the framework more extensively, and there are gaps that could be bridged through new research in this respect.

Triad of Absolute Power - Corruption - Ideology as Encoded in Orwell's "Animal Farm"

ABSTRACT

This study aims at determining the interconnection of absolute power represented by a totalitarian regime and corruption, and confirming the relationship of power and ideology as encoded in George Orwell's novel *Animal Farm*. This study shows how the misusing power and imposing ideology can lead to corruption, and reshaping class and identity, and creation of dystopian society inside the text. As a qualitative study, this study adopts thematic analysis to investigate the concepts that it focuses on, in addition to textual analysis of the text by employing Marxist Criticism and Critical Discourse Analysis as analytical approaches. The findings of the current study indicate that absolute power practices are interconnected with corruption, and those who are in power impose their ideology upon the society to retain power through manipulation in language and discourse. It is hoped that the study will provide better understanding of the interconnection of absolute power and corruption as a missing feature in literature on this novel. It contributes to extending the base of knowledge and enriches the literature on this novel in particular, and the field of the political English novels in general.

Keywords: absolute power, corruption, ideology, class, George Orwell and *Animal Farm*.

Introduction

The modernist English literature especially the novel has become more popular than that written in the previous periods of English literature, because it is based on more realistic events rather than just imagination. Thus, during the 20th century, the narratives

encoding human sufferings and aspirations for better conditions were highly circulated among the readers. The modern English novel has dealt with the important events that affected the world and literature (Nouasri, 2015). Among the most prominent novels that have been written in the period of Modernism in English literature is *Animal Farm*. It was published firstly in England in 1945 and then in the United States in 1946 on the heels of World War II. It is an allegorical novel that tells a story of animals living on a farm under hard conditions which make them revolt against a human farmer, the owner of the farm. The animals dream to build up their own society in a way that ensures that they can live in justice, equality, and freedom (Orwell, 2001). According to George Orwell, the novel depicts events leading up to the Russian Revolution in 1917, as well as the Stalinist era in the Soviet Union. *Animal Farm* is an influential satire wherein Orwell uses irony to undermine the tenets of totalitarianism, especially the Stalinism (Khan and et al., 2017). Orwell, the British writer, through writing this novel aimed to dispel the common belief that Russia is a 'Socialist State', and he aims to expose its totalitarian political regime. During the writing of this novel in 1943 and 1944, the British-Soviet relationship was at its peak, so it could be said that Orwell wrote this novel allegorically to avoid accountability and prosecution. The novel deals with totalitarianism as a prominent political theme. It depicts the emergence of the pigs as rulers of the farm as they are the educated elite who have knowledge. The pigs use their eloquence to impose their ideology by manipulating the language and discourse to control the rest of the animals to exploit them, and to retain power and interests of the pigs. At the end, under the rule of the pigs, the animals live in a worse condition than before their revolution against their human master (Shapiro, 2017). In the light of the above-mentioned view, the current study deals with the concepts of power, corruption, and ideology in Orwell's narrative text. The purpose of conducting this study is to determine the interconnection of absolute power and corruption in *Animal Farm*. So, the relationship of power and

ideology in this novel is investigated, because absolute power represented by the totalitarian regime mostly uses certain ideologies to retain its power upon the society in the novel. The study has examined the corruption that is related to the practices of power through imposing its corrupt ideology. Looking at discursive practices in *Animal Farm*, the study has focused on how language is used by the pigs to manipulate and to impose their ideology that supports their power.

The literature has a big bulk of studies related to the theme of absolute power in Orwell's novel *Animal Farm*. For example; studies of Sebastian (2001), Sewlall (2002), Pelissioli (2008), Monica (2011), Nouasri (2015), and Goncalves (2017) focused on drawing the form of absolute power and its authoritarian methods and negative effects on the society through the interrogation of the narrative text. However, the relationship between absolute power and corruption in the previous studies about the selected novel is missed. The gap of research gap could be identified through previous studies that focused on: i) The form of absolute power, and ii) Authoritarian method and its negative effects on society. Thus, the gap appeared in: i) Lack of research in examining the interconnection between absolute power and corruption, and ii) No study has applied Marxist criticism with CDA (together) as analytical approaches. To bridge the gap, the current study; i) Examines the image of corruption and the social reaction against absolute power practices through inquest of the text to show the evidence of interconnection of absolute power and corruption, ii) Employs Marxist criticism with CDA as the analytical approaches. The use of these two analytical tools together in conducting the textual analysis of the selected data creates integration in the analysis of the narrative text, where the literary and linguistic aspects of the text are covered and surrounded. From the researcher's point of view, this makes the analysis more in depth, and makes the results more reliable. In order to address the research problem and objectives of the study, the following research question emerges: How does absolute power interconnect

with corruption, and how does power relate to ideology in the selected narrative text? The significant of conducting this research is to provide a better understanding to the interconnection of absolute power and corruption as a missing feature in the literature on Orwell's novel under quest in particular, and on the political English novels in general. In addition, this study contributes to enlarge the base of knowledge in this field.

Literature Review

A comprehensive commentary on the relevant terms and concepts is given this section. History has shown evidence that among the main reasons that may affect breakdown or progress of a society or a state is the role of command, ruling class, or leadership and its leaders. Through classification and division of the sorts of power, the most effective sorts are two; political and religious powers (Perry, 1997). In the past, religious power has held a great position, it was the most powerful. While in the modern era, political power (governments or political regimes) appears to be the most influential which controls our world, and influences, directly or indirectly, the societies and the states (Nyarota, 2013). The political power, especially absolute power that is represented by totalitarian regimes and dictatorships, has occupied large areas of literary and political studies because of the importance and seriousness of this theme and its impacts on the lives of peoples. Power, according to Wrong (2017), is often defined as "a capacity to control or influence others."(6). However, absolute power means a complete authority which is not restrained by review or supervision to act in an area. The main forms of power are; force, manipulation, and persuasion (Wrong, 2017), so when political absolute power is practiced by an individual, a group, or by one-party government will take the form of totalitarian regime or dictatorship. The term 'totalitarianism' refers to "tyrannical political regimes that wield more extensive, comprehensive and intensive power than any of the monarchies or tyrannies of the past" (2017, p.19). The last century witnessed several inhuman

and oppressive regimes that came in power including the major Bolsheviks in the Soviet Union, the Nazis in Germany, and Mao's Communists in China. Roughly, over one hundred million people were killed by these governments (Werth and et al., 1999). The current study investigates power and corruption as its main concepts. It explores the abuse of power represented by the totalitarian regime and dictatorship, and the corruption that pervades such forms of power, depicted in the novel under the study. In addition, this study investigates ideology because it is related to power. Ideology is a means to gain and retain power, where corruption of power stems from corruption of ideology. Thus, these three main concepts have to be explained to serve in understanding the analysis in the section of findings in this study. Power is a major part of political life that controls and negatively affects the life of society inside the narrative text. In one of Foucault's writings, *Discipline and Punish* (1975), he states that the main source of social discipline and conformity is power. Through power, the state controls people and obliges them to comply with its law (Bunsom, 2016). Van Dijk (2013) stated that "power is a property of relations between social groups, institutions, or organizations" (p.84). In fact the social power matters and not the individual one. In addition, Van Dijk emphasized that "the social power can be defined in terms of the control exercised by one group or organization (or its members) over the acts and/or the mind of (the members of) other group" (2013, p.84), therefore restraining the liberty of acts of the others, or affecting their knowledge, outlooks and ideologies. Thus, there is a sense of dominance in such human relationships. According to Van Dijk (2013), dominance is understood as a form of social power abuse, as a legal or moral illegitimate exercise of control over others in one's own interests that often results in social inequality. Totalitarianism is an embodiment of the concept of absolute power. It is a type of government that controls everything starting from individual to collective life. This regime is characterized by force and suppression. Totalitarianism functions

on two concepts; it is an official and exclusive philosophy which makes the society bow down before it, and it is a sort of dogma which compels the society to work as it has been ordered to do, without even complaining. Beauchamp (1986) opined totalitarianism as a matchless threat in the human history, which is further terrifying because it is more brutal than any preceding form of tyranny.

Corruption is a main concept in this study, it is related to the concept of absolute power in a 'cause-effect relationship'. It is difficult to find an agreed definition of corruption because it involves all life aspects. Corruption can be found everywhere; it might penetrate political, social, religious, administrative, financial, educational, and moral sides in the state or the society. However, Waite and Allen (2003) mentioned that literature on police corruption could provide a relatively simple definition of corruption that; "corruption is the misuse of public power for private and personal benefit" (p.282). This study deals with the political sense of this concept. Corruption means abuse of power, it penetrates all life aspects of society inside the novel under the study, wherein political, ideological and social corruption is prevalent. Werlin stated that corruption "is robbing people the opportunities they fought for" (2013, p.4). The society inside the text suffers from absence of social justice, because of the corrupt regime that prevented the society and individuals from their rights and freedoms. Thus, corruption leads to create dystopian society and finally disintegration of society.

Ideology is defined in diverse ways and through different perspectives. Plamenatz (1970) defines ideology as "a set of closely related beliefs or ideas, or even attitudes, characteristic of a group or community" (p.15). For van Dijk, as cited in Schäffner (2003) "ideologies have something to do with systems of ideas, and especially with the social, political or religious ideas shared by a social group or movement" (p.6). These definitions are the operational definitions used in this study. In the novel under study, political absolute power is based on marketing of its own

ideologies to persuade and subject the society for its total authority. The ruling class uses processes of manipulation and distortion of these ideologies, from time to time, in order to retain its power and own interests. According to Van Dijk (1999), the process of manipulation has been adopted to be the masterful strategy for influencing the minds of individuals and societies by distorting and internalizing of certain ideologies, values, beliefs, or attitudes. The use of Language and discourse, based on Van Dijk (2000) are the "critical social practices influenced by ideologies", which in turn also influence "how we acquire, learn or change ideologies"(p.9). Sandaran (2008) mentioned that Capitalist relations are embedded in ideologies and not just in economic relations. For Marx ideology is related to manipulation. As Van Dijk (1998) demonstrates that "the ideas of the ruling classes are imposed upon the majority and accepted throughout society as natural and normal" (p.2). This study adopts the Marxism views of ideology as a means to retain power. However, some previous studies can be mentioned by what they have done through investing the theme of power in Orwell's novel. The theme of absolute power has been investigated by Sebastian (2001) who stated that absolute power controlled over individuals lives in Animal Farm. He exposed practices of power, and concluded that the love of power was the major motive behind the political action. Nouasri (2015) exposed some aspects of corruption in education in the society of Animal Farm, and focused on Orwell's purpose behind his writing this novel. Monica (2011) exposed the class discrimination in Animal Farm, and how the upper class exploits the lower class under dictatorship of communism. Thus, all these studies have left a gap regarding the relationship of absolute power and corruption. This clearly points to the need for a study to investigate the interconnection between absolute power and corruption.

Methodology

The data of this qualitative study is the text of Orwell's novel *Animal Farm*. The analysis of the data involves thematic analysis and textual analysis. The thematic analysis is a method of analysing qualitative data to examine the data to identify themes (Cresswell, 2003). The qualitative data of this study are in the form of extracts taken from the narrative text to be analysed. These selected data (extracts) are based on the themes that relate to the key concepts of the study; power, corruption, and ideology. Thus, the extracts have been selected based on the mentioned related concepts. The textual analysis is used to describe and interpret the text, where information, assumptions, symbolism and values can be detected from the text. The textual analysis is conducted by employing two analytical tools; Marxist Criticism and Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) to reveal manipulation of language and discourse used in the text. Furthermore, the notion of binarism or binary oppositions is used as a platform to serve the analysis. It is a mode of thought on stable oppositions (such as good and evil). As Tahreem and Khan (2020) have mentioned, binarism or binary relationship has always been established on the basis of power, economy, and politics, in addition to gender and caste. This notion is a central to the literary creation, especially in drama and fiction. The analysis is be built on binary opposition in the society inside the narrative text on the basis of power, ideology, and class. Identifying the social classes in the narrative text helps in tracing class, ideology, and power. The textual analysis of the data of *Animal Farm* is conducted by using two analytical tools and through two phases as follows:

i) Analysing the text by employing Marxist Criticism (Marxist literary criticism) which focuses on the role of ideology and class difference within the literary work, the role of money and power, author's ideologies, and the context. Notion of binary oppositions or duality, and manipulative techniques used in the text, such as

manipulation and propaganda, are used in doing analysis from literary perspective.

ii) Analysing the text by employing Critical Discourse Analysis: CDA is used to conduct the second phase of analysing the text (extracts) by using strategies of manipulation, presentation, lexicalization, presupposition, and under-lexicalization. The analysis of *Animal Farm* involves the idea of revolution in the animal farm, and the seven commandments (the principles of Animalism).

Findings

In the following paragraphs, the extracts would form the main part of the interpretation of findings. The textual analysis is organized based on the two frameworks used in this study, focus on: the first phase) Marxist Criticism, and second) Critical Discourse Analysis. Thus, the data analysis is conducted by using the two analytical tools and through two phases.

i) Analysing the text by employing Marxist Criticism:

Before the revolution of the animals in the farm, Mr. Jones represented the corrupt absolute power that controlled the farm. So, the analysis starts at a point in which there is a powerful invitation for animals to begin a rebellion against Mr. Jones, as the symbol of man, who oppresses the animals. All the animals have been invited by Old Major to attend a secret meeting to tell them about his dream of revolution. He inspires the animals to rid of the human oppression and tyranny. During the meeting of the animals which is held secretly, and through his speech to the animal, in Extracts 1 and 2, below, Old Major has said;

Extract 1: "Let us face it: our lives are miserable, laborious"(Orwell, 2001, p.27).

Extract 2: Man is the only creature that consumes without producing. He does not give milk, he does not lay eggs, he is too weak to pull the plough, he cannot run fast enough to catch

rabbits. Yet he is lord of all the animals. He sets them to work, he gives back to them the bare minimum that will prevent them from starving, and the rest he keeps for himself (Orwell, 2001, p.28).

The two extracts said by Old Major indicate power represented by Mr Jones as a lord of all the animals, and his corruption which embodies by injustice for his treatment of the animals. These lines of the Old Major speech refer to his vital role in disseminating his beliefs, which is an ideology of anti-human, of the revolution against the absolute power of Mr Jones. In *Animal Farm*, the manipulative techniques are highly used by the pigs. From the beginning of the novel, Old Major employed the strategy of manipulation in his speech by telling the animals about his dream of revolution to instigate the animals to revolt against Mr Jones. Manipulation is an act of attempting to make the other to accept one's own point of view and to change their way of thinking of certain subjects, in favour of the speaker. This is usually done through some concept such as rhetoric, persuasion, and propaganda (Jewett & O'Donnell, 2012). Old Major's speech involved the notion of binary or duality by describing Mr Jones as the symbol of 'evil' and the animals as the symbol of 'good'. Despite Mr Jones does nothing and he "is too weak to pull the plough" and the animals are stronger than Mr Jones and they do everything in the farm, but "he is lord of all the animals". Old Major focuses on class disparity and states that the animals are the oppressed class. Mr Jones seizes the resources of the farm (economics). Mr Jones is the lord who "sets the (animals) to work, he gives back to them the bare minimum that will prevent them from starving, and the rest he keeps for himself".

Old Major promotes his beliefs that the animals are in a about the state of inequality, that is to say, there is a class division between the animals of the farm and humans. Through his word, Old Major reveals to the animals his ideology (anti-human) which is opposite to Man who represents human ruling class. Old Major encourages all the animals to revolt against Mr. Jones for their freedom. Old Major sheds light on the fact that despite of the hard work the

animals, they do not gain benefits from their work. In the same time, Mr. Jones, who represents 'Man', does nothing except exploiting the work of the animals for his own interests. He points out that the humans utilize all of the profits and enjoy the fruits of the animals' work, while the animals have just to do work on the farm for very little income that keeps them alive only. He states that the humans take full authority over the animals. He reminds the animals how Mr. Jones oppresses them, and steals everything they have. The purpose behind Old Major's speech is to persuade the animals of the farm to rebel against Mr. Jones "Let us face". Old Major states that the animals are the victims of human power, exploitation, oppression, and corruption. So, by overthrowing Man, the animals can regain their rights and the fruits of their work in the farm. The two extracts said by Old Major indicate power represented by Mr Jones as a lord of all the animals, and his corruption which embodies by injustice for his treatment of the animals.

Extract 3: "The Seven Commandments"

1. "Whatever goes upon two legs is an enemy"
2. "Whatever goes upon four legs, or has wings, is a friend"
3. "No animal shall wear clothes"
4. "No animal shall sleep in a bed"
5. "No animal shall drink alcohol"
6. "No animal shall kill any other animal"
7. "All animals are equal" (Orwell, 2001, p.42)

The pigs, the educated elite in the animal farm, take power on the farm after succeeding the animals' revolution. They change the name of the farm from 'MANOR FARM' to 'ANIMAL FARM', and they adopt a flag for their farm and a song of 'Beasts of England' as a national anthem of the farm. Now, the animals possess the farm, they feel free, and don't mind working hard for the benefit of everyone. The three pigs; Napoleon, Snowball, and Squealer "elaborated old Major's teachings into a complete system of thought; they called it Animalism" (Orwell, 2001, p.38). Then, Napoleon and Snowball (the main leaders) succeeded in reducing

the principles of 'Animalism', which is based on the ideologies of Old Major (anti-human), to 'Seven Commandments' as "an unalterable law by which all the animals on Animal Farm must live forever" (2001, p.42). However, the turning-point in the novel happens when the pigs changed the seven commandments by using manipulation, under the pretext that most of the animals are not intelligent enough to learn them by heart. So, things start going to wrong direction.

Because of their eloquence in language and their rhetoric, pigs employed manipulation and propaganda in deceiving the animals to promote and impose their new ideology (the pigs' racism), and to conceal the process of destroying the principles of 'Animalism', and turning into 'humanism'. The purpose of doing this is the pigs' desire to retain power and their privileges, at the expense of other animals. After the revolution in the farm, two groups of characters in this novel seem to be in binary opposition socially, economically and intellectually. A group includes the ruling class, the pigs and their leaders; Napoleon, Snowball, and Squealer. In addition, the trained dogs that loyal to the pigs. This ruling class controls the farm resources and lives in luxury, adopts utilitarian philosophy based on their own interests, and imposes its own ideology upon the rest of animals. As the upper class in society, this group possesses the speech of power and domination. Another group includes the rest of the oppressed animal in the farm, such as; Boxer and Benjamin, who represents the down-trodden class. Speech of this class represents a socially and culturally oppressed class. This kind of speech represents submission and surrender to repression exercised by absolute power. The analysis will explain how events develop in the narrative text and how things go wrong and end up to dystopia society in the animal farm. The purpose of these introductory signals is to contextualize the text, and this has significance in understanding the analysis.

Napoleon and Snowball replace the term of 'Animalism' with 'The Seven Commandments', a term derived from the Christian

religious discourse. Religion has powerful influence on humans in general. The words 'seven' and 'commandment' have been mentioned in the Quran and Bible and in many heavenly texts, so they have great effect. The pigs employ Moses, a raven, to tell the animals through stories that they will receive rewards in life after death due to their hard work on the farm; in return they will go to paradise after they die. Religious symbols, concepts and terms have particular sanctity, thus the pigs employ religion as a tool for controlling the animals since they truly believe in religion as the only true source of inspiration. It is an example of manipulation used by the pigs (through religious ideology) to serve their goal of controlling the animals and the farm. Orwell employs the character of Moses, who plays a missionary role; to expose the communism policy in exploiting religion to anesthetize people in order not to think about their suffering and bad conditions due to the rule of the Communists leaders. Karl Marx (2005) describes the effect of religion as the opium of the people. It seems that Orwell reveals the policy of the pigs from the beginning of the story when the pigs employ the effect of religious ideology as a main remote control that could be used to control the rest of the animal, in order to retain power.

Based on Marxist literary criticism's strategies which focuses on ideology, class, and the role of money and power in the literary work, the notions of the Seven Commandments could be investigated as follows;

i) The first and the second commandments classifying and identifying who is the enemy of the animals and who is a friend (class and ideology):

1. "Whatever goes upon two legs is an enemy".
2. "Whatever goes upon four legs, or has wings, is a friend" (Orwell, 2001, p.42).

This is to confirm the ideology of hostility against humans, because they oppressed the animal. Thus, the enemies of the animals are; Mr Jones and in general the human farmers. In addition, it emphasizes the relation of friendship between all

animals should be a relation of cooperation and solidarity as one class.

ii) The commandments 3, 4, 5, and 6 are laws and orders that must be adhered, and cannot be violated (ideology):

3. "No animal shall wear clothes".

4. "No animal shall sleep in a bed".

5. "No animal shall drink alcohol".

6. "No animal shall kill any other animal") (Orwell, 2001, p.42).

The text stresses on forbidding of these acts by starting each commandment with 'No', as well as the use of the modal verb 'shall' which refers to an order, law, promise etc. (LDOCE, 2009). In this way the text confirms on these compulsory actions as orders or rules.

iii) The last one is the cornerstone of the seven commandments and the major principle of 'Animalism'. It assures the equality among all animals in the farm, i.e. equality in rights and duties (class and ideology):

7. "All animals are equal" (Orwell, 2001, p.42).

It could be said that the basic principles of Animalism, inspired by the thoughts of Old Major, which have been transformed into seven commandments and written on the barn wall immediately after the revolution to be obligated to all animals, are focusing on the fundamental issues:

First: Human class is the enemy of the animals; it is not allowed to deal with them, to act like them, or to imitate them. It is not allowed to wear clothes, to sleep in bed, and to drink alcohol like humans.

Second: The major ideology is; all animals are equal in rights and duties.

Later on in the novel, the pigs turn towards 'humanization' (imitation of human actions and behaviours) for their own interests. Napoleon and Squealer partake in activities associated with the humans (drinking alcohol, sleeping in beds, walking on two legs, and trading), which are explicitly prohibited in the seven commandments. Eventually, the final betrayal occurs when the

pigs establish good relationships with Mr Jones and humans. The pigs deviate from the goals of the revolution, their aim becomes how to seize power and obtain privileges and benefits. For this end, the pigs practice manipulation and propaganda for imposing their ideologies. In order to achieve their goals, the pigs work on changing the commandments to suit their policies and desires. Thus, they provide a legitimate cover for their power and corruption, and justify their violation of these commandments. The pigs reduce the commandments from seven to five. They cancel three commandments (1, 2, 3), change four commandments (4, 5, 6, 7), and invents new one. It is worth noting that the commandments have not been changed at once or at the same time, rather the change has occurred gradually and according to the requirements of the situation and events throughout the novel. The Seven Commandments" become Five:

1. "Whatever goes upon two legs is an enemy". (CANCELLED)
2. "Whatever goes upon four legs, or has wings, is a friend". (CANCELLED)
3. "No animal shall wear clothes". (CANCELLED)
"Four legs good, two legs bad", then "Four legs good, two legs better" (Orwell, 2001,P.125). (INVENTED)
4. "No animal shall sleep in a bed with sheets" (Orwell, 2001, p.75). (CHANGED)
5. "No animal shall drink alcohol to excess" (Orwell,2001, p.106). (CHANGED)
6. "No animal shall kill any other animal without cause" (Orwell,2001, p.92). (CHANGED)
7. "All animals are equal but some animals are more equal than others"(2001, p.126). (CHANGED)

For Marxist critique, it is important to trace the ideology in the text and how it is promoted or imposed to retain power. Squealer acts as Napoleon's spokesperson, he is a good and persuasive orator who always falsifies the truth in order to cover the corruption of the pigs. The build-up of power is caused by language as well as the use of eloquence by the pigs throughout

the novel. The control of words and language used by the pigs is the reason behind the expulsion of Mr Jones, thus dictatorship of Napoleon is possible to emerge by the same way. The first commandment has been cancelled, because it confirms hostility against humans who have oppressed the animals. In contrary, the pigs build relationships with humans and go towards 'humanization' in order to gain benefits for their personal interests. Napoleon broke the commandments of Old major; this act indicates misuse of power and corruption. Napoleon wants to seize power alone, so he starts practicing violence, intimidation and even killing animals. Finally, he expels his rival, Snowball, from the farm by using violence. Therefore, he has dared and cancelled the second commandment in order to get rid of this law that prohibits the practice of these hostile acts against animals, because it is a commandment calling for friendship between all animals. After Napoleon and the pigs associating with relationships and with humans and imitating their acts, the pigs were motivated to wear clothes, just like humans. Therefore, the pigs decided to cancel the third commandment because it forbids wearing clothes. Later on, the pigs invented of a new commandment, which is "Four legs good, two legs bad". Here, the pigs have changed their attitude towards humans by describing them as (bad) rather than describing them as enemy. Now, the pigs and humans are from the same class and have same ideologies. Then, the pigs have appeared to imitate humans in public; they wear clothes and walk erect on two legs. So, the pigs have changed again this invented commandment by replacing the word (bad) (better), thus the commandment becomes "Four legs good, two legs better". This is a dangerous shift that gives preference to those who walk on two legs, including the pigs that started walking on two legs (their hind legs). This expose that the pigs confess that the humans are better than the animals, this is a betrayal of the most important principles of "Animalism". Accordingly, it becomes clear that the pigs (who become more human) are better than the rest of animals. This divides the society of animals farm (who were originally one class,

and common identity and culture) into two classes; the ruling class or upper class (the pigs) it's ideology pig's racism and humanism, and the oppressed class or lower class (the rest of the animal), it's ideology 'Animalism'. Such a division breaks the principle of justice and equality between the animals and creates hidden conflict between the two classes in this society, where the upper class tries to suppress the lower class, and this what the pigs did.

The pigs, by using manipulation and their good ability to use language succeeded to empty the original commandments from their content and change them according to their will. Thus, the fourth commandment has been changed to abolish the prohibition of sleeping in bed to legitimize their sleeping on the bed in the farmhouse, like Mr Jones. Here the pigs succeeded in transferring the idea of prohibition from (bed) to the (sheets). In the same way, the pigs change the fifth commandment. They legalize drinking of alcohol which is already forbidden. The pigs decide to allow drinking alcohol, but on one condition; no drinking excessively. The change of the fourth and fifth commandments comes in the context of strengthening the pigs' principle of going towards "humanism" and normalizing with humans, and imposing this new culture on the animals.

Napoleon decided to get rid of his rival Snowball, and to kill any animal that opposes his rule or forms a threat to him. Therefore, Napoleon has to change the sixth commandment which prohibits killing of the animals. As usual, Napoleon and Squealer employed manipulation to legalize the killing of the animals. It becomes easy to invent and fabricate reasons and excuses for killing and violence that have been practiced by Napoleon, under the pretext that these animals are traitors and should be killed. Napoleon fights Snowball for getting power and leadership for himself and to control Animal Farm. Napoleon uses special trained dogs to rid of Snowball. The trained dogs symbolize police and security force that carry out acts of violence against the animals when Napoleon orders to do so. After overtaking Snowball's position, Napoleon starts a new tyranny era in the farm under his control through

violence and killing, but he justifies his acts by using manipulation.

Napoleon, the dictator kills any animal in the farm that does not display complete obedience or object to Napoleon's policy. Often Napoleon claims that those who have been killed are traitors, enemies who must be eliminated. In one afternoon, Napoleon executes a large group of animals. The event of execution causes terror in the hearts of the animals, but after days the animals would calm down. Squealer comes to justify killing of the animals by giving good reason, they are traitors. As usual, Squealer the propagandist justifies everything in favour of Napoleon. Benjamin the oldest animal in the farm, but speaks rarely, so he seems as someone who supports unintentionally the rule of the pigs by keeping silent. There is no justification for his silence except that he is afraid of the pigs. It seems that terror and violence which are caused by the pigs and their dogs fill up the hearts of the rest of the animals with fear, and make them unable to speak or even to think. Thus, the animals convince themselves that there is a good reason for killing some animals because they are traitors.

Napoleon's crimes against 'Animalism' continue. Meanwhile, he continues to deceive animals by providing legal cover for these crimes, or inventing fake stories to convince the animals that everything he does is based on the principles of 'Animalism'. When Boxer becomes elderly and weak, Boxer becomes a victim of Napoleon's absolute power and corruption. Through a sinister, immoral, and illegal secret deal, Napoleon hands Boxer over to a "knacker" to kill him and turn his body into glue and other materials. Little barrels of whiskey that Napoleon gets in return for Boxer's life. Boxer always shows his devotion and support to the animals' issues, especially when he appears as the strong worker among the animals in building the windmill. Boxer supports power of the pigs through his gullibility.

Napoleon, who gained absolute power linked to corrupt practices, decided to legislate a racial law that would give preference to pigs, and formally establish the class inequality between the animals

community on the farm. He changed the seventh commandment to be "All animals are equal but some animals are more equal than others". This has overturned the original meaning of the commandment upside down. Thus the ultimate betrayal happens when the pigs change this commandment. This change is betrayal; it represents a complete collapse of the principles of "Animalism", as pigs decide to abolish the equality and unity among the animals which are the essence of the animal's revolution. On the side of the barn, the final revised commandment is seen painted. This indicates Napoleon's ability and willingness to change the historical record boldly, for manipulating the animals and controlling them. It becomes clear that the acts of the pigs and behaviours directly and strongly oppose the original revolutionary movement and its principles. The superiority of the ruling class and its privileges, and even its corruption, become a fait accompli, while the rest of animals suffer from poverty and oppression. The supposed idea is that communism serves man, but in fact man serves communism (Inch, 2016, p.10). It is a declaration that Napoleon's political regime has absolutely become corrupt.

Accordingly, it has become clear that the images of the pigs' corruption appear in: betrayal of the goals of revolution, destroying the principles of "Animalism" and changing its historical record, imposing their ideology (The pigs' racism), controlling on the sources of the farm, and domination over the farm and the rest of the animals. Finally, it could be said that the writer of the text has triumphed for the oppressed class of animals. Orwell exposed, criticized and attacked the corrupt and the oppressive power of the pigs. Napoleon's regime of ruling deservedly is the worst example of interconnection of absolute power and corruption.

ii) Analysing the text by employing Critical Discourse Analysis:

Extract 1: "Let us face it: our lives are miserable, laborious"(Orwell, 2001, p.27).

Extract 2: "Man is the only creature that consumes without producing. He does not give milk, he does not lay eggs, he is too

weak to pull the plough, and he cannot run fast enough to catch rabbits. Yet he is lord of all the animals. He sets them to work, he gives back to them the bare minimum that will prevent them from starving, and the rest he keeps for himself "(Orwell, 2001, p.28).

The words in these extracts indicate power represented by Mr. Jones as a lord of all the animals, and his corruption which embodies injustice and inequity for his treatment of the animals. CDA is significant to reveal injustice and inequity of the dominant group or ruling class in a society. In the narrative text of *Animal Farm*, manipulative discourses have highly been employed. Manipulation "is a communicative and interactional practice, in which a manipulator exercises control over other people, usually against their will or against their best interests.... Language users call this discourse 'manipulative discourse'"(Van Dijk, 2006, p.360). For understanding manipulative discourse in the text, strategy of manipulation and the linguistic strategies of CDA mentioned above are used in doing the analysis. In the novel, the manipulative discourses have been produced by the pigs in two stages; before the revolution of the animals in the farm (under Man domination), and after the revolution (under the pigs' domination). Before the revolution, the manipulative discourse has been produced by Old Major for achieving his goal in the revolution, because of the corrupt power of Mr Jones. Old Major has adopted anti-human ideology to produce political discourse to persuade the animals to rebel against the owner of the farm, Mr Jones, for freedom of all the animals. A manner of argumentation has been employed in Old Major's manipulative discourse to determine the reason behind the misery of the animals and who should be blamed. For this purpose, Old Major has used many strategies;

i) Old Major has used strategy of manipulation to promote his ideology (anti-human), by telling the animals about his dream about the revolution. In addition, Old Major has employed (in-group) ideology in his discourse by focusing on the notions of the unity of the animals, and the golden future time as a dream of the

animals from generation to generation "Let us face it: our lives are miserable".

ii) Old Major has also used the strategy of negative presentation by describing Man cruel treatment against the animals; "he gives back to them the bare minimum that will prevent them from starving". Old Major has dramatized some details that related to the lives of the animals and the tragic end that awaits them. Old Major has confirmed 'the evil of Man'. Old Major's discourse has shown the great disparity between the great contribution of the animals to the farm and the non-contribution of Man 'consumes without producing'. However, the strategies that have been employed in Old Major's discourse are utilizing "a negative presentation of an out-group called Man with a negative predicator "evil", in terms of ideology, called "enemy" or "antagonist" (Basuki& Authar, 2019: 2). The Old Major has demonstrated and emphasized Man's unfair behaviour and focused on it.

iii) Old Major has also used the strategy of negative lexicalization in his discourse such as; 'miserable', 'laborous', and 'starving', in order to promote his ideology of anti-human among the animal to revolt against Mr Jones. Due to the corruption that is linked with the power of Mr Jones, Old Major's discourse has focused on the animals' suffering, despite the fact that the soil of the farm is fertile, and able to provide plenty of food for the animals. So, their suffering is due to Man's greed, 'Man who knows only to take but never gives'. Thus, Old Major's discourse carries an implicature that 'dismissal Man from the farm'; this means that the only solution is rebellion. The two extracts said by Old Major indicate power represented by Mr Jones as a lord of all the animals, and his corruption which embodies by injustice for his treatment of the animals.

Extract 3: "The Seven Commandments"

1. "Whatever goes upon two legs is an enemy"
2. "Whatever goes upon four legs, or has wings, is a friend"
3. "No animal shall wear clothes"
4. "No animal shall sleep in a bed"

5. "No animal shall drink alcohol"
6. "No animal shall kill any other animal"
7. "All animals are equal" (Orwell, 2001, p.42).

After the revolution, the manipulative discourses have been produced by the pigs by using many strategies which basically depend on manipulation in language and discourse. Religion has powerful influence on humans in general. Napoleon and Snowball replace the term of 'Animalism' with 'The Seven Commandments', a term derived from the Christian religious discourse. This is an example of using lexicalization; "using euphemistic expressions, a word which is substituted for a something that is more conventional or familiar" (Fairclough, 2001b, p.97). The term of 'The Seven Commandments' is more conventional or familiar for the animals, so they have accepted it easily. The pigs have employed the effect of religious ideology as a main remote control that could be used to control the rest of the animal. It is a strategy of manipulation used by the pigs in order to retain their power.

The pigs (after the revolution) have produced manipulative discourses to get domination, and to control on the rest of the animals of the farm. The pigs' racism is the ideology which has been adopted by the pigs to gain power, then to get more privilege and control the resources of the farm. For this end, the pigs use the strategy of manipulation in language, supported by propaganda (which is a process of manipulation), in order to win the consent of the rest of the animals and legalize their power. The pigs have also employed some the strategies include manipulation, presupposition, and under-lexicalization.

i) Manipulation in language, supported by propaganda (which is a process of manipulation), has been use by the pigs in order to win the consent of the rest of the animals and to legalize the pigs' power. The pigs have decided to seize the power and the resources of the farm, at the expense of the rest of the animals. But the Seven Commandments are an obstacle to achieving their goal, so the pigs decided to change these commandments to align with their goal. This entails manipulation that is considered as a

delicately ingenious strategy for influencing the minds of an audience through the distortion and internalization of certain beliefs, values, attitudes, or ideologies (Van Dijk, 1999). Language use and discourse are the "critical social practices influenced by ideologies", which in turn also influence "how we acquire, learn or change ideologies" (Van Dijk, 2000, p. 9). The pigs have conducted the strategy of manipulation to find resolutions for all the obstacles that originally the commandments involve. The pigs have to legalize the following forbidden actions; living in a house, sleep in a bed, wearing clothes, drinking alcohol, killing other animals, trading with human farmers, and some animals are more equal. The major purpose of the manipulation in the commandments is to get absolute power for Napoleon and the pigs.

ii) Presupposition: The pigs have employed the strategy of presupposition that "the pigs are the brain of the farm" as a resolution for living in the house of the farm. This presupposition has an implication that the pigs are in the higher rank (the upper class), so they deserve more privilege. Furthermore, Napoleon is "Leader and ruler", thus, it is necessary for the pigs to get him an exception. As resolutions for sleeping in the bed, drinking alcohol, and killing other animal (traitors).

iii) Under-lexicalization: For the purpose of imposing their ideology (pigs' racism), controlling the farm, and retaining their power over the rest of the animals, the pigs have changed the essential meaning of the seven commandments. The process of changing the meanings of commandments has been done by Napoleon through adding words or phrases to the original text. Adding words to the text is similar to Fairclough's explanation of what he calls under-lexicalization that refers to "the phenomenon in which a lexical item that would precisely refer to a concept, is deliberately avoided, suppressed, or substituted for another one" (Fairclough, 1992, p.193). The strategy of 'under-lexicalization' is used by the pigs for changing the meanings of the original text of the commandments in order to serve the pigs' power and interests.

The pigs have established good relationships with Mr. Jones and other human farmers, and imitated humans' acts. The pigs have cancelled the first commandment "Whatever goes upon two legs is an enemy", because it confirms the ideology of hostility against humans. Then, the pigs invented a new commandment "Four legs good, two legs better".

The pigs have added two words "with sheet" to the commandment "No animal shall sleep in a bed". The origin of prohibition includes "bed", but it has turned into prohibition of "sheets". Thus, "bed" is not forbidden now; prohibition is shifted to "sheet". The pigs have added a phrase "without a cause" to the commandment "No animal shall kill other animal". Thus, killing other animals is not forbidden if there is a reason (such as traitor). The pigs have added a phrase "to excess" to the commandment "No animal shall drink alcohol". Thus, it becomes allowed to the pigs to drink alcohol. Most of the animals do not pay attention any writing, because they cannot read. So, this strategy used by the pigs is effective. Eventually, the animals have been shocked once they discovered that all the Seven Commandments have been gone with the wind. All the commandments have been replaced with a single principle based on racial discrimination, "All animals are equal but some animals are more equal than others". Van Dijk emphasized that "the social power can defined in terms of the control exercised by one group or organization (or its members) over the acts and/or the mind of (the members of) other group" (2013, p.84), According to Van Dijk, dominance is understood as a form of social power abuse that is as a legal or moral illegitimate exercise of control over others in one's own interests, often resulting in social inequality (Van Dijk, 2013).

The principles of Animalism (later on, the Seven Commandments) are the cornerstone in Animal Farm. Before the revolution, Old Major has established "The original principles of Animalism" before his death. However, the Seven Commandments) have gradually been manipulated (one by one) by the pigs after the revolution. These principles have been changed and distorted to

give the opposite meaning that serves the pigs' power and interests. By manipulating the commandments and distorting them, then cancelling and finally replacing them by a single principle of racism, the pigs have intended to create confusion status among the animals in order to make them totally rely on and obey the pigs. Changing the commandments involves a hidden intention aims at leaving no chance for the rest of the animals to think and question about "the principles of "Animalism" that has been changed and manipulated. The powerful and fake propaganda used by the pigs has helped them to achieve their goals. Propaganda, used by the pigs and based on lies, is an illegitimate discourse practice or social practice, because it is a process of manipulation in its nature. In addition, the pigs' presupposition "the pigs are more equal" which means "above the nonpig animals" makes the pigs exercise constantly the domination over the animals in the farm. Now, "racism" rules the farm, the ideology of the racist pigs, but no "Animalism". The pigs have reached a position that enables to control the animals and resources of the farm. As a result, the political system has been turned into totalitarian. What has been analysed above reveals how the pigs have imposed their ideology by using manipulative discourse supported by their corrupt power. Thus the analysis has shown evidence that absolute power is interconnected with corruption.

Discussion

In *Animal Farm*, the analysis of the data has been conducted (through two analytical tools) by using the essentials of Marxist Criticism along with CDA's strategies that used to reveal manipulation in language and discourse which has been used in the narrative text to impose ideologies of pigs to retain power. The findings of the analysis have determined the interconnection of absolute power and corruption. The findings of data analysis have confirmed the relationship between power and ideology. The pigs have eloquence and influential language and discourse as an

educated group among the animals. Thus, discourse, that conveys ideology of the pigs, plays critical role in the narrative text. The results speak about the abuse of power by the ruling class, which is exploiting power to achieve its interests, desires, and utility. Therefore, the aspects of corruption in all its forms emerge as an inevitable result of totalitarian power. This confirms the interconnection between absolute power and corruption. So, it could be said that where absolute power is present, corruption will surely be present. The interpretation of the interconnection of absolute power and corruption stems from the desire of the ruler, who has absolute power, to remain in power and retain its privileges, and since integrity, justice and freedom of governed do not achieve what the ruler wants, so the absolute ruler rushes towards practicing corruption to achieve this illegal goal. This interpretation of this result is based on the data that have been already analysed.

Orwell personified the animals in the tradition of allegory so that they could represent real historical figures. In *Animal Farm*, Orwell clearly reveals classes' difference. Napoleon and the pigs represented the ruling class while the rest of the animals represented the lower class (proletariats). Orwell portrays the picture of exploitation and showed the abuse of power as well as totalitarianism of pigs when they become the leaders of the animals. Napoleon somehow got control and became a dictator. Symbolically, this was what Stalin did as he was also a proletarian and assured people of utopia. However, Stalin only gave his dictatorship and tyranny to generate dystopia. In *Animal Farm*, all principles, to get utopian life, have been changed in such a way that life became dystopian. All animals (except the pigs and the dogs) are broken and scared. There were no rules but dictatorship, Orwell depicts the effects of totalitarianism on the society and as a result the civilization could turn into dystopia. Orwell has proved that all the utopia ideas and promises were abused by only totalitarian dictator (Raza and Awan, 2016).

Conclusion

It could be concluded that the findings of this study have expanded the work of the previous research on the theme of absolute power in the selected modernist English novel, *Animal Farm*. The current study has bridged the gap that left by previous research through finding the link between absolute power and corruption as a missing feature in literature. This study has determined the interconnection of absolute power and corruption and provided a better understanding to this interconnection as a prominent phenomenon in the old and the modern human history that have always been portrayed in the literary works, because it touches people's lives deeply. The analysis of the data has clearly confirmed that the corruption, resulting from absolute power, has appeared in multiple forms; political, ideological, social, financial, and moral corruption. Napoleon and the pigs, as a ruling class, have oppressed the animals, they have deceived them and stolen the farm resources, and they have enjoyed a life of luxury. In return, the rest of the animals have turned into an oppressed and deprived lower class. This determines the corruption of the pigs that related to their power. Thus, the final statement of the study can be formulated by saying; wherever absolute power exists, then surely corruption exists. Besides, it could be concluded that power is related to ideology in the narrative text. The manipulation of language and discourse and the intense propaganda along with the violence have led to impose ideology of totalitarian political regime, in order to retain and reinforce its power upon the society. In *Animal Farm*, Napoleon has imposed his ideology, upon the rest of the animals in the farm, with the help of his followers, especially the eloquent orator Squealer, and his security force which is represented by the nine dogs. Squealer has adopted Napoleon's policy and philosophy, and turned into a propaganda machine supporting Napoleon's ideology and power. Orwell's novel *Animal Farm* revealed the political perspective of the writer and demonstrated how Orwell handled totalitarianism. Orwell has

expressed his political ideas in this literary work that reflects his ideological orientations, so as to communicate his inner world and ideological attitudes. He tried to explore the effect of political ideologies and the contribution of these ideologies to human life.